

CAMBRIDGE

THE WORLD'S BEST-SELLING GRAMMAR BOOK

ENGLISH GRAMMAR IN USE

A self-study reference and
practice book for intermediate
learners of English

with answers

Fifth Edition

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Experience
Better
Learning

114 IRREGULAR VERBS

Infinitive	Past simple	Past participle
be	was/were	been
beat	beat	beaten
become	became	become
begin	began	begun
bend	bent	bent
bet	bet	bet
bite	bit	bitten
blow	blew	blown
break	broke	broken
bring	brought	brought
broadcast	broadcast	broadcast
build	built	built
burst	burst	burst
buy	bought	bought
catch	caught	caught
choose	chose	chosen
come	came	come
cost	cost	cost
creep	crept	crept
cut	cut	cut
deal	dealt	dealt
dig	dug	dug
do	did	done
draw	drew	drawn
drink	drank	drunk
drive	drove	driven
eat	ate	eaten
fall	fell	fallen
feed	fed	fed
feel	felt	felt
fight	fought	fought
find	found	found
flee	fled	fled
fly	flew	flown
forbid	forbade	forbidden
forget	forgot	forgotten
forgive	forgave	forgiven
freeze	froze	frozen
get	got	gotten

Infinitive	Past simple	Past participle
give	gave	given
go	went	gone
grow	grew	grown
hang	hung	hung
have	had	had
hear	heard	heard
hide	hid	hidden
hit	hit	hit
hold	held	held
hurt	hurt	hurt
keep	kept	kept
kneel	knelt	knelt
know	knew	known
lay	laid	laid
lead	led	led
leave	left	left
lend	lent	lent
let	let	let
lie	lay	lain
light	lit	lit
lose	lost	lost
make	made	made
mean	meant	meant
meet	met	met
pay	paid	paid
put	put	put
read	read [red]*	read [red]*
ride	rode	ridden
ring	rang	rung
rise	rose	risen
run	ran	run
say	said	said
see	saw	seen
seek	sought	sought
sell	sold	sold
send	sent	sent
set	set	set
sew	sewed	sewn/sewed
shake	shook	shaken

Infinitive	Past simple	Past participle
shine	shone	shone
shoot	shot	shot
show	showed	shown/ showed
shrink	shrank	shrunk
shut	shut	shut
sing	sang	sung
sink	sank	sunk
sit	sat	sat
sleep	slept	slept
slide	slid	slid
speak	spoke	spoken
spend	spent	spent
spit	spat	spat
split	split	split
spread	spread	spread
spring	sprang	sprung
stand	stood	stood
steal	stole	stolen
stick	stuck	stuck
sting	stung	stung
stink	stank	stunk
strike	struck	struck
swear	swore	sworn
sweep	swept	swept
swim	swam	swum
swing	swung	swung
take	took	taken
teach	taught	taught
tear	tore	torn
tell	told	told
think	thought	thought
throw	threw	thrown
understand	understood	understood
wake	woke	woken
wear	wore	worn
weep	wept	wept
win	won	won
write	wrote	written

Present continuous (I am doing)

A Study this example situation:

Sarah is in her car. She is on her way to work.
She's **driving** to work. (= She **is driving** ...)

This means: she is driving *now*, at the time of speaking.
The action is not finished.

am/is/are + -ing is the *present continuous*:

I	am	(= I'm)	driving
he/she/it	is	(= he's etc.)	working
we/you/they	are	(= we're etc.)	doing etc.



B I am doing something = I started doing it and I haven't finished; I'm in the middle of doing it.

- ☐ Please don't make so much noise. I'm **trying** to work. (*not* I try)
- ☐ 'Where's Mark?' 'He's **having** a shower.' (*not* He has a shower)
- ☐ Let's go out now. It **isn't raining** any more. (*not* It doesn't rain)
- ☐ How's your new job? **Are** you **enjoying** it?
- ☐ What's all that noise? What's **going** on? or What's **happening**?

Sometimes the action is not happening at the time of speaking. For example:

Steve is talking to a friend on the phone. He says:



I'm reading a really good book at the moment.
It's about a man who ...

Steve says 'I'm reading ...' but he is *not* reading the book at the time of speaking.

He means that he has started reading the book, but has not finished it yet. He is in the middle of reading it.

Some more examples:

- ☐ Kate wants to work in Italy, so she's **learning** Italian.
(but perhaps she isn't learning Italian at the time of speaking)
- ☐ Some friends of mine **are building** their own house. They hope to finish it next summer.

C You can use the present continuous with **today / this week / this year** etc. (periods around now):

- ☐ A: You're **working** hard **today**. (*not* You work hard today)
- B: Yes, I have a lot to do.
- ☐ The company I work for **isn't doing** so well **this year**.

D We use the present continuous when we talk about a change that has started to happen. We often use these verbs in this way:

getting, becoming
starting, beginning

changing, improving
increasing, rising, falling, growing

- ☐ Is your English **getting** better? (*not* Does your English get better)
- ☐ The population of the world **is increasing** very fast. (*not* increases)
- ☐ At first I didn't like my job, but I'm **starting** to enjoy it now. (*not* I start)

Present simple (I do)

A Study this example situation:



Alex is a bus driver, but now he is in bed asleep. He is not driving a bus. (He is asleep.)

but He **drives** a bus. He is a bus driver.

drive(s), work(s), do(es) etc. is the *present simple*:

I/we/you/they	drive/work/do etc.
---------------	---------------------------

he/she/it	drives/works/does etc.
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B We use the present simple to talk about things in general. We use it to say that something happens all the time or repeatedly, or that something is true in general:

- ☐ Nurses **look** after patients in hospitals.
- ☐ I usually **go** away at weekends.
- ☐ The earth **goes** round the sun.
- ☐ The cafe **opens** at 7.30 in the morning.

We say:

I work	but	he works	you go	but	it goes
they teach	but	my sister teaches	I have	but	he has

For spelling (-s or -es), see Appendix 6.

C We use **do/does** to make questions and negative sentences:

do does	I/we/you/they he/she/it	work? drive? do?	I/we/you/they he/she/it	don't doesn't	work drive do
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- ☐ I come from Canada. Where **do** you **come** from?
- ☐ I **don't go** away very often.
- ☐ What **does** this word **mean**? (*not* What means this word?)
- ☐ Rice **doesn't grow** in cold climates.

In the following examples, **do** is also the main verb (do you **do** / doesn't **do** etc.):

- ☐ 'What **do** you **do**?' 'I work in a shop.'
- ☐ He's always so lazy. He **doesn't do** anything to help.

D We use the present simple to say how often we do things:

- ☐ I **get** up at 8 o'clock **every morning**.
- ☐ **How often do** you **go** to the dentist?
- ☐ Julie **doesn't drink** tea **very often**.
- ☐ Robert usually **goes** away **two or three times a year**.

E I promise / I apologise etc.

Sometimes we do things by saying something. For example, when you promise to do something, you can say '**I promise ...**'; when you suggest something, you can say '**I suggest ...**':

- ☐ I **promise** I won't be late. (*not* I'm promising)
- ☐ 'What do **you suggest** I do?' 'I **suggest** that you ...'

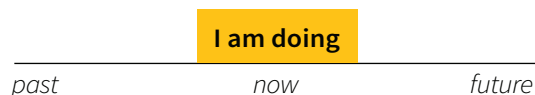
In the same way we say: I **apologise ...** / I **advise ...** / I **insist ...** / I **agree ...** / I **refuse ...** etc.

Present continuous and present simple 1 (I am doing and I do)

A Compare:

present continuous (I am doing)

We use the continuous for things happening at or around the time of speaking. The action is not complete.



- ☐ The water **is boiling**. Be careful.
- ☐ Listen to those people. What language **are they speaking**?
- ☐ Let's go out. It **isn't raining** now.
- ☐ 'I'm busy.' 'What **are you doing**?'
- ☐ I'm **getting** hungry. Let's go and eat.
- ☐ Kate wants to work in Italy, so she's **learning** Italian.
- ☐ The population of the world **is increasing** very fast.

We use the continuous for *temporary* situations (things that continue for a short time):

- ☐ I'm **living** with some friends until I find a place of my own.
- ☐ A: You're **working** hard today.
B: Yes, I have a lot to do.

See Unit 1 for more information.

present simple (I do)

We use the simple for things in general or things that happen repeatedly.



- ☐ Water **boils** at 100 degrees Celsius.
- ☐ Excuse me, **do** you **speak** English?
- ☐ It **doesn't rain** very much in summer.
- ☐ What **do** you usually **do** at weekends?
- ☐ I always **get** hungry in the afternoon.
- ☐ Most people **learn** to swim when they are children.
- ☐ Every day the population of the world **increases** by about 200,000 people.

We use the simple for *permanent* situations (things that continue for a long time):

- ☐ My parents **live** in London. They have lived there all their lives.
- ☐ Joe isn't lazy. He **works** hard most of the time.

See Unit 2 for more information.

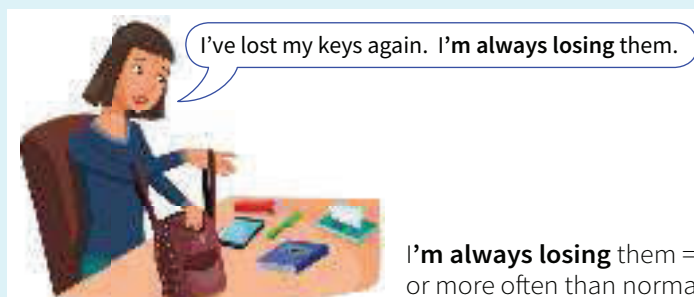
B I always do and I'm always doing

I **always do** something = I do it every time:

- ☐ I **always go** to work by car. (*not* I'm always going)

I'm **always doing** something = I do it too often or more often than normal.

For example:



I'm **always losing** them = I lose them too often, or more often than normal.

- ☐ Paul is never satisfied. He's **always complaining**. (= he complains too much)
- ☐ You're **always looking** at your phone. Don't you have anything else to do?

Present continuous and present simple 2 (I am doing and I do)

A

We use continuous forms (I'm **waiting**, it's **raining** etc.) for actions and happenings that have started but not finished.

Some verbs (for example, **know** and **like**) are not normally used in this way. We don't say 'I am knowing', 'they are liking'. We say 'I **know**', 'they **like**'.

The following verbs are not normally used in the present continuous:

like	want	need	prefer	
know	realise	understand	recognise	
believe	suppose	remember	mean	
belong	fit	contain	consist	seem

- ☐ I'm hungry. I **want** something to eat. (*not* I'm wanting)
- ☐ **Do** you **understand** what I **mean**?
- ☐ Anna **doesn't seem** very happy right now.

B think

When **think** means 'believe' or 'have an opinion', we do not use the continuous:

- ☐ I **think** Mary is Canadian, but I'm not sure. (*not* I'm thinking)
- ☐ What **do** you **think** of my idea? (= what is your opinion?)

When **think** means 'consider', the continuous is possible:

- ☐ I'm **thinking** about what happened. I often **think** about it.
- ☐ Nicky **is thinking** of giving up her job. (= she is considering it)

C

see hear smell taste look feel

We normally use the present simple (not continuous) with **see/hear/smell/taste**:

- ☐ **Do** you **see** that man over there? (*not* are you seeing)
- ☐ The room **smells**. Let's open a window.
- ☐ This soup **doesn't taste** very good.

You can use the present simple or continuous to say how somebody **looks** or **feels** now:

- ☐ You **look** well today. *or* You're **looking** well today.
- ☐ How **do** you **feel** now? *or* How **are** you **feeling** now?

but

- ☐ I usually **feel** tired in the morning. (*not* I'm usually feeling)

D

am/is/are being

You can say **he's being ...**, **you're being ...** etc. to say how somebody is behaving *now*:

- ☐ I can't understand why he's **being** so selfish. He isn't usually like that.
(**being** selfish = behaving selfishly now)
- ☐ 'The path is icy. Don't slip.' 'Don't worry. I'm **being** very careful.'

Compare:

- ☐ He never thinks about other people. He's **very** selfish.
(= he is selfish generally, not only now)
- ☐ I don't like to take risks. I'm **a** very careful person.

We use **am/is/are being** to say how a person is *behaving* (= doing something they can control) now.

It is not usually possible in other situations:

- ☐ Sam **is** ill. (*not* is being ill)
- ☐ **Are** you tired? (*not* are you being tired)

Past simple (I did)

A Study this example:

Wolfgang Amadeus Mozart **was** an Austrian musician and composer. He **lived** from 1756 to 1791. He **started** composing at the age of five and **wrote** more than 600 pieces of music. He **was** only 35 years old when he **died**.

lived/started/wrote/was/died are all *past simple*

B Very often the past simple ends in **-ed** (*regular verbs*):

- ☐ I work in a travel agency now. Before that I **worked** in a department store.
- ☐ They **invited** us to their party, but we **decided** not to go.
- ☐ The police **stopped** me on my way home last night.
- ☐ Laura **passed** her exam because she **studied** very hard.

For spelling (**stopped**, **studied** etc.), see Appendix 6.

But many verbs are *irregular*. The past simple does *not* end in **-ed**. For example:

- | | |
|----------------------|---|
| write → wrote | ☐ Mozart wrote more than 600 pieces of music. |
| see → saw | ☐ We saw Alice in town a few days ago. |
| go → went | ☐ I went to the cinema three times last week. |
| shut → shut | ☐ It was cold, so I shut the window. |

For a list of irregular verbs, see Appendix 1.

C In questions and negative sentences we use **did/didn't** + infinitive (**enjoy/see/go** etc.):

I she they	enjoyed saw went	did	you she they	enjoy? see? go?	I she they	didn't	enjoy see go
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- ☐ I enjoyed the party a lot. **Did** you **enjoy** it?
- ☐ How many people **did** they **invite** to the wedding?
- ☐ I **didn't buy** anything because I **didn't have** any money.
- ☐ 'Did you **go** out?' 'No, I **didn't**.'

Sometimes **do** is the main verb in the sentence (did you **do**?, I didn't **do**):

- ☐ What **did** you **do** at the weekend? (*not* What did you at the weekend?)
- ☐ I **didn't do** anything. (*not* I didn't anything)

D The past of **be** (**am/is/are**) is **was/were**:

I/he/she/it	was/wasn't	was	I/he/she/it?
we/you/they	were/weren't	were	we/you/they?

- ☐ I **was** annoyed because **they were** late.
- ☐ **Was the weather** good when **you were** on holiday?
- ☐ **They weren't** able to come because **they were** so busy.
- ☐ I **wasn't** hungry, so I didn't eat anything.
- ☐ Did you go out last night or **were you** too tired?

Past continuous (I was doing)

A Study this example situation:



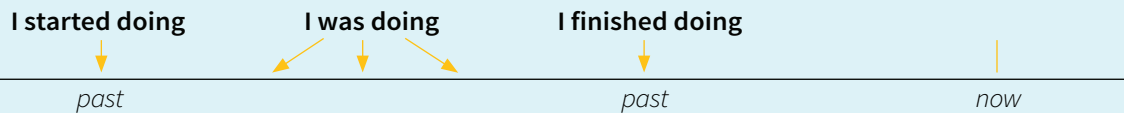
Yesterday Karen and Joe played tennis. They started at 10 o'clock and finished at 11.30.

So, at 10.30 they **were playing** tennis.

they **were playing** =
they were in the middle of playing, they had not finished

was/were + -ing is the past continuous:

he/she/it	was	playing doing
we/you/they	were	working etc.

B **I was doing** something = I was in the middle of doing it at a certain time. The action or situation started before this time, but had not finished:

- ☐ This time last year I **was living** in Hong Kong.
- ☐ What **were** you **doing** at 10 o'clock last night?
- ☐ I waved to Helen, but she **wasn't looking**.

C Compare **I was doing** (*past continuous*) and **I did** (*past simple*):

I was doing (= in the middle of an action)

- ☐ We **were walking** home when I met Dan. (in the middle of walking home)
- ☐ Kate **was watching** TV when we arrived.

I did (= complete action)

- ☐ We **walked** home after the party last night. (= all the way, completely)
- ☐ Kate **watched** TV a lot when she was ill last year.

D You can say that something **happened** (past simple) in the middle of something else (past continuous):

- ☐ Matt **phoned** while we **were having** dinner.
- ☐ It **was raining** when I **got** up.
- ☐ I **saw** you in the park yesterday. You **were sitting** on the grass and **reading** a book.
- ☐ I **hurt** my back while I **was working** in the garden.

But we use the past simple to say that one thing happened *after* another:

- ☐ I **was walking** along the road when I **saw** Dan. So I **stopped**, and we **talked** for a while.

Compare:

- | | |
|--|--|
| ☐ When Karen arrived, we were having dinner. (= we had already started before she arrived) | ☐ When Karen arrived, we had dinner. (= Karen arrived, and then we had dinner) |
|--|--|

E Some verbs (for example, **know** and **want**) are not normally used in continuous forms (**is + -ing**, **was + -ing** etc.). See Unit 4A for a list of these verbs.

- ☐ We were good friends. We **knew** each other well. (*not* we were knowing)
- ☐ I was enjoying the party, but Chris **wanted** to go home. (*not* was wanting)

Present perfect 1 (I have done)

A Study this example situation:



Tom can't find his key.
He's **lost** his key. (= He **has lost** ...)

he **has lost** his key =
he lost it and he doesn't have it now

have lost / **has lost** is the *present perfect simple*:

I/we/they/you	have (= I've etc.)	finished lost done been etc.
he/she/it	has (= he's etc.)	

The present perfect simple is **have/has** + *past participle*. The past participle often ends in **-ed** (finished**ed**/decided**ed** etc.), but many verbs are *irregular* (**lost**/**done**/**written** etc.).

For a list of irregular verbs, see Appendix 1.

B When we say 'something **has happened**', this is usually new information:

- ☐ Ow! I've **cut** my finger.
- ☐ The road is closed. There's **been** an accident. (= There **has been** ...)
- ☐ Police **have arrested** two men in connection with the robbery.

When we use the present perfect, there is a connection with *now*. The action in the past has a result *now*:

- ☐ Tom **has lost** his key. (= he doesn't have it *now*)
- ☐ He told me his name, but I've **forgotten** it. (= I can't remember it *now*)
- ☐ Sally is still here. She **hasn't gone** out. (= she is here *now*)
- ☐ I can't find my bag. **Have** you **seen** it? (= do you know where it is *now*?)

Compare **gone (to)** and **been (to)**:

- ☐ James is on holiday. He **has gone to** Italy. (= he is there now or on his way there)
- ☐ Amy is back home now. She **has been to** Italy. (= she has now come back)

C You can use the present perfect with **just**, **already** and **yet**.

Just = a short time ago:

- ☐ 'Are you hungry?' 'No, I've **just had** lunch.'
- ☐ Hello. **Have** you **just arrived**?

Already = sooner than expected:

- ☐ 'Don't forget to pay the bill.' 'I've **already paid** it.'
- ☐ 'What time is Mark leaving?' 'He's **already left**.'

Yet = until now. We use **yet** to show that we are expecting something to happen.

We use **yet** in questions and negative sentences:

- ☐ **Has** it **stopped** raining **yet**?
- ☐ I've written the email, but I **haven't sent** it **yet**.

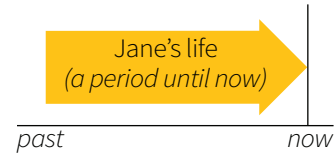
D You can also use the past simple (**did**, **went**, **had** etc.) in the examples on this page. So you can say:

- ☐ Ben isn't here. He's **gone** out. or He **went** out.
- ☐ 'Are you hungry?' 'No, I've **just had** lunch.' or 'No, I **just had** lunch.'

Present perfect 2 (I have done)

A Study this example conversation:

- DAVE: **Have** you **travelled** a lot, Jane?
 JANE: Yes, I've **been** to lots of places.
 DAVE: Really? **Have** you ever **been** to China?
 JANE: Yes, I've **been** to China twice.
 DAVE: What about India?
 JANE: No, I **haven't been** to India.



When we talk about a period of time that continues from the past until now, we use the *present perfect* (**have been** / **have travelled** etc.). Here, Dave and Jane are talking about the places Jane **has visited** in her life, which is a period that continues until now.

In the same way we say:

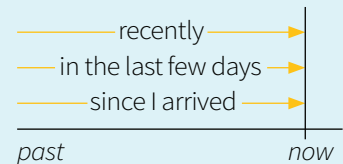
- ☐ **Have** you **ever eaten** caviar?
- ☐ We've never **had** a car.
- ☐ I don't know what the film is about. I **haven't seen** it.
- ☐ Susan really loves that book. She's **read** it three times. (She's = She **has**)
- ☐ It's a really boring movie. It's the most boring movie I've **ever seen**.

been (to) = visited:

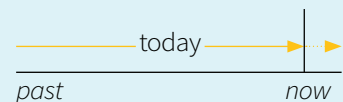
- ☐ I've never **been to** Canada. Have you **been** there?

B In the following examples too, the speakers are talking about a period that continues until now (**recently**, **in the last few days**, **so far**, **since I arrived** etc.):

- ☐ **Have** you **heard** anything from Ben **recently**?
- ☐ I've **met** a lot of people **in the last few days**.
- ☐ Everything is going well. There **haven't been** any problems **so far**.
- ☐ The weather is bad here. It's (= It **has**) **rained** every day **since I arrived**. (= from when I arrived until now)
- ☐ It's good to see you again. We **haven't seen** each other **for a long time**.

In the same way we use the present perfect with **today**, **this evening**, **this year** etc. when these periods are not finished at the time of speaking:

- ☐ I've **drunk** four cups of coffee **today**.
- ☐ **Have** you **had** a holiday **this year**?
- ☐ I **haven't seen** Tom **this morning**. **Have** you?

C We say 'It's the (first) time something **has happened**'. For example:

Don is having a driving lesson. It's his first lesson.
 We can say:

- ☐ It's the first time he **has driven** a car. (*not drives*)
- or He **hasn't driven** a car **before**.
- or He **has never driven** a car **before**.

In the same way we say:

- ☐ Sarah **has lost** her passport again. This is the second time this **has happened**. (*not happens*)
- ☐ Andy is phoning his girlfriend again. It's the third time he's **phoned** her **this evening**.



Present perfect continuous (I have been doing)

A It's been raining.

Study this example situation:



Is it raining?

No, but the ground is wet.

It's been raining. (= It **has** been ...)**have/has been + -ing** is the *present perfect continuous*:I/we/they/you
he/she/it**have
has**(= I've etc.)
(= he's etc.)**been****doing
working
learning** etc.

We use the present perfect continuous for an activity that has recently stopped or just stopped:

- ☐ Why are you out of breath? **Have you been running?**
- ☐ Paul is very tired. **He's been working** hard.
- ☐ Why are you so tired? What **have you been doing?**
- ☐ I've **been talking** to Amanda and she agrees with me.
- ☐ Where have you been? I've **been looking** for you.

have/has been + -ing
present perfect continuous

now

B It's been raining for two hours.

Study this example situation:



It began raining two hours ago and it is still raining.

How long **has it been raining?****It's been raining** for two hours. (= It **has** been ...)We use the present perfect continuous in this way, especially with **how long**, **for ...** and **since ...**. The activity is still happening (as in this example) or has just stopped.

- ☐ **How long have you been learning** English? (= you're still learning English)
- ☐ Ben is watching TV. **He's been watching** TV all day.
- ☐ Where have you been? I've **been looking** for you **for the last half hour**.
- ☐ Chris **hasn't been feeling** well **recently**.

You can use the present perfect continuous for repeated actions:

- ☐ Silvia is a very good tennis player. She's **been playing** **since she was eight**.
- ☐ Every morning they meet in the same cafe. They've **been going** there **for years**.

C Compare I am doing and I have been doing:

I am doing
present continuous

now

- ☐ Don't disturb me now. I'm **working**.
- ☐ We need an umbrella. **It's raining**.
- ☐ Hurry up! We're **waiting**.

I have been doing
present perfect continuous

now

- ☐ I've **been working** hard. Now I'm going to have a break.
- ☐ The ground is wet. **It's been raining**.
- ☐ We've **been waiting** for an hour.

Present perfect continuous and simple (I have been doing and I have done)

A

Compare these two situations:



I've been painting my bedroom.

There is paint on Kate's clothes. She **has been painting** her bedroom.

has been painting is the *present perfect continuous*.

We are thinking of the activity. It does not matter whether it has been finished or not. In this example, the activity (painting the bedroom) has not been finished.



I've painted my bedroom.

The bedroom was green. Now it is yellow. She **has painted** her bedroom.

has painted is the *present perfect simple*.

Here, the important thing is that something has been finished. 'She **has painted**' is a completed action. We are thinking about the *result* of the activity (the painted bedroom), not the activity itself.

B

Compare these examples:

- | | |
|--|---|
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"> ☐ My hands are very dirty. I've been repairing my bike. ☐ Joe has been eating too much recently. He should eat less. ☐ It's nice to see you again. What have you been doing since we last met? ☐ Where have you been? Have you been playing tennis? | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> ☐ My bike is OK again now. I've repaired it. (= I've finished repairing it) ☐ Somebody has eaten all the chocolates. The box is empty. ☐ Where's the book I gave you? What have you done with it? ☐ Have you ever played tennis? |
|--|---|

C

We use the continuous to say *how long* (for something that is still happening):

- ☐ How long **have** you **been reading** that book?
- ☐ Amy is writing emails. She's **been writing** emails all morning.
- ☐ They've **been playing** tennis since 2 o'clock.
- ☐ I'm learning Arabic, but I **haven't been learning** it very long.

We use the simple to say *how much*, *how many* or *how many times* (for completed actions):

- ☐ How many pages of that book **have** you **read**?
- ☐ Amy **has sent** lots of emails this morning.
- ☐ They've **played** tennis three times this week.
- ☐ I'm learning Arabic, but I **haven't learnt** very much yet.

D

Some verbs (for example, **know**) are not normally used in continuous forms (**be + -ing**):

- ☐ I've **known** about the problem for a long time. (*not* I've been knowing)
- ☐ How long **have** you **had** that camera? (*not* have you been having)

For a list of these verbs, see Unit 4A. For **have**, see Unit 17.

But note that you *can* use **want** and **mean** in the present perfect continuous (**have/has been + -ing**):

- ☐ I've **been meaning** to phone Anna, but I keep forgetting.

how long have you (been) ... ?

A Study this example situation:



Dan and Kate are married. They got married exactly 20 years ago, so today is their 20th wedding anniversary.

They **have been** married **for 20 years**.

We say: They **are** married. (*present*)

but How long have they **been** married?
 (not How long are they married?)
 They **have been** married **for 20 years**.
 (not They are married for 20 years)

(*present perfect*)

We use the *present perfect* to talk about something that began in the past and still continues now.

Compare the *present* and *present perfect*:

- ☐ Paul is in hospital.
- but He's **been** in hospital **since Monday**. (= He **has** been ...)
(not Paul is in hospital since Monday)
- ☐ We **know** each other very well.
- but We've **known** each other **for a long time**.
(not We know)
- ☐ Do they **have** a car?
- but How long **have** they **had** their car?
- ☐ She's **waiting** for somebody.
- but She **hasn't been** waiting very long.

present
 he is
 we know
 do they have
 she is waiting

present perfect
 he has been
 we have known
 have they had
 she has been waiting

past now

B I've known / I've had / I've lived etc. is the *present perfect simple*.
 I've been learning / I've been waiting etc. is the *present perfect continuous*.

When we ask or say 'how long', the continuous is more usual (see Unit 10):

- ☐ I've **been learning** English **since January**.
- ☐ It's **been raining** **all morning**.
- ☐ Richard **has been doing** the same job **for 20 years**.
- ☐ 'How long **have** you **been driving**?' 'Since I was 17.'

Some verbs (for example, **know** and **like**) are not normally used in the continuous:

- ☐ How long **have** you **known** Jane? (not have you been knowing)
- ☐ I've **had** these shoes for ages. (not I've been having)

See also Units 4A and 10C. For **have**, see Unit 17.

C You can use either the continuous or simple with **live** and **work**:

- ☐ Julia **has been living** in this house for a long time. or Julia **has lived** ...
- ☐ How long **have** you **been working** here? or How long **have** you **worked** here?

But we use the simple (**have lived** etc.) with **always**:

- ☐ I've **always lived** in the country. (not always been living)

D We say 'I haven't (done something) **since/for** ...' (*present perfect simple*):

- ☐ I **haven't seen** Tom **since Monday**. (= Monday was the last time I saw him)
- ☐ Sarah **hasn't phoned** for ages. (= the last time she phoned was ages ago)

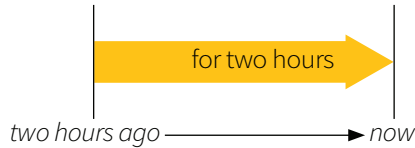
for and since when ... ? and how long ... ?

A

We use **for** and **since** to say how long something has been happening.

We use **for** + a period of time:

- ☐ We've been waiting **for two hours**.



for		
two hours	a long time	a week
20 minutes	six months	ages
five days	50 years	years

- ☐ Sally has been working here **for six months**. (*not since six months*)
- ☐ I haven't seen Tom **for three days**.

We use **since** + the start of a period:

- ☐ We've been waiting **since 8 o'clock**.



since		
8 o'clock	April	lunchtime
Monday	2001	we arrived
12 May	Christmas	I got up

- ☐ Sally has been working here **since April**. (= from April until now)
- ☐ I haven't seen Tom **since Monday**.

B

We often leave out **for** (but not usually in negative sentences):

- ☐ They've been married **for ten years**. or They've been married **ten years**.
- ☐ They **haven't had** a holiday **for** ten years. (you need **for**)

You can use **in** instead of **for** in negative sentences (**I haven't ... etc.**):

- ☐ They **haven't had** a holiday **in ten years**. (= **for** ten years)

We do *not* use **for** + **all ...** (**all day** / **all my life** etc.):

- ☐ I've lived here **all my life**. (*not for all my life*)

C

Compare **when ... ?** (+ *past simple*) and **how long ... ?** (+ *present perfect*):



A: **When** did it start raining?

B: It started raining **an hour ago** / **at 1 o'clock**.

A: **How long** has it been raining?

B: It's been raining **for an hour** / **since 1 o'clock**.



A: **When** did Joe and Kate first meet?

B: They first met { **a long time ago**.
when they were at school.

A: **How long** have they known each other?

B: They've known each other { **for a long time**.
since they were at school.

D

We say:

it's (= it is)	a long time	since something happened
or it's been (= it has been)	six months (etc.)	

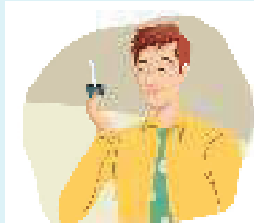
- ☐ **It's two years since** I last saw Joe. or **It's been two years since ...**
(= I **haven't seen** Joe for two years)
- ☐ **It's ages since** we went to the cinema. or **It's been ages since ...**
(= We **haven't been** to the cinema for ages)
- ☐ **How long is it since** Mrs Hill died? or **How long has it been since ...**
(= when did she die?)

Present perfect and past 1 (**I have done** and **I did**)**A** Study this example situation:

Tom is looking for his key. He can't find it.

He **has lost** his key. (*present perfect*)This means that he doesn't have his key *now*.

Ten minutes later:

Now Tom **has found** his key. He has it now.**Has** he **lost** his key? No, he **has found** it.**Did** he **lose** his key? Yes, he **did**.He **lost** his key (*past simple*)but now he **has found** it. (*present perfect*)

The *present perfect* (something **has happened**) is a *present* tense. It tells us about the situation *now*.
 'Tom **has lost** his key' = he doesn't have his key *now* (see Unit 7).

The *past simple* (something **happened**) tells us only about the *past*. If somebody says 'Tom **lost** his key', we don't know whether he has the key now or not. We know only that he lost it at some time in the past.

Compare *present perfect* and *past simple*:

- ☐ They've **gone** away. They'll be back on Friday. (they are away *now*)
- ☐ They **went** away, but I think they're back at home now. (*not* They've gone away)
- ☐ It **has stopped** raining now, so we don't need the umbrella. (it isn't raining *now*)
- ☐ It **stopped** raining for a while, but now it's raining again. (*not* It has stopped)

B You can use the present perfect for new or recent happenings:

- ☐ I've **repaired** the washing machine. It's working OK now.
- ☐ 'Hannah **has had** a baby! It's a boy.' 'That's great news.'

Usually, you can also use the past simple:

- ☐ I **repaired** the washing machine. It's working OK now.

Use the past simple (*not* the present perfect) for things that are not recent or new:

- ☐ Mozart **was** a composer. He **wrote** more than 600 pieces of music.
(*not* has been ... has written)
- ☐ My mother **grew** up in Italy. (*not* has grown)

Compare:

Somebody **has invented** a new type of washing machine.
 Who **invented** the telephone? (*not* has invented)

C We use the present perfect to give new information (see Unit 7). But if we continue to talk about it, we normally use the past simple:

- ☐ A: Ow! I've **burnt** myself.
 B: How **did** you **do** that? (*not* have you done)
 A: I **picked** up a hot dish. (*not* have picked)
- ☐ A: Look! Somebody **has spilt** something on the sofa.
 B: Well, it **wasn't** me. I **didn't do** it. (*not* hasn't been ... haven't done)

Present perfect and past 2 (**I have done** and **I did**)

A

We do not use the present perfect (**I have done**) when we talk about a *finished* time (for example, **yesterday** / **last year** / **ten minutes ago** etc.). We use a past tense:

- ☐ It **was** very cold **yesterday**. (*not has been*)
- ☐ Paul and Lucy **arrived ten minutes ago**. (*not have arrived*)
- ☐ **Did you eat** a lot of sweets **when you were a child**? (*not have you eaten*)
- ☐ I **got** home late **last night**. I **was** very tired and **went** straight to bed.

Use the past to ask **When ... ?** or **What time ... ?**:

- ☐ **When did** your friends **arrive**? (*not have ... arrived*)
- ☐ **What time did** you **finish** work?

Compare:

Present perfect

- ☐ Tom **has lost** his key. He can't get into the house.
- ☐ Is Carla here or **has she left**?

Past simple

- ☐ Tom **lost** his key **yesterday**. He couldn't get into the house.
- ☐ **When did** Carla **leave**?

B

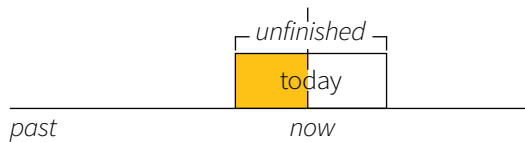
Compare:

Present perfect (have done)

- ☐ I've **done** a lot of work **today**.

We use the present perfect for a period of time that continues *until now*. For example:

today / **this week** / **since 2010**.



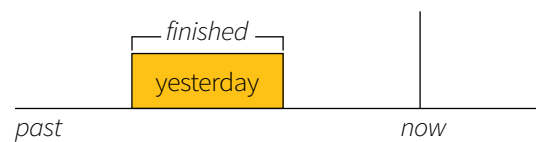
- ☐ It **hasn't** rained **this week**.
- ☐ **Have you seen** Anna **this morning**? (it is still morning now)
- ☐ **Have you seen** Ben **recently**? (in the last few days or weeks)
- ☐ I've **been working** here **since 2010**. (I still work here now)
- ☐ I don't know where Lisa is. I **haven't seen** her. (= I haven't seen her recently)
- ☐ We've **been waiting** for an hour. (we are still waiting now)
- ☐ Jack lives in Los Angeles. He **has lived** there for seven years.
- ☐ I've **never ridden** a horse. (in my life)
- ☐ It's the last day of your holiday. You say: It's **been** a really good holiday. I've really **enjoyed** it.

Past simple (did)

- ☐ I **did** a lot of work **yesterday**.

We use the past simple for a *finished* time in the past. For example:

yesterday / **last week** / **from 2010 to 2014**.



- ☐ It **didn't** rain **last week**.
- ☐ **Did you see** Anna **this morning**? (it is now afternoon or evening)
- ☐ **Did you see** Ben **on Sunday**?
- ☐ I **worked** here **from 2010 to 2014**. (I don't work here now)
- ☐ A: **Was** Lisa at the party **on Sunday**?
B: I don't think so. I **didn't see** her.
- ☐ We **waited** (*or were waiting*) for an hour. (we are no longer waiting)
- ☐ Jack **lived** in New York for ten years. Now he lives in Los Angeles.
- ☐ I **never rode** a bike **when I was a child**.
- ☐ After you come back from holiday you say: It **was** a really good holiday. I really **enjoyed** it.

Past perfect (I had done)

A Study this example situation:



Sarah and Paul went to the same party last week, but they didn't see each other. Paul left the party at 10.30 and Sarah arrived at 11 o'clock.

So when Sarah arrived at the party, Paul wasn't there.

He **had gone** home.

had gone is the *past perfect*:

I/we/they/you he/she/it	had	(= I'd etc.) (= he'd etc.)	gone seen finished etc.
----------------------------	------------	-------------------------------	--

The past perfect (simple) is **had** + *past participle* (**gone/seen/finished** etc.).

Sometimes we talk about something that happened in the past:

- ☐ Sarah **arrived** at the party.

This is the starting point of the story. Then, if we want to talk about things that happened *before* this time, we use the past perfect (**had** ...):

- ☐ **When Sarah arrived** at the party, Paul **had** already **gone** home.

Some more examples:

- ☐ When we got home last night, we found that somebody **had broken** into the flat.
- ☐ Karen didn't come to the cinema with us. She'd already **seen** the movie.
- ☐ At first I thought I'd **done** the right thing, but I soon realised that I'd **made** a big mistake.
- ☐ The people sitting next to me on the plane were nervous. They **hadn't flown** before.
or They'd never **flown** before.

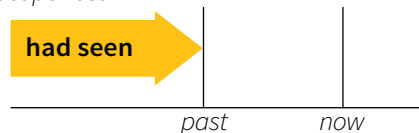
B Compare *present perfect* (**have seen** etc.) and *past perfect* (**had seen** etc.):

Present perfect



- ☐ Who is that woman? I've **seen** her before, but I can't remember where.
- ☐ We aren't hungry. We've just **had** lunch.
- ☐ The house is dirty. They **haven't cleaned** it for weeks.

Past perfect



- ☐ I wasn't sure who she was. I'd **seen** her before, but I couldn't remember where.
- ☐ We weren't hungry. We'd just **had** lunch.
- ☐ The house was dirty. They **hadn't cleaned** it for weeks.

C Compare *past simple* (**left, was** etc.) and *past perfect* (**had left, had been** etc.):

Past simple

- ☐ A: Was Tom there when you arrived?
B: Yes, but he **left** soon afterwards.
- ☐ Kate **wasn't** at home when I phoned.
She **was** at her mother's house.

Past perfect

- ☐ A: Was Tom there when you arrived?
B: No, he'd already **left**.
- ☐ Kate **had** just **got** home when I phoned.
She'd **been** at her mother's house.

Past perfect continuous (I had been doing)

A Study this example situation:

yesterday morning



Yesterday morning I got up and looked out of the window.
The sun was shining, but the ground was very wet.

It **had been raining**.

It was *not* raining when I looked out of the window.
The sun was shining. But it **had been raining** before.

had been -ing is the *past perfect continuous*:

I/we/you/they he/she/it	had	(= I'd etc.) (= he'd etc.)	been	doing working playing etc.
----------------------------	------------	-------------------------------	-------------	---

Some more examples:

- ☐ My hands were dirty because I'd **been repairing** my bike.
- ☐ Tom was tired when he got home. He'd **been working** hard all day.
- ☐ I went to Madrid a few years ago and stayed with a friend of mine. **She hadn't been living** there very long, but she knew the city very well.

You can say that something **had been happening** before something else happened:

- ☐ We'd **been playing** tennis for about half an hour when it **started** to rain heavily.

B Compare **have been -ing** (*present perfect continuous*) and **had been -ing** (*past perfect continuous*):

Present perfect continuous



- ☐ I hope the bus comes soon. I've **been waiting** for 20 minutes. (*before now*)
- ☐ James **is** out of breath. He's **been running**. (= he **has** been ...)

Past perfect continuous



- ☐ At last the bus came. I'd **been waiting** for 20 minutes. (*before the bus came*)
- ☐ James **was** out of breath. He'd **been running**. (= he **had** been ...)

C Compare **was -ing** (*past continuous*) and **had been -ing**:

- ☐ It **wasn't raining** when we went out. The sun **was shining**. But it **had been raining**, so the ground was wet.
- ☐ Katherine **was lying** on the sofa. She was tired because she'd **been working** hard.

D Some verbs (for example, **know**) are not normally used in *continuous* forms (**be + -ing**):

- ☐ We were good friends. We **had known** each other for years. (*not had been knowing*)
- ☐ A few years ago Lisa cut her hair really short. I was surprised because she'd always **had** long hair. (*not she'd been having*)

For a list of these verbs, see **Unit 4A**. For **have**, see **Unit 17**

have and have got

A have and have got (= for possession, relationships, illnesses, appointments etc.)

You can use **have** or **have got**. There is no difference in meaning. You can say:

- ☐ They **have** a new car. or They **'ve got** a new car.
- ☐ Lisa **has** two brothers. or Lisa **has got** two brothers.
- ☐ I **have** a headache. or I **'ve got** a headache.
- ☐ Our house **has** a small garden. or Our house **has got** a small garden.
- ☐ He **has** a few problems. or He **'s got** a few problems.
- ☐ I **have** a driving lesson tomorrow. or I **'ve got** a driving lesson tomorrow.

With these meanings (possession etc.), we do not use continuous forms (**I'm having** etc.):

- ☐ We're enjoying our holiday. We **have** / We **'ve got** a nice room in the hotel.
(not We're having a nice room)

For the past we use **had** (usually without **got**):

- ☐ Lisa **had** long hair when she was a child. (not Lisa had got)

B In questions and negative sentences there are three possible forms:

Do you have any questions?	I don't have any questions.
or Have you got any questions?	or I haven't got any questions.
or Have you any questions? (less usual)	or I haven't any questions. (less usual)
Does she have a car?	She doesn't have a car.
or Has she got a car?	or She hasn't got a car.
or Has she a car? (less usual)	or She hasn't a car. (less usual)

In past questions and negative sentences, we use **did/didn't**:

- ☐ **Did you have** a car when you were living in Paris?
- ☐ I **didn't have** my phone, so I couldn't call you.
- ☐ Lisa **had** long hair, **didn't** she?

C have breakfast / have a shower / have a good time etc.

We also use **have** (but not have got) for things we do or experience. For example:

have	breakfast / dinner / a cup of coffee / something to eat etc. a bath / a shower / a swim / a break / a rest / a party / a holiday an accident / an experience / a dream a look (at something) a chat / a discussion / a conversation (with somebody) trouble / difficulty / fun / a good time etc. a baby (= give birth to a baby)
-------------	--

Have got is *not* possible in these expressions. Compare:

- ☐ Sometimes I **have** (= eat) a sandwich for my lunch. (not I've got)
- but I **'ve got** / I **have** some sandwiches. Would you like one?

You can use continuous forms (**I'm having** etc.) with these expressions:

- ☐ We're enjoying our holiday. We **'re having** a great time.
- ☐ 'Where's Mark?' 'He **'s having** a shower.'

In questions and negative sentences we use **do/does/did**:

- ☐ I **don't** usually **have** a big breakfast. (not I usually haven't)
- ☐ Where **does** Chris usually **have** lunch?
- ☐ **Did you have** trouble finding somewhere to stay? (not Had you)

A Study this example situation:

a few years ago

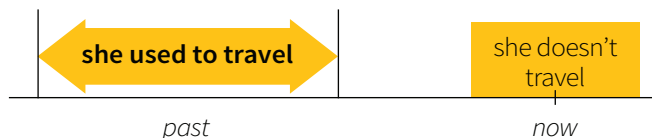


these days

Nicola doesn't travel much these days.
She prefers to stay at home.

But she **used to travel** a lot.
She **used to go** away two or three times a year.

She **used to travel** a lot = she travelled often in the past, but she doesn't do this any more.



B I **used to** do something = I did it often in the past, but not any more:

- ☐ I **used to play** tennis a lot, but I don't play very much now.
- ☐ David **used to spend** a lot of money on clothes. These days he can't afford it.
- ☐ 'Do you go to the cinema much?' 'Not now, but I **used to**.' (= I used to go)

We also use **used to** ... for things that were true, but are not true any more:

- ☐ This building is now a furniture shop. It **used to be** a cinema.
- ☐ I **used to think** Mark was unfriendly, but now I realise he's a very nice person.
- ☐ I've started drinking coffee recently. I never **used to like** it before.
- ☐ Lisa **used to have** very long hair when she was a child.

C 'I **used to** do something' is past. There is no present. You cannot say 'I use to do'. To talk about the present, we use the present simple (I **do**).

Compare:

past	he used to play	we used to live	there used to be
present	he plays	we live	there is

- ☐ We **used to live** in a small village, but now we **live** in a city.
- ☐ There **used to be** four cinemas in the town. Now there **is** only one.

D The normal question form is **did** (you) **use to** ... ? :

- ☐ **Did** you **use to eat** a lot of sweets when you were a child? (= did you do this often?)

The negative form is **didn't use to** ... (**used not to** ... is also possible):

- ☐ I **didn't use to like** him. (or I **used not to like** him.)

E Compare I **used to do** and I **was doing**:

- ☐ I **used to watch** TV a lot. (= I watched TV often in the past, but I don't do this any more)
- ☐ I **was watching** TV when Rob called. (= I was in the middle of watching TV)

F Do not confuse I **used to do** and I **am used to doing** (see Unit 61). The structures and meanings are different:

- ☐ I **used to live** alone. (= I lived alone in the past, but I no longer live alone.)
- ☐ I **am used to living** alone. (= I live alone, and it's not a problem for me because I've lived alone for some time.)

Present tenses (**I am doing / I do**) for the future**A** Present continuous (**I am doing**) with a future meaning

This is Ben's diary for next week.

He **is playing** tennis on Monday afternoon.

He **is going** to the dentist on Tuesday morning.

He **is meeting** Kate on Friday.

In all these examples, Ben has already decided and arranged to do these things.

I'm doing something (tomorrow etc.) = I have already decided and arranged to do it:

- ☐ A: What **are you doing** on Saturday evening? (*not* What do you do)
- ☐ B: **I'm going** to the cinema. (*not* I go)
- ☐ A: What time **is** Katherine **arriving** tomorrow?
- ☐ B: Half past ten. We **'re meeting** her at the station.
- ☐ **I'm not working** tomorrow, so we can go out somewhere.
- ☐ Steve **isn't playing** football next Saturday. He's hurt his leg.

We do not normally use **will** to talk about what we have arranged to do:

- ☐ What **are you doing** tonight? (*not* What will you do)
- ☐ Alex **is getting** married next month. (*not* will get)

We also use the present continuous for an action *just before you start to do it*. This happens especially with verbs of movement (**go/come/leave** etc.):

- ☐ I'm tired. **I'm going** to bed now. Goodnight. (*not* I go to bed now)
- ☐ 'Tina, are you ready yet?' 'Yes, **I'm coming**.' (*not* I come)

B Present simple (**I do**) with a future meaning

We use the present simple when we talk about timetables and programmes (for example, transport or cinema times):

- ☐ I have to go. My train **leaves** at 11.30.
- ☐ What time **does** the film **start** tonight?
- ☐ The meeting **is** at nine o'clock tomorrow.

You can use the present simple to talk about people if their plans are fixed like a timetable:

- ☐ I **start** my new job on Monday.
- ☐ What time **do** you **finish** work tomorrow?

But the continuous is more usual for other personal arrangements:

- ☐ What time **are you meeting** Kate tomorrow? (*not* do you meet)

Compare:

Present continuous

- ☐ What time **are you arriving**?
- ☐ **I'm going** to the cinema this evening.

Present simple

- ☐ What time **does** the train **arrive**?
- ☐ The film **starts** at 8.15.

When you talk about appointments, lessons, exams etc., you can use **I have** or **I've got**:

- ☐ **I have** an exam next week. or **I've got** an exam next week.

I'm going to (do)

A

I **am going to do** something = I have already decided to do it, I intend to do it:

- ☐ 'Are you **going to eat** anything?' 'No, I'm not hungry.'
- ☐ A: I hear Sarah won the lottery. What **is** she **going to do** with the money?
B: She's **going to buy** a new car.
- ☐ I'm just **going to make** a quick phone call. Can you wait for me?
- ☐ This cheese smells horrible. I'm **not going to eat** it.

B

I **am doing** and I **am going to do**

I **am doing** = it is *already fixed or arranged*. For example, you have arranged to go somewhere or meet somebody:

- ☐ I'm **leaving** next week. I've booked my flight.
- ☐ What time **are** you **meeting** Emily this evening?

I **am going to do** something = I've decided to do it. Maybe I've arranged to do it, maybe not.

- ☐ A: Your shoes are dirty.
B: Yes, I know. I'm **going to clean** them.
(= I've *decided* to clean them, but I haven't arranged this with anybody)
- ☐ I don't want to stay here. Tomorrow I'm **going to look** for somewhere else to stay.

Compare:

- ☐ I don't know what I'm **doing** tomorrow. (= I don't know my schedule or plans)
- ☐ I don't know what I'm **going to do** about the problem. (= I haven't decided what to do)

Often the difference is small and either form is possible.

C

You can also say that 'something **is going to happen**' in the future. For example:



Some more examples:

- ☐ Look at those black clouds! It's **going to rain**. (we can see the clouds *now*)
- ☐ I feel terrible. I think I'm **going to be** sick. (I feel terrible *now*)
- ☐ The economic situation is bad now and things **are going to get** worse.

D

I **was going to do** something = I intended to do it, but didn't do it:

- ☐ We **were going to travel** by train, but then we decided to drive instead.
- ☐ I **was** just **going to cross** the road when somebody shouted 'Stop!'

You can say that 'something **was going to happen**' (but didn't happen):

- ☐ I thought it **was going to rain**, but it didn't.

A We use **I'll ... (= I will)** when we've just decided to do something. When we say '**I'll** do something', we announce our decision:

- ☐ Oh, I left the door open. **I'll go** and shut it.
- ☐ 'What would you like to drink?' '**I'll have** orange juice, please.'
- ☐ 'Did you call Max?' 'Oh no, I forgot. **I'll call** him now.'

We do not use the *present simple* (**I do / I go** etc.) in these sentences:

- ☐ **I'll phone** him now. (*not* I phone him now)

We often use **I think I'll ... / I don't think I'll ...**:

- ☐ I'm a little hungry. **I think I'll have** something to eat.
- ☐ **I don't think I'll go** out tonight. I'm too tired.

In spoken English **will not** is usually **won't**:

- ☐ I can see you're busy, so **I won't stay** long. (= I will not stay long)

B We often use **I'll** in these situations:

Offering to do something

- ☐ That bag looks heavy. **I'll help** you with it. (*not* I help)

Agreeing to do something

- ☐ A: Can you give Tom this book?
B: Sure, **I'll give** it to him when I see him this afternoon.

Promising to do something

- ☐ Thanks for lending me the money. **I'll pay** you back on Friday.
- ☐ **I won't tell** anyone what happened. I promise.



We use **won't** to say that somebody refuses to do something:

- ☐ I've tried to give her advice, but she **won't listen**.
- ☐ The car **won't start**. (= the car 'refuses' to start)

Will you (do something)? = please do it:

- ☐ **Will you** please turn the music down? It's too loud.

The car **won't start**.



C We do *not* use **will** to talk about what has been decided or arranged before:

- ☐ **I'm going** on holiday next Saturday. (*not* I'll go)

Compare:

- ☐ **I'm meeting** Kate tomorrow morning. (decided before)
- ☐ A: **I'll meet** you at half past ten, OK?
B: Fine. See you then. (decided now)

D We use **shall** mostly in the questions **shall I ... ? / shall we ... ?**

We use **shall I ... ? / shall we ... ?** to ask if it's OK to do something or to ask for a suggestion:

- ☐ **Shall I** open the window? (= do you want me to open it?)
- ☐ I've got no money. What **shall I** do? (= what do you suggest?)
- ☐ '**Shall we** go?' 'Just a minute. I'm not ready yet.'
- ☐ 'Where **shall we** have lunch?' 'Let's go to Marino's.'

Compare **shall I ... ?** and **will you ... ?**:

- ☐ **Shall I** shut the door? (= do you want me to shut it?)
- ☐ **Will you** shut the door? (= I want you to shut it)

A

We do *not* use **will** to say what somebody has *already arranged or decided* to do:

- ☐ Lisa **is working** next week. (*not* Lisa will work)
- ☐ **Are you going to watch** TV this evening? (*not* will you watch)

See Units 19–20.

We use **will** to say what we know or believe about the future (not what someone has already decided).
For example:

Kate has her driving test next week.
Chris and Joe are talking about it.

Do you think
Kate **will pass**?

CHRIS



JOE

Yes, she's a good driver.
She'll **pass** easily.

Joe believes that Kate **will pass** the driving test.
He is *predicting* the future.

When we predict a future happening or situation, we use **will/won't**.

Some more examples:

- ☐ They've been away a long time. When they return, they'll **find** a lot of changes here.
- ☐ 'Where **will** you **be** this time next year?' 'I'll **be** in Japan.'
- ☐ That plate is hot. If you touch it, you'll **burn** yourself.
- ☐ Anna looks completely different now. You **won't recognise** her.
- ☐ When **will** you **get** your exam results?

Compare:

- ☐ I think James **is going** to the party on Friday. (= I think he has already decided to go)
- ☐ I think James **will go** to the party on Friday. (= I think he will decide to go)

B

We often use **will** ('ll) with:

- | | |
|----------------------|--|
| probably | ☐ I'll probably be home late tonight. |
| I'm sure | ☐ Don't worry about the exam. I'm sure you'll pass. |
| I think | ☐ Do you think Sarah will like the present we bought her? |
| I don't think | ☐ I don't think the exam will be very difficult. |
| I wonder | ☐ I wonder what will happen. |

After **I hope**, we generally use the present:

- ☐ I hope Kate **passes** the driving test.
- ☐ I hope it **doesn't rain** tomorrow.

C

Generally we use **will** to talk about *the future*, but sometimes we use **will** to talk about *now*:

- ☐ Don't phone Amy now. She'll **be** busy. (= she'll be busy *now*)

D

Normally we use **shall** only with **I** and **we**. You can say:

I shall or **I will** (I'll) **we shall** or **we will** (we'll)

- ☐ **I shall** be late this evening. (*or* **I will** be)
- ☐ **We shall** probably go to France in June. (*or* **We will** probably go)

In spoken English we normally use **I'll** and **we'll**:

- ☐ **We'll** probably go to France.

The negative of **shall** is **shall not** or **shan't**:

- ☐ I **shan't** be here tomorrow. (*or* **I won't** be)

We do not normally use **shall** with **he/she/it/you/they**:

- ☐ She **will** be very angry. (*not* She shall be)

I will and I'm going to

A

Future actions

Compare **will** and **(be) going to**:

Sarah is talking to Helen:

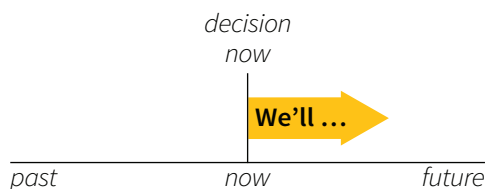
Let's have a party.

That's a great idea.
We'll invite lots of people.

SARAH



HELEN

will (We'll invite ...)We use **will** (We'll invite ...) to announce a new decision. The party is a new idea.

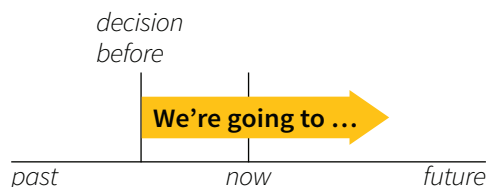
Later that day, Helen meets Max:

Sarah and I have decided to have a party.
We're going to invite lots of people.

HELEN



MAX

(be) going to (We're going to invite ...)We use **(be) going to** when we have *already decided* to do something. Helen had already decided to invite lots of people *before* she spoke to Max.

Compare:

- ☐ 'Gary has been trying to contact you.' 'Has he? OK, I'll call him.'
- 'Gary has been trying to contact you.' 'Yes, I know. I'm going to call him.'
- ☐ 'Anna is in hospital.' 'Really? I didn't know. I'll go and visit her.'
- 'Anna is in hospital.' 'Yes, I know. I'm going to visit her this evening.'

B

Future happenings and situations (predicting the future)

We use both **will** and **going to** for future happenings and situations. So you can say:

- ☐ I think the weather **will be** nice later. *or*
I think the weather **is going to be** nice later.
- ☐ Those shoes are well-made. They'll last a long time. *or*
Those shoes are well-made. They're going to last a long time.

When we say something **is going to** happen, we believe this because of the situation *now*. What is happening *now* shows that something **is going to** happen in the future. For example:

- ☐ Look at those black clouds. It's going to rain. (*not* it will rain)
(we can see that it **is going to rain** – the black clouds are in the sky *now*)

Compare:

- ☐ We're going to be late. The meeting starts in five minutes and it takes 15 minutes to get there.
(it is clear *now* that we don't have enough time to get there)
- ☐ Jane **will be** late for the meeting. She's always late.
(I believe this because I know what Jane is like)

will be doing and will have done

A Study this example situation:

These people are standing in a queue to get into the cinema.



now

Half an hour from now, the cinema will be full. Everyone **will be watching** the film.



half an hour from now

Three hours from now, the cinema will be empty. The film **will have finished**. Everyone **will have gone** home.



three hours from now

B I **will be doing** something (*future continuous*) = I will be in the middle of doing it:

- ☐ This time next week I'll be on holiday. I'll **be lying** on the beach or **swimming** in the sea.
- ☐ You have no chance of getting the job. You'll **be wasting** your time if you apply.

Compare **will be (do)ing** and **will (do)**:

- ☐ Don't phone between 7 and 8. We'll **be eating**.
- ☐ Let's wait for Liz to arrive and then we'll **eat**.

Compare:

- ☐ At 10 o'clock yesterday, Tina **was** in her office. She **was working**. (*past continuous*)
- It's 10 o'clock now. She **is** in her office. She **is working**. (*present continuous*)
- At 10 o'clock tomorrow, she **will be** in her office. She **will be working**. (*future continuous*)

C We also use **will be -ing** to talk about complete actions in the future. For example:

- ☐ The government **will be making** a statement about the crisis later today.
- ☐ Later in the programme, I'll **be talking** to the Minister of Education.
- ☐ The team's star player is injured and **won't be playing** in the game on Saturday.

When we use it in this way, **will be (doing)** is similar to **will (do)** and **going to (do)**.

Later in the programme, I'll **be talking** to ...

D I **will have done** something (*future perfect*) = it will be complete before a time in the future. For example:

- ☐ Sally always leaves for work at 8.30 in the morning. She won't be at home at 9 o'clock – she'll **have gone** to work.
- ☐ We're late. The film **will already have started** by the time we get to the cinema.

Compare:

- ☐ Ted and Amy **have been** married for 24 years. (*present perfect*)
- Next year they **will have been** married for 25 years. (*future perfect*)
- When their son was born, they **had been** married for three years. (*past perfect*)

A

Study this example:

Amy is on a train. She's calling a friend.

I'll call you again later **when I arrive**.



'I'll call you again later when I arrive' is a sentence with two parts:

the main part: I'll call you again later
and **when** ...: when I arrive

The time is *future* ('later'), but Amy says:

... **when I arrive** (*not* when I will arrive)

We say

when I do something (*not* will do)

when something **happens** (*not* will happen)

Some more examples:

- ☐ We'll go out **when it stops** raining. (*not* when it will stop)
- ☐ **When you are** here again, you must come and see us. (*not* When you will be)
- ☐ Don't forget to lock the door **when you go** out. (*not* will go)

The same thing happens after **while** / **before** / **after** / **as soon as** / **until**:

- ☐ What are you going to do **while I'm** away? (*not* while I will be)
- ☐ **Before you go**, there's something I want to ask you.
- ☐ Wait here **until I come** back. or ... **till I come** back.

B

You can also use the *present perfect* (**have done**) after **when** / **after** / **until** / **as soon as**:

- ☐ Can I have the newspaper **when you've finished** with it?
- ☐ Don't say anything while Ian is here. Wait **until he has gone**.

We use the present perfect to show that one thing is complete *before* the other. The two things do *not* happen together:

- ☐ **When I've phoned** Kate, we can go out.
(= first I'll phone Kate and *after that* we can go out)

Do not use the present perfect if the two things happen together:

- ☐ **When I phone** Kate, I'll ask her about the party. (*not* when I've phoned)

It is often possible to use either the present simple or the present perfect:

- ☐ I'll come **as soon as I finish**. or I'll come **as soon as I've finished**.
- ☐ You'll feel better **after you have** something to eat. or You'll feel better **after you've had** something to eat.

C

if and when

After **if**, we normally use the present (**if I do** / **if I see** etc.) for the future:

- ☐ I'll be angry **if it happens** again. (*not* if it will happen)
- ☐ Hurry up! **If we don't** hurry, we'll be late.

We use **if** (*not* when) for things that will *possibly* happen (or not happen):

- ☐ **If** it is raining this evening, I won't go out. (*not* when it is raining)
- ☐ Don't worry **if** I'm late tonight. (*not* when I'm late)
- ☐ **If** they don't come soon, I'm not going to wait for them.

We use **when** for things which are *sure* to happen. Compare:

- ☐ I might go out later. (*it's possible*) **If** I go out, I'll get some bread.
- ☐ I'm going out later. (*for sure*) **When** I go out, I'll get some bread.

can, could and (be) able to

A

We use **can** to say that something is possible or allowed, or that somebody has the ability to do something. We use **can + infinitive** (**can do / can see** etc.):

- ☐ We **can see** the lake from our hotel.
- ☐ 'I don't have a pen.' 'You **can use** mine.'
- ☐ **Can** you **speak** any foreign languages?
- ☐ I **can come** and see you tomorrow if you like.
- ☐ The word 'dream' **can be** a noun or a verb.

The negative is **can't** (= **cannot**):

- ☐ I'm afraid I **can't come** to the party on Friday.

B

You can say that somebody **is able to** do something, but **can** is more usual:

- ☐ We **are able to see** the lake from our hotel.

But **can** has only two forms: **can** (*present*) and **could** (*past*). So sometimes it is necessary to use **(be) able to**. Compare:

- | | |
|--|---|
| ☐ I can't sleep. | ☐ I haven't been able to sleep recently. |
| ☐ Tom can come tomorrow. | ☐ Tom might be able to come tomorrow. |
| ☐ Maria can speak French, Spanish and English. | ☐ Applicants for the job must be able to speak two foreign languages. |

C

Sometimes **could** is the past of **can**. We use **could** especially with:

see hear smell taste feel remember understand

- ☐ We had a lovely room in the hotel. We **could see** the lake.
- ☐ As soon as I walked into the room, I **could smell** gas.
- ☐ I was sitting at the back of the theatre and **couldn't hear** very well.

We also use **could** to say that somebody had the ability to do something, or was allowed to do something:

- ☐ My grandfather **could speak** five languages.
- ☐ We were totally free. We **could do** what we wanted. (= we were allowed to do)

D

could and **was able to**

We use **could** for *general* ability and with **see, hear** etc. :

- ☐ My grandfather **could speak** five languages.
- ☐ I **could see** them, but not very clearly.

But to say that somebody succeeded in doing something in a specific situation, we normally use **was/were able to** or **managed to** (*not could*):

- ☐ The fire spread quickly, but everybody **was able to escape**. (*not could escape*)
- ☐ I didn't know where Max was, but I **managed to find** him in the end. (*not could find*)

Compare:

- ☐ Jack was an excellent tennis player when he was younger. He **could beat** anybody.
(= he was good enough to beat anybody, he had the ability)

but Jack and Andy played a match yesterday. Andy played well, but Jack **managed to beat** him.
(= he succeeded in beating him this time)

The negative **couldn't** (**could not**) is possible in all situations:

- ☐ My grandfather **couldn't swim**.
- ☐ I looked for Max everywhere, but I **couldn't find** him.
- ☐ Andy played well, but he **couldn't beat** Jack.

could (do) and could have (done)

A

Sometimes **could** is the past of **can** (see Unit 26):

- ☐ Listen. I **can hear** something. (*now*)
- ☐ I listened. I **could hear** something. (*past*)

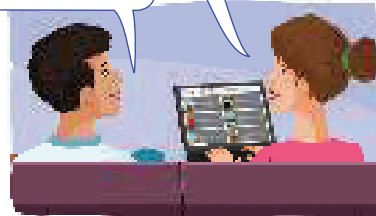
But **could** is not always past. We also use **could** for possible actions now or in the future, especially to make suggestions. For example:

- ☐ A: What shall we do tonight?
B: We **could go** to the cinema.
- ☐ A: When you go to Paris next month,
you **could stay** with Sarah.
B: Yes, I suppose I **could**.

Can is also possible in these sentences ('We can go to the cinema' etc.). **Could** is less sure than **can**.

What shall we
do tonight?

We **could go** to the cinema.



B

We also use **could** (*not can*) for actions that are not realistic. For example:

- ☐ I'm so tired, I **could sleep** for a week. (*not I can sleep for a week*)

Compare **can** and **could**:

- ☐ I **can stay** with Sarah when I go to Paris. (*realistic*)
- ☐ Maybe I **could stay** with Sarah when I go to Paris. (*possible, but less sure*)
- ☐ This is a wonderful place. I **could stay** here for ever. (*unrealistic*)

C

We also use **could** (*not can*) to say that something is possible now or in the future:

- ☐ The story **could be** true, but I don't think it is. (*not can be true*)
- ☐ I don't know what time Lisa is coming. She **could get** here at any time.

Compare **can** and **could**:

- ☐ The weather **can** change very quickly in the mountains. (*in general*)
- ☐ The weather is nice now, but it **could** change later. (*the weather now, not in general*)

D

We use **could have** (done) to talk about the past. Compare:

- ☐ I'm so tired, I **could sleep** for a week. (*now*)
I was so tired, I **could have slept** for a week. (*past*)
- ☐ The situation is bad, but it **could be** worse. (*now*)
The situation was bad, but it **could have been** worse. (*past*)

Something **could have** happened = it was possible, but did *not* happen:

- ☐ Why did you stay at a hotel? You **could have stayed** with me.
- ☐ David was lucky. He **could have hurt** himself when he fell, but he's all right.

E

I **couldn't do** something = it would not be possible:

- ☐ I **couldn't live** in a big city. I'd hate it. (= it wouldn't be possible for me)
- ☐ Everything is fine right now. Things **couldn't be** better.

For the past we use **couldn't have** ... (= would not have been possible):

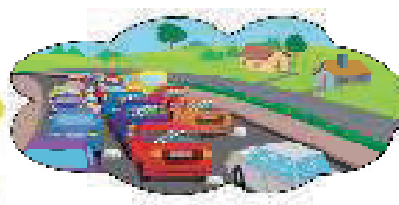
- ☐ We had a really good holiday. It **couldn't have been** better.

Note that 'I **couldn't do** something' has two meanings:

- (1) I **couldn't** = it would not be possible now, I would not be able:
 - ☐ I **couldn't run** ten kilometres now. I'm not fit enough. (= I would not be able)
- (2) I **couldn't** = I was not able (past)
 - ☐ I **couldn't run** yesterday because I'd hurt my leg. (= I was not able)

A Study this example:

My house is very near the motorway.

It **must be** very noisy.We use **must** to say that we believe something is certain:

- ☐ You've been travelling all day. You **must be** tired.
(travelling is tiring and you've been travelling all day, so you **must** be tired)
- ☐ 'Joe is a hard worker.' 'Joe? You **must be joking**. He doesn't do anything.'
- ☐ Louise **must get** very bored in her job. She does the same thing every day.

We use **can't** to say that we believe something is not possible:

- ☐ You've just had lunch. You **can't be** hungry already.
(we don't expect people to be hungry immediately after a meal)
- ☐ They haven't lived here for very long. They **can't know** many people.

The structure is:

you/she/they (etc.)	must can't	be (tired / hungry / at work etc.) be -ing (doing / going / joking etc.) get / know / have etc.
---------------------	-----------------------	--

B Study this example:

There's nobody at home. They **must have gone** out.

Martin and Lucy expected their friends to be at home.

They rang the doorbell twice, but nobody has answered. Lucy says:

They **must have gone** out.
(= there is no other possibility)For the past we use **must have ...** and **can't have ...**:

- ☐ I lost one of my gloves. I **must have dropped** it somewhere.
(that's the only explanation I can think of)
- ☐ 'We used to live very near the motorway.' 'Did you? It **must have been** noisy.'
- ☐ Sarah hasn't contacted me. She **can't have got** my message.
- ☐ Max walked into a wall. He **can't have been looking** where he was going.

The structure is:

I/you/he (etc.)	must can't	have	been (asleep / at work etc.) been -ing (doing / looking etc.) gone / got / known etc.
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You can use **couldn't have** instead of **can't have**:

- ☐ Sarah **couldn't have got** my message.
- ☐ Max **couldn't have been looking** where he was going.

may and might 1

A Study this example situation:

You are looking for Ben. Nobody is sure where he is, but you get some suggestions.



Where's Ben?

He **may** be in his office. (= perhaps he is in his office)

He **might** be having lunch. (= perhaps he is having lunch)

Ask Kate. She **might** know. (= perhaps she knows)

We use **may** or **might** to say that something is possible. You can use **may** or **might**:

- ☐ It **may** be true. or It **might** be true. (= perhaps it is true)
- ☐ She **might** know. or She **may** know.

The negative forms are **may not** and **might not**:

- ☐ It **may not** be true. (= perhaps it isn't true)
- ☐ She **might not** know. (= perhaps she doesn't know)

I/you/he (etc.)	may might	(not)	be (true / in his office etc.) be -ing (doing / working / having etc.) know / work / want etc.
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Note the difference between **may be** (2 words) and **maybe** (1 word):

- ☐ It **may be** true. (**may** + verb)
- ☐ 'Is it true?' '**Maybe**. I'm not sure.' (**maybe** = it's possible, perhaps)

B For the past we use **may have ...** or **might have ...**:

- ☐ A: I wonder why Kate didn't answer her phone.
B: She **may have been** asleep. (= perhaps she was asleep)
- ☐ A: I can't find my phone anywhere.
B: You **might have left** it at work. (= perhaps you left it at work)
- ☐ A: Why wasn't Amy at the meeting yesterday?
B: She **might not have known** about it. (= perhaps she didn't know)
- ☐ A: I wonder why David was in such a bad mood yesterday.
B: He **may not have been feeling** well. (= perhaps he wasn't feeling well)

I/you/he (etc.)	may might	(not) have	been (asleep / at home etc.) been -ing (doing / working / feeling etc.) known / had / wanted / left etc.
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C **could** is similar to **may** and **might**:

- ☐ It's a strange story, but it **could be** true. (= it is possible that it's true)
- ☐ You **could have left** your phone at work. (= it's possible that you left it there)

But **couldn't** (negative) is different from **may not** and **might not**. Compare:

- ☐ Sarah **couldn't have received** my message. Otherwise she would have replied.
(= it is not possible that she got my message)
- ☐ Why hasn't Sarah replied to my message? I suppose she **might not have received** it.
(= it's possible that she didn't receive it – perhaps she did, perhaps she didn't)

A

We use **may** and **might** to talk about possible actions or happenings in the future:

- ☐ I haven't decided where to go on holiday. I **may go** to Ireland. (= perhaps I will go there)
- ☐ Take an umbrella with you. It **might rain** later. (= perhaps it will rain)
- ☐ The bus isn't always on time. We **might have** to wait a few minutes. (= perhaps we will have to wait)

The negative forms are **may not** and **might not (mightn't)**:

- ☐ Amy **may not go** out tonight. She isn't feeling well. (= perhaps she will not go out)
- ☐ There **might not be** enough time to discuss everything at the meeting. (= perhaps there will not be enough time)

Compare:

- ☐ I'm **going** to buy a car. (for sure)
- ☐ I **may buy** a car. or I **might buy** a car. (possible)

B

Usually you can use **may** or **might**. So you can say:

- ☐ I **may go** to Ireland. or I **might go** to Ireland.
- ☐ Jane **might be** able to help you. or Jane **may be** able to help you.

But we use **might (not may)** when the situation is *not real*:

- ☐ If they paid me better, I **might** work harder. (*not* I may work)

This situation (**If they paid** me better) is not real. They do *not* pay me well, so I'm not going to work harder.

C

Compare **may/might be -ing** and **will be -ing**:

- ☐ Don't phone at 8.30. I'll **be watching** the football on TV.
- ☐ Don't phone at 8.30. I **might be watching** the football on TV. (= perhaps I'll be watching it)

We also use **may/might be -ing** for possible plans. Compare:

- ☐ I'm **going** to Ireland soon. (for sure)
- ☐ I **might be going** (or I **may be going**) to Ireland soon. (possible)

D

might as well

Helen and Clare have just missed the bus.
The buses run every hour.

What shall we do? Shall we walk?

We **might as well**. It's a nice day and I don't want to wait here for an hour.

We **might as well** do something = we should do it because there is no better alternative.
There is no reason not to do it.

You can also use **may as well**.



- ☐ A: What time are you going out?
B: Well, I'm ready, so I **might as well go** now. or ... I **may as well go** now.
- ☐ Buses are so expensive these days, you **might as well get** a taxi. (= taxis are as good, no more expensive than buses)

A

I **have to** do something = it is necessary to do it, I am obliged to do it:

- ☐ You can't turn right here. You **have to turn** left.
- ☐ I **have to wear** glasses for reading.
- ☐ Robert can't come out with us this evening. He **has to work** late.
- ☐ Last week Tina broke her arm and **had to go** to hospital.
- ☐ I haven't **had to go** to the doctor for ages.

You **have to turn** left here.



We use **do/does/did** in questions and negative sentences (for the present and past simple):

- ☐ What **do I have to do** to get a new driving licence? (*not* What have I to do?)
- ☐ Karen **doesn't have to work** Saturdays. (*not* Karen hasn't to)
- ☐ 'Did you **have to wait** a long time for a bus?' 'No, only ten minutes.'

You can say **I'll have to ...**, **I'm going to have to ...**, **I might have to ...**, **I may have to ...**:

- ☐ They can't repair my computer, so **I'll have to buy** a new one. *or* ... **I'm going to have to buy** a new one.
- ☐ We **might have to change** our plans. *or* We **may have to change** ... (= it's possible that we will have to change them)

B

Must is similar to **have to**. You can say:

- ☐ It's later than I thought. I **must go**. *or* I **have to go**.

You can use **must** or **have to** when you give your own opinion (for example, to say what *you* think is necessary, or to recommend someone to do something):

- ☐ I haven't spoken to Sue for ages. I **must phone** her. / I **have to phone** her. (= I say this is necessary)
- ☐ Mark is a really nice person. You **must meet** him. / You **have to meet** him. (= I recommend this)

We use **have to** (*not usually must*) to say what someone is *obliged* to do. This is a *fact*, not the speaker's own opinion:

- ☐ I **have to work** from 8.30 to 5.30 every day. (a fact, not an opinion)
- ☐ Jane **has to travel** a lot for her work.

But we use **must** in written rules and instructions:

- ☐ Applications for the job **must be received** by 18 May.
- ☐ Seat belts **must be worn**.

We use **had to** (*not must*) to talk about the past:

- ☐ I went to the meeting yesterday, but I **had to** leave early. (*not* I must)



C

Mustn't and **don't have to** are completely different:

You **mustn't** do something = *don't* do it:

- ☐ You **must keep** this a secret. You **mustn't tell** anyone. (= don't tell anyone)
- ☐ I promised I would be on time. I **mustn't be** late. (= I must be on time)

You **don't have to** do something = you don't need to do it (but you can if you want):

- ☐ You **don't have to come** with me. I can go alone.
- ☐ I **don't have to be** at the meeting, but I'm going anyway.

D

You can use **have got to** instead of **have to**. You can say:

- ☐ I've **got to** work tomorrow. *or* I **have to** work tomorrow.
- ☐ When **has** Helen **got to** go? *or* When **does** Helen **have to** go?

A must and mustn't

You **must** do something = it is necessary that you do it:

- ☐ Don't tell anybody what I said. You **must keep** it a secret.
- ☐ We don't have much time. We **must hurry**.

You **mustn't** do something = don't do it:

- ☐ You **must** keep it a secret. You **mustn't** tell anyone. (= don't tell anyone)
- ☐ We **must** be very quiet. We **mustn't** make any noise.

B needn't and don't need to

You **needn't** do something = it's not necessary to do it (but you can if you want):

- ☐ We have plenty of time. We **needn't hurry**. (= it is not necessary to hurry)
- ☐ Joe can stay here. He **needn't come** with us. (= it is not necessary for him to come)

You can also use **don't/doesn't need to**:

- ☐ We **don't need to** hurry.

Note that we say '**don't need to** do', but '**needn't do**' (*without to*).

Compare **needn't** and **mustn't**:

- ☐ You **needn't** tell Steve. I can tell him myself. (= it is not necessary)
- ☐ You **mustn't** tell Steve. I don't want him to know. (= don't tell him)

C needn't have (done)

Study this example situation:



Paul and Sarah reserved a table at a restaurant.

But when they went to the restaurant, it was almost empty.

They **needn't have reserved** a table.

This means: they reserved a table, but now they know this was not necessary.

Compare **needn't** (do) and **needn't have** (done):

- ☐ Everything will be OK. You **needn't worry**. (it is not necessary)
- ☐ Everything was OK. You **needn't have worried**. (you worried, but it was not necessary)

D needn't have (done) and didn't need to (do)

He **needn't have done** something = he did it, but now we know that it was not necessary:

- ☐ Why did he get up at 5 o'clock? He **needn't have got** up so early. He could have stayed in bed longer.

He **didn't need to do** something = it was not necessary to do it. It doesn't matter whether he did it or not:

- ☐ He **didn't need to get** up early, so he didn't.
- ☐ He **didn't need to get** up early, but it was a beautiful morning, so he did.

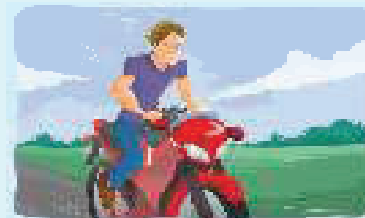
You can also say 'He **didn't have to** get up' in these examples.

A

You **should do** something = it is a good thing to do or the right thing to do.

You can use **should** to give advice or to give an opinion:

- ☐ You look tired. You **should go** to bed.
- ☐ The government **should do** more to improve schools.
- ☐ A: **Should** we **invite** Stephanie to the party?
B: Yes, I think we **should**.
- ☐ The man on the motorbike **should be wearing** a helmet.



You **shouldn't** do something = it isn't a good thing to do:

- ☐ You **shouldn't believe** everything you read in newspapers.

We often use **should** with **I think** / **I don't think** / **Do you think ...?**:

- ☐ **I think** the government **should do** more to improve schools.
- ☐ **I don't think** you **should work** so hard.
- ☐ A: **Do you think** I **should apply** for this job?
B: Yes, **I think** you **should**.

Should is not as strong as **must** or **have to**:

- ☐ You **should** apologise. (= it would be a good thing to do)
- ☐ You **must** apologise. / You **have to** apologise. (= you have no alternative)

B

We use **should** when something is not right or what we expect:

- ☐ Where's Tina? She **should be** here by now.
(= she isn't here yet, and this is not normal)
- ☐ The price on this packet is wrong. It **should be** £2.50, not £3.50.

We also use **should** to say that we expect something to happen:

- ☐ Helen has been studying hard for the exam, so she **should pass**.
(= I expect her to pass)
- ☐ There are plenty of hotels in the town. It **shouldn't be** hard to find a place to stay.
(= I don't expect it to be hard)

C

You **should have done** something = you didn't do it, but it would have been a good thing to do:

- ☐ You missed a great party last night. You **should have come**. Why didn't you?
(= you didn't come, but it would have been good to come)
- ☐ I wonder why they're so late. They **should have been** here long ago.

You **shouldn't have done** something = you did it, but it wasn't a good thing to do:

- ☐ I'm feeling sick. I **shouldn't have eaten** so much. (= I ate too much)
- ☐ She **shouldn't have been listening** to our conversation. It was private.
(= she was listening)

Compare **should** (do) and **should have** (done):

- ☐ You look tired. You **should go** to bed now.
- ☐ You went to bed very late last night. You **should have gone** to bed earlier.

D

ought to ...

You can use **ought to** instead of **should** in the sentences on this page.

We say 'ought to do' (with **to**):

- ☐ Do you think I **ought to apply** for this job? (= Do you think I **should apply** ...?)
- ☐ Jack **ought not to go** to bed so late. (= Jack **shouldn't go** ...)
- ☐ It was a great party last night. You **ought to have come**. (= You **should have come**)

A You can use **should** after:

insist demand recommend suggest propose

- ☐ I **insisted** that he **should apologise**.
- ☐ Doctors **recommend** that everyone **should eat** plenty of fruit.
- ☐ What do you **suggest** we **should do**?
- ☐ Many people are **demanding** that something **should be done** about the problem.

also

It's important/vital/necessary/essential that ... **should** ...:

- ☐ **It's essential** that everyone **should be** here on time.

B You can also leave out **should** in the sentences in section A. So you can say:

- ☐ **It's essential** that everyone **be** here on time. (= ... that everyone **should be** here ...)
- ☐ I **insisted** that he **apologise**. (= ... that he **should apologise**)
- ☐ What do you **suggest** we **do**?
- ☐ Many people are **demanding** that something **be done** about the problem.

This form (**be/do/apologise** etc.) is called the *subjunctive*. It is the same as the *infinitive* (without **to**).

You can also use normal present and past forms:

- ☐ It's **essential** that everyone **is** here on time.
- ☐ I **insisted** that he **apologised**.

C We do not use **to** ... with **suggest**. You can say:

- ☐ What do you **suggest we should do**?
- or What do you **suggest we do**? (*but not* What do you suggest us to do?)
- ☐ Jane won the lottery.
- I **suggested** that she **should buy** a car with the money she won.
- or I **suggested** that she **buy** a car.
- or I **suggested** that she **bought** a car. (*but not* I suggested her to buy)

You can also use **-ing** after **suggest** (What do you **suggest doing**?). See Unit 53.

D You can use **should** after some adjectives, especially:

strange odd funny typical natural interesting surprised surprising

- ☐ It's **strange** that he **should be** late. He's usually on time.
- ☐ I was **surprised** that he **should say** such a thing.

E You can say **'if something should happen ...'**. For example:

- ☐ We have no jobs at present, but **if the situation should change**, we will contact you.

You can also begin with **should** (**Should** something happen ...):

- ☐ **Should** the situation **change**, we will contact you.

This means the same as **'If the situation changes, ...'**. With **should**, the speaker feels that the possibility is smaller.

F You can use **I should ... / I shouldn't ...** to give advice. For example:

- ☐ 'Shall I leave now?' 'No, **I should wait** a bit.' (= I advise you to wait)

Here, **I should ...** = 'I would ... if I were you', 'I advise you to ...'. Two more examples:

- ☐ 'I'm going out now. Is it cold outside?' 'Yes, **I should wear** a coat.'
- ☐ **I shouldn't stay** up too late. You have to be up early tomorrow.

I'd better ... it's time ...

A had better (I'd better / you'd better etc.)

I'd better do something = it is advisable to do it. If I don't do it, there will be a problem or a danger:

- ☐ I have to meet Amy in ten minutes. **I'd better go** now or I'll be late.
- ☐ 'Shall I take an umbrella?' 'Yes, **you'd better**. It might rain.'
- ☐ **We'd better stop** for petrol soon. The tank is almost empty.

The negative is **I'd better not** (= I **had** better not):

- ☐ A: That jacket looks good on you. Are you going to buy it?
B: **I'd better not**. It's very expensive.
- ☐ You don't look very well. **You'd better not go** out tonight.

Remember that:

I'd better = I **had** better, **you'd better** = you **had** better etc.

- ☐ **I'd better** phone Chris, **hadn't** I?
- ☐ We **had better** go now.

Had is normally past, but we use **had better** for the present or future, *not* past.

- ☐ I'd better go **now** / **tomorrow**.

We say 'I'd better **do**' (*not* to do).

- ☐ It might rain. We'd better **take** an umbrella. (*not* We'd better to take)

B had better and should

Had better is similar to **should** but not exactly the same. We use **had better** only for a specific situation, not for things in general. You can use **should** in all types of situations to give an opinion or give advice:

- ☐ It's late. **You'd better go**. or You **should go**. (a specific situation)
- ☐ You're always at home. You **should go** out more often. (in general – *not* 'had better go')

Also, with **had better**, there is always a danger or a problem if you don't follow the advice.

Should means only 'it is a good thing to do'. Compare:

- ☐ It's a great film. You **should** go and see it. (but no problem if you don't)
- ☐ The film starts at 8.30. **You'd better** go now or you'll miss the beginning.

C it's time ...

You can say **It's time** (for somebody) **to** ...:

- ☐ It's time **to go** home. / It's time for us **to go** home.

But you can also say:

- ☐ It's late. It's time **we went** home.

When we use **it's time** + past ('it's time we **went**' etc.), the meaning is present, *not* past:

- ☐ **It's time** they **were** here. Why are they so late? (*not* It's time they are here)

It's time somebody **did** something = they should have already done it or started it.

We often use this structure to criticise or to complain:

- ☐ This situation can't continue. **It's time** you **did** something about it.
- ☐ He's very selfish. **It's time** he **realised** that he isn't the most important person in the world.

You can also say **It's about time** ...:

- ☐ Jack is a great talker, but **it's about time** he **did** something instead of just talking.

A

We use **would** ('d) / **wouldn't** when we *imagine* a situation or action (= we think of something that is not real):

- ☐ It **would be** nice to buy a new car, but we can't afford it.
- ☐ I'**d love** to live by the sea.
- ☐ A: Shall I tell Chris what happened?
B: No, I **wouldn't say** anything.
(= I wouldn't say anything in your situation)



We use **would have (done)** when we imagine something that didn't happen in the past:

- ☐ They helped us a lot. I don't know what we'**d have done** without their help.
(we'**d** have done = we **would** have done)
- ☐ It's a shame you didn't see the film. You **would have liked** it.
- ☐ I didn't tell Sam what happened. He **wouldn't have been** pleased.

Compare **would (do)** and **would have (done)**:

- ☐ I **would call** Lisa, but I don't have her number. (*now*)
I **would have called** Lisa, but I didn't have her number. (*past*)
- ☐ I'm not going to invite them to the party. They **wouldn't come** anyway.
I didn't invite them to the party. They **wouldn't have come** anyway.

We often use **would** in sentences with **if** (see Units 38–40):

- ☐ I **would call** Lisa **if** I had her number.
- ☐ I **would have called** Lisa **if** I'd had her number.

B

Compare **will ('ll)** and **would ('d)**:

- ☐ I'**ll stay** a little longer. I've got plenty of time.
I'**d stay** a little longer, but I really have to go now. (so I can't stay longer)
- ☐ I'**ll call** Lisa. I have her number.
I'**d call** Lisa, but I don't have her number. (so I can't call her)

Sometimes **would/wouldn't** is the past of **will/won't**.

Compare:

<i>present</i>		<i>past</i>
☐ TOM: I' ll call you on Sunday.	→	Tom said he' d call me on Sunday.
☐ AMY: I promise I won't be late.	→	Amy promised that she wouldn't be late.
☐ LISA: Oh, no! The car won't start .	→	Lisa was annoyed because her car wouldn't start .

Somebody **wouldn't do** something = he/she refused to do it:

- ☐ I tried to warn him, but he **wouldn't listen** to me. (= he refused to listen)
- ☐ The car **wouldn't start**. (= it 'refused' to start)

C

You can also use **would** to talk about things that happened regularly in the past:

- ☐ When we were children, we lived by the sea. In summer, if the weather was fine, we **would** all get up early and go for a swim. (= we did this regularly)
- ☐ Whenever Richard was angry, he **would** walk out of the room.

With this meaning, **would** is similar to **used to** (see Unit 18):

- ☐ Whenever Richard was angry, he **used to walk** out of the room.

can/could/would you ... ? etc. (Requests, offers, permission and invitations)

A Asking people to do things (requests)

We use **can** or **could** to ask people to do things:

- ☐ **Can you** wait a moment, please?
- or ☐ **Could you** wait a moment, please?
- ☐ Helen, **can you** do me a favour?
- ☐ Excuse me, **could you** tell me how to get to the bus station?

You can say **Do you think you could** ... ? :

- ☐ **Do you think you could** take me to the airport?
(not Do you think you can)

Could you open the door, please?



B Asking for things

To ask for something, we use **Can (I) have ... ? / Could (I) have ... ?** or **Can (I) get ... ?**:

- ☐ (in a shop) **Can I have** these postcards, please? or **Can I get** these postcards, please?
- ☐ (in a restaurant) **Could we have** the menu, please? or **Can we have** the menu, please?

May I have ... ? is also possible:

- ☐ **May I have** these postcards, please?

C Asking to do things

We use **can I** or **could I** to ask to do something:

- ☐ (on the phone) Hello, **can I** speak to Steve, please?
- ☐ **'Could I** use your phone charger?' 'Sure.'
- ☐ **Do you think I could** borrow your bike?

May is also possible:

- ☐ **May I ask you a question?**

May is more formal than **can** or **could**.

You can also say:

- Do you mind if I ... ?**
- Is it all right if I ... ? / Is it OK if I ... ?**
- ☐ **Do you mind if I** use your phone charger?
- ☐ **'Is it all right if I** sit here?' 'Yes, of course.'

Could I use your phone charger?



D Offering and inviting

You can use **Can I ... ?** to offer to do something:

- ☐ **'Can I** help you?' 'No, it's OK. I can manage, thanks.'
- ☐ **'Can I** get you some coffee?' 'That would be nice.'

To offer or to invite, we use **Would you like ... ?** (not Do you like):

- ☐ **'Would you like** some coffee?' 'No, thanks.'
- ☐ **'Would you like** to eat with us tonight?' 'That would be great.'

I'd like ... (= I would like) is a polite way to say what you want:

- ☐ (at a tourist information office) **I'd like** some information about hotels, please.
- ☐ (in a shop) **I'd like** to try on this jacket, please.

if I do ... and if I did ...

A Compare these examples:

- (1) LISA: Shall we take the bus or the train?
JESS: **If we take** the bus, it **will** be cheaper.

For Jess, it is possible that they will take the bus, so she says:

If we take the bus, it **will** be ...



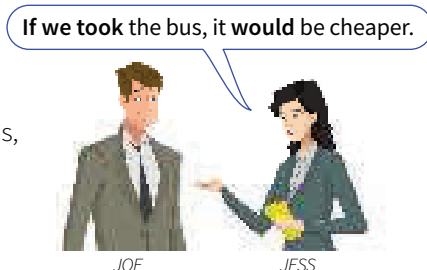
- (2) Lisa and Jess decide to take the train.
Later, Jess talks to Joe.

JOE: How are you going to travel?

JESS: We're going to take the train. **If we took** the bus, it **would** be cheaper, but the train is quicker.

Now Jess knows they are *not* going to take the bus, so she says:

If we took the bus, it **would** be ...

B When we talk about something that will not happen, or we don't expect that it will happen, we use **if + past (if we went / if there was etc.)**.

But the meaning is *not* past:

- ☐ What would you do **if you won** a lot of money? (I don't really expect this to happen)
- ☐ **If there was** an election tomorrow, who would you vote for? (there will not be an election tomorrow)
- ☐ I'd be surprised **if they didn't come** to the party. (I expect them to come)



Compare **if I find** and **if I found**:

- ☐ I think I left my watch at your house. **If you find** it, can you call me?
- but
- ☐ **If you found** a wallet in the street, what would you do with it?

C We do not normally use **would** in the **if**-part of the sentence:

- ☐ I'd be very scared **if somebody pointed** a gun at me. (*not* if somebody would point)
- ☐ **If we went** by bus, it would be cheaper. (*not* If we would go)

In the other part of the sentence (not the **if**-part) we use **would ('d) / wouldn't**:

- ☐ I'd be (= I **would** be) scared if somebody pointed a gun at me.
- ☐ I'm not going to bed yet. I'm not tired. If I went to bed now, I **wouldn't** sleep.
- ☐ What **would** you do if you were bitten by a snake?

Could and **might** are also possible:

- ☐ If I won a lot of money, I **might** buy a house. (= it is possible that I would buy a house)
- ☐ If it stopped raining, we **could** go out. (= we would be able to go out)

if I knew ... I wish I knew ...

A Study this example situation:

Sarah wants to phone Paul, but she can't do this because she doesn't know his number. She says:

I'd phone him **if I knew** his number.
(I'd phone = I **would** phone)

Sarah *doesn't* know Paul's number, so she says 'if I **knew**'. She *imagines* what she **would** do **if** she **knew** his number.



... if I knew his number ...

When we imagine a situation like this, we use **if + past** (**if I knew** / **if you were** / **if we didn't** etc.). But the meaning is present, *not* past:

- ☐ There are many things I'd like to do **if I had** more time. (but I don't have time)
- ☐ **If I didn't** want to go to the party, I wouldn't go. (but I want to go)
- ☐ **If you were** in my position, what would you do?
- ☐ It's a pity he can't drive. It would be useful **if he could**.

B We use the past in the same way after **wish** (**I wish I knew** / **I wish you were** etc.).

We use **wish** to say that we regret something, that something is not as we would like it to be:

- ☐ **I wish I knew** Paul's phone number.
(= I don't know it and I regret this)
- ☐ Do you ever **wish** you **could** fly?
(you can't fly)
- ☐ It's very crowded here. **I wish** there **weren't** so many people. (there are a lot of people)
- ☐ **I wish I didn't** have to work tomorrow, but unfortunately I do.

Compare:

- ☐ **I'm glad I live** here. (I live here and that's good)
- ☐ **I wish I lived** here. (I don't live here unfortunately)



C After **if** and **wish**, you can use **were** instead of **was** (**if I were** / **I wish it were** etc.).

You can also use **was**. So you can say:

- | | | |
|--|----|----------------------------------|
| ☐ If I were you, I wouldn't buy that coat. | or | If I was you, ... |
| ☐ I'd go for a walk if it weren't so cold. | or | ... if it wasn't so cold. |
| ☐ I wish Anna were here. | or | I wish Anna was here. |

D We do not usually say 'if ... would'. We use **would** ('d) in the other part of the sentence:

- ☐ **If I were** rich, I **would** travel a lot. (*not* If I would be rich)
- ☐ Who **would** you ask **if** you **needed** help? (*not* if you would need)

In the same way we say:

- ☐ **I wish I had** something to read. (*not* I wish I would have)
- ☐ **I wish she were** here now. (*not* I wish she would be)

For '**I wish ... would ...**' see Unit 41.

E **Could** sometimes means 'would be able to' and sometimes 'was/were able to':

- ☐ She **could get** a better job (she **could get** = she **would be able to** get)
if she **could speak** another language. (if she **could speak** = if she **was able to** speak)
- ☐ I wish I **could** help you. (I wish I **could** = I wish I **was able to**)

if I had known ... I wish I had known ...

A

Study this example situation:

Last month Gary was in hospital for a few days. Rachel didn't know this.
A few days ago they met by chance. Rachel said:

If I'd known you were in hospital, **I would have gone** to visit you.
(= I didn't know, so I didn't go to visit you)

If I'd known = If I **had** known. This tells us that she *didn't* know before.

We use **if + had ('d)** ... to talk about the past (**if I'd known / if you'd done** etc.):

- ☐ I didn't see you when you passed me in the street. **If I'd seen** you, I would have said hello.
- ☐ They didn't go out last night. They would have gone out **if they hadn't been** so tired. (but they were tired)
- ☐ **If you'd been looking** where you were going, you wouldn't have walked into the wall. (but you weren't looking)
- ☐ The view was wonderful. I would have taken some pictures **if I'd had** (= if I **had had**) a camera with me. (but I didn't have a camera)

Compare:

- ☐ I'm not hungry. **If I was** hungry, I would eat something. (*now*)
- ☐ I wasn't hungry. **If I had been** hungry, I would have eaten something. (*past*)

B

We do *not* say 'if something would have happened'. We use **would** in the other part of the sentence:

- ☐ **If I had seen** you, **I would have said** hello. (*not* If I would have seen you)

The short form **'d** can be **would** or **had**:

- ☐ If **I'd seen** you, (I'd seen = I **had** seen)
I'd have said hello. (I'd have said = I **would** have said)

C

We use **had done/known/been** etc. in the same way after **wish**.

I wish something **had happened** = I am sorry that it didn't happen

I wish something **hadn't happened** = I am sorry that it happened

- ☐ **I wish I'd known** that Gary was ill. I would have gone to see him. (but I didn't know)
- ☐ I feel sick. **I wish I hadn't eaten** so much. (I ate too much)
- ☐ Do you **wish you'd studied** science instead of languages? (you didn't study science)

Compare:

- ☐ **I'm glad I saw** him. (= I **saw** him)
- ☐ **I wish I'd seen** him. (= I **didn't see** him)

We do *not* say 'wish ... would have ...'.

- ☐ The weather was cold. I wish it **had been** warmer. (*not* I wish it would have been)

D

Compare **would (do)** and **would have (done)**:

- ☐ If I'd gone to the party last night, **I would be** tired now. (I am not tired now – *present*)
- ☐ If I'd gone to the party last night, **I would have met** lots of people. (I didn't meet lots of people – *past*)

Compare **would have**, **could have** and **might have**:

- ☐ If the weather hadn't been so bad, { we **would have gone** out.
we **could have gone** out.
(= we would have been able to go out)
we **might have gone** out.
(= maybe we would have gone out)

A

We say '**wish** somebody **luck** / **all the best** / **success**' etc. :

- ☐ I **wish you all the best** in the future.
- ☐ I saw Mark before the exam and **he wished me luck**.

We say '**wish** somebody *something*' (**luck**, **happiness** etc.), but we do not say 'I wish something *happens*'. We use **hope** in this situation:

- ☐ I'm sorry you're not well. I **hope** you **feel** better soon. (*not* I wish you feel)

Compare **I wish** and **I hope**:

- ☐ I **wish** you a **pleasant stay** at this hotel.
- ☐ I **hope** you **enjoy** your stay at this hotel. (*not* I wish you enjoy)

B

We also use **wish** to say that we regret something, that something is not as we would like it. When we use **wish** in this way, we use the *past* (**knew**/**lived** etc.), but the meaning is *present*:

- ☐ I **wish I knew** what to do about the problem. (but I don't know)
- ☐ I **wish you didn't** have to go so soon. (but you have to go)
- ☐ Do you **wish you lived** near the sea? (you don't live near the sea)
- ☐ Jack's going on a trip to Mexico soon. I **wish I was** going too. (but I'm not going)

To say that we regret something that happened before, we use **wish** + **had** known / **had** said etc. :

- ☐ I **wish I'd known** about the party. I'd have gone if I'd known. (but I didn't know)
- ☐ It was a stupid thing to say. I **wish I hadn't said** it. (but I said it)

See also Units 39 and 40.

C

I wish I could (do something) = I regret that I cannot do it:

- ☐ I'm sorry you have to go. I **wish you could stay** longer. (but you can't)
- ☐ I've met that man before. I **wish I could remember** his name. (but I can't)

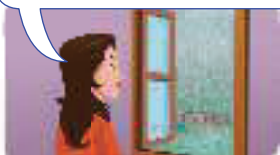
I wish I could have (done something) = I regret that I could not do it:

- ☐ I hear the party was great. I **wish I could have gone**. (but I couldn't go)

D

You can say '**I wish** something **would** happen'. For example:

I wish it would stop raining.



It's been raining all day. Tanya doesn't like it. She says:

I wish it would stop raining.

Tanya would like the rain to stop, but this will probably not happen.

We use **I wish ... would** when we would like something to happen or change.

We often use **I wish ... would** to complain about a situation:

- ☐ The phone has been ringing for five minutes. I **wish** somebody **would answer** it.
- ☐ I **wish you'd do** (= you **would** do) something instead of just sitting and doing nothing.

You can use **I wish ... wouldn't ...** to complain about things that people do repeatedly:

- ☐ I **wish you wouldn't keep** interrupting me. (= please stop interrupting me)

E

We use **I wish ... would ...** to say that we want something *to happen*. We do not use **I wish ... would ...** to say how we would like things *to be*. Compare:

- ☐ I **wish** Sarah **would** come. (= I want her to come)
- but I **wish** Sarah **was** (or **were**) here now. (*not* I wish Sarah would be)
- ☐ I **wish** somebody **would buy** me a car.
- but I **wish** I **had** a car. (*not* I wish I would have)

Passive 1 (is done / was done)

A Study this example:



This house **was built** in 1981.

'This house **was built**' is *passive*.

Compare active and passive:

Somebody **built** this house in 1981. (active)
subject *object*

This house **was built** in 1981. (*passive*)
subject

When we use an *active* verb, we say *what the subject does*:

- ☐ My grandfather was a builder. **He built** this house in 1981.
- ☐ It's a big company. **It employs** two hundred people.

When we use a *passive* verb, we say *what happens to the subject*:

- ☐ 'How old is this house?' **'It was built in 1981.'**
- ☐ **Two hundred people are employed** by the company.

B When we use the passive, who or what causes the action is often unknown or unimportant:

- ☐ A lot of money was **stolen** in the robbery. (somebody stole it, but we don't know who)
- ☐ **Is** this room **cleaned** every day? (does somebody clean it? – it's not important who)

If we want to say who does or what causes the action, we use **by**:

- ☐ This house was built **by my grandfather**.
- ☐ Two hundred people are employed **by the company**.

C The passive is **be (is/was etc.) + past participle (done/cleaned/seen etc.)**:
 (be) done (be) cleaned (be) damaged (be) built (be) seen etc.

The *past participle* often ends in **-ed** (clean**ed**/damag**ed** etc.), but many important verbs are *irregular* (**built**/**done**/**stolen** etc.). See Appendix 1.

Compare active and passive, *present simple* and *past simple*:

Present simple

active: **clean(s)** / **see(s)** etc.

Somebody **cleans** this room every day.

passive: **am/is/are + cleaned/seen** etc.

This room **is cleaned** every day.

- ☐ Many accidents **are caused** by careless driving.
- ☐ I'm **not invited** to parties very often.
- ☐ How **is** this word **pronounced**?

Past simple

active: **cleaned/saw** etc.

Somebody **cleaned** this room yesterday.

passive: **was/were + cleaned/seen** etc.

This room **was cleaned** yesterday.

- ☐ We **were woken** up by a loud noise during the night.
- ☐ 'Did you go to the party?' 'No, I **wasn't invited**.'
- ☐ How much money **was stolen** in the robbery?

Passive 2 (be done / been done / being done)

A

Infinitive

active: (to) **do/clean/see** etc.Somebody **will clean** this room later.passive: (to) **be + done/cleaned/seen** etc.This room **will be cleaned** later.

- ☐ The situation is serious. Something must **be done** before it's too late.
- ☐ A mystery is something that can't **be explained**.
- ☐ The music was very loud and could **be heard** from a long way away.
- ☐ A new supermarket is going **to be built** next year.
- ☐ Please go away. I want **to be left** alone.

B

Perfect infinitive

active: (to) **have + done/cleaned/seen** etc.Somebody **should have cleaned** the room.passive: (to) **have been + done/cleaned/seen** etc.The room **should have been cleaned**.

- ☐ I haven't received the letter yet. It might **have been sent** to the wrong address.
- ☐ If you had locked the car, it wouldn't **have been stolen**.
- ☐ There were some problems at first, but they seem **to have been solved**.

C

Present perfect

active: **have/has + done** etc.The room looks nice. Somebody **has cleaned** it.passive: **have/has been + done** etc.The room looks nice. **It has been cleaned**.

- ☐ Have you heard? The trip **has been cancelled**.
- ☐ **Have** you ever **been bitten** by a dog?
- ☐ 'Are you going to the party?' 'No, I **haven't been invited**.'

Past perfect

active: **had + done** etc.The room looked nice. Somebody **had cleaned** it.passive: **had been + done** etc.The room looked nice. **It had been cleaned**.

- ☐ The vegetables didn't taste good. They **had been cooked** too long.
- ☐ The car was three years old, but **hadn't been used** very much.

D

Present continuous

active: **am/is/are + (do)ing**Somebody **is cleaning** the room at the moment.passive: **am/is/are + being (done)**The room **is being cleaned** at the moment.

- ☐ There's somebody walking behind us. I think we **are being followed**.
- ☐ A new bridge **is being built** across the river. It will be finished next year.

Past continuous

active: **was/were + (do)ing**Somebody **was cleaning** the room when I arrived.passive: **was/were + being (done)**The room **was being cleaned** when I arrived.

- ☐ There was somebody walking behind us. I think we **were being followed**.

A I was offered .../ we were given ... etc.

Some verbs can have two objects. For example, **give**:

- My grandfather gave me this watch.
object 1 object 2

It is possible to make two passive sentences:

- ☐ I **was given** this watch (by my grandfather). or
This watch **was given** to me (by my grandfather).

Other verbs which can have two objects are:

ask offer pay show tell

When we use these verbs in the passive, most often we begin with the *person*:

- ☐ **I've been offered** the job, but I don't think I want it. (= somebody has offered me the job)
- ☐ **You will be given** plenty of time to decide. (= we will give you plenty of time)
- ☐ I didn't see the original document, but **I was shown** a copy. (= somebody showed me a copy)
- ☐ Tim has an easy job – **he's paid a lot of money** to do very little. (= somebody pays him a lot)



B I don't like being ...

The passive of **doing/seeing** etc. is **being done / being seen** etc. Compare:

active: I don't like **people telling me** what to do.

passive: I don't like **being told** what to do.

- ☐ I remember **being taken** to the zoo when I was a child.
(= I remember **somebody taking** me to the zoo)
- ☐ Steve hates **being kept** waiting. (= he hates **people keeping** him waiting)
- ☐ We climbed over the wall without **being seen**. (= without **anybody seeing** us)

I was born ...

We say '**I was** born ...' (*not* I am born):

- ☐ I was born in Chicago.
- ☐ Where **were** you **born**? (*not* Where are you born?) } *past*

but

- How many babies **are born** every day? *present*

D get

You can use **get** for the passive:

- ☐ There was a fight, but nobody **got hurt**. (= nobody **was** hurt)
- ☐ I don't **get invited** to many parties. (= I'm not invited)
- ☐ I'm surprised Liz **didn't get offered** the job. (= Liz **wasn't offered** the job)

We use **get** only when things *happen*. For example, you cannot use **get** in these sentences:

- Jessica **is liked** by everybody. (*not gets liked* – this is not a ‘happening’)
- Peter was a mystery man. Very little **was known** about him. (*not got known*)

We use **get** mainly in informal spoken English. You can use **be** in all situations.

We also use **get** in the following expressions (which are not passive in meaning):

get married, get divorced

get lost (= not know where you are)

get dressed (= put on your clothes)

get changed (= change your clothes)

it is said that ... he is said to ... he is supposed to ...

A Study this example situation:



George is very old. Nobody knows exactly how old he is, but:

It is said that he is 108 years old.

or **He is said to be** 108 years old.

Both these sentences mean: 'People say that he is 108 years old.'

You can use these structures with a number of other verbs, especially:

alleged believed considered expected known reported thought understood

- | | | |
|---|----|--|
| ☐ Cathy loves running.
It is said that she runs 10 miles a day. | or | She is said to run 10 miles a day. |
| ☐ The police are looking for a missing boy.
It is believed that the boy is wearing a white sweater and blue jeans. | or | The boy is believed to be wearing a white sweater and blue jeans. |
| ☐ The strike started three weeks ago.
It is expected that it will end soon. | or | The strike is expected to end soon. |
| ☐ A friend of mine has been arrested.
It is alleged that he stole a car. | or | He is alleged to have stolen a car. |
| ☐ The two houses belong to the same family.
It is said that there is a secret tunnel between them. | or | There is said to be a secret tunnel between them. |

These structures are often used in news reports. For example, in a report about an accident:

- | | | |
|---|----|---|
| ☐ It is reported that two people were injured in the explosion. | or | Two people are reported to have been injured in the explosion. |
|---|----|---|

B supposed to ...

You can use **supposed to ...** in the same way as **said to ...**:

- ☐ I want to see that film. **It's supposed to be** good. (= people say it's good)
- ☐ There are many stories about Joe. **He's supposed to have robbed** a bank many years ago.
- ☐ Fireworks **are supposed to have been invented** in China. Is it true?

Sometimes **supposed to ...** has a different meaning. We use **supposed to** to say what is intended, arranged or expected. Often this is different from the real situation:

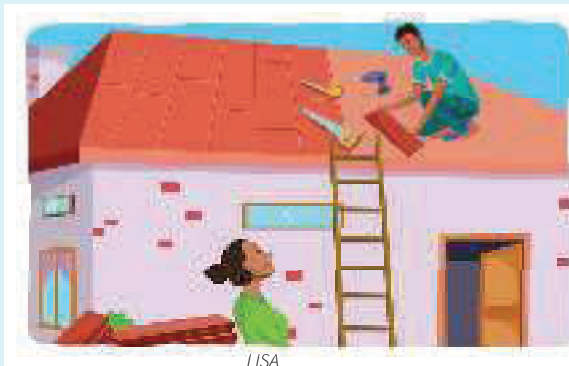
- ☐ The plan **is supposed to be** a secret, but everybody seems to know about it.
(= the plan is intended to be a secret)
- ☐ What are you doing at work? You **'re supposed to be** on holiday.
(= you arranged to be on holiday)
- ☐ Our guests **were supposed to come** at 7.30, but they were late.
- ☐ Jane **was supposed to phone** me last night, but she didn't.
- ☐ I'd better hurry. I **'m supposed to be meeting** Chris in ten minutes.

You're not supposed to do something = it is not allowed or advised:

- ☐ **You're not supposed to park** your car here. It's private parking only.
- ☐ Joe is much better after his illness, but **he's not supposed to exercise** too hard.

have something done

A Study this example situation:



The roof of Lisa's house was damaged.
So she called a builder, and yesterday he came and repaired it.

Lisa **had** the roof **repaired** yesterday.

This means: Lisa arranged for somebody else to repair the roof. She didn't repair it herself.

If you **have something done**, you arrange for somebody to do it for you.

Compare:

- ☐ Lisa **repaired** the roof. (= she repaired it herself)
Lisa **had** the roof **repaired**. (= she arranged for somebody else to repair it)
- ☐ A: Did you **make** those curtains yourself?
B: Yes, I like making things.
A: Did you **have** those curtains **made**?
B: No, I made them myself.

B Study the word order:

have	object	past participle
Lisa had	the roof	repaired.
Where did you have	your hair	cut?
We are having	the house	painted.
I think you should have	that coat	cleaned.
I don't like having	my picture	taken.

We say:

- ☐ How often do you **have your car serviced?** (*not* have serviced your car)
- ☐ Our neighbour is **having a garage built.** (*not* having built a garage)
- ☐ Your hair looks nice. Did you **have it cut?**

C **get something done**

You can say '**get** something done' instead of '**have** something done':

- ☐ When are you going to **get the roof repaired?** (= have the roof repaired)
- ☐ I think you should **get your hair cut** really short.

D We also use **have something done** with a different meaning. For example:

- ☐ Paul and Karen **had their bags stolen** while they were travelling.

This does not mean that they arranged for somebody to steal their bags. 'They **had their bags stolen**' means only: 'Their bags were stolen'.

With this meaning, we use **have something done** to say that something happens to somebody or their belongings:

- ☐ Gary **had** his nose **broken** in a fight. (= his nose was broken)
- ☐ Have you ever **had** your bike **stolen**?

Reported speech 1 (he said that ...)

A Study this example situation:



PAUL

You saw Paul yesterday and you want to tell somebody what he said.

There are two ways of doing this:

You can repeat Paul's words (direct speech):

Paul said, '**I'm feeling ill.**'

Or you can use reported speech:

Paul said **that he was feeling ill.**

Compare:

direct Paul said, '**I am** feeling ill.'

reported Paul said that **he was** feeling ill.

In writing we use these quotation marks to show direct speech.

B When we use reported speech, the main verb of the sentence is usually past (Paul **said** that ... / I **told** her that ... etc.). The rest of the sentence is usually past too:

- ☐ Paul **said** that he **was feeling** ill.
- ☐ I **told** Lisa that I **didn't have** any money.

You can leave out **that**. So you can say:

- ☐ Paul **said that** he was feeling ill. or Paul **said** he was feeling ill.

In general, the *present* in direct speech changes to the *past* in reported speech:

am/is → was	do/does → did	will → would
are → were	have/has → had	can → could
want/like/know/go etc. → wanted/liked/knew/went etc.		

See also Unit 48A.

Compare direct and reported speech:

You met Anna. Here are some of the things she said in *direct* speech:

I've lost my phone.
I want to buy a car.
 I **can't** come to the party on Friday.
 I **don't** have much free time.
 My parents **are** fine.
 I'm going away for a few days.
 I'll phone you when I **get** back.



ANNA

Later you tell somebody what Anna said.
 You use *reported* speech:

- ☐ Anna said that she **had** lost her phone.
- ☐ She said that she **wanted** to buy a car.
- ☐ She said that she **couldn't** come to the party on Friday.
- ☐ She said that she **didn't** have much free time.
- ☐ She said that her parents **were** fine.
- ☐ She said that she **was** going away for a few days and **would** phone me when she **got** back.

C The *past simple* (**did/saw/knew** etc.) can stay the same in reported speech, or you can change it to the *past perfect* (**had done / had seen / had known** etc.):

- ☐ *direct* Paul said: 'I **woke** up feeling ill, so I **didn't go** to work.'
- ☐ *reported* Paul said (that) he **woke** up feeling ill, so he **didn't go** to work. or Paul said (that) he **had woken** up feeling ill, so he **hadn't gone** to work.

Reported speech 2

A

We do not always change the verb in reported speech. If the situation *is still the same*, it is not necessary to change the verb to the past. For example:

- ☐ *direct* Paul said, '**My** new job **is** boring.'
- reported* Paul said that **his** new job **is** boring.
(The situation is still the same. His job is still boring now.)
- ☐ *direct* Helen said, '**I want** to go to Canada next year.'
- reported* Helen told me that **she wants** to go to Canada next year.
(Helen still wants to go to Canada next year.)

You can also change the verb to the past:

- ☐ Paul said that his new job **was** boring.
- ☐ Helen told me that she **wanted** to go to Canada next year.

But if the situation has *changed* or *finished*, you need to use a past verb. Compare:

- ☐ Paul left the room suddenly. He said '**I have to go.**' (*direct speech*)
- Paul left the room suddenly. He said (that) **he had to go.** (*not has to go*)

B

You need to use the past in reported speech when what was said is different from what is really true. For example:

You met Rachel a few days ago. She said:

- ☐ Have you heard? **Joe is in hospital.**

Later that day you meet Joe in the street. You say:

- ☐ Joe, this is a surprise. Rachel said you **were** in hospital.
(*not 'you are in hospital' – it's clear that he isn't*)



Joe is in hospital.



Rachel said
you **were**
in hospital

JOE

C

say and tell

If you say *who* somebody is talking to, use **tell**:

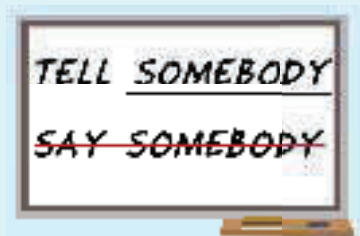
- ☐ Rachel **told me** that you were in hospital. (*not Rachel said me*)
- ☐ What did you **tell the police**? (*not say the police*)

Otherwise use **say**:

- ☐ Rachel **said** that you were in hospital.
(*not Rachel told that ...*)
- ☐ What did you **say**?

You can '**say** something **to** somebody':

- ☐ Anna **said** goodbye **to** me and left. (*not Anna said me goodbye*)
- ☐ What did you **say to** the police?



D

We say '**tell** somebody **to** ...' and '**ask** somebody **to** ...'.

Compare direct and reported speech:

- ☐ *direct* '**Drink** plenty of water,' the doctor said to me.
- reported* The doctor **told me to drink** plenty of water.
- ☐ *direct* '**Don't work** too hard,' I said to Joe.
- reported* I **told Joe not to work** too hard.
- ☐ *direct* 'Can you help me, please,' Jackie said to me.
- reported* Jackie **asked me to help** her.

You can also say 'Somebody **said (not) to** do something':

- ☐ Paul **said not to worry** about him. (*but not Paul said me*)

Questions 1

A

In questions the subject is usually after the first verb:

subject + verb

verb + subject

Tom	will	→	will	Tom?
you	have	→	have	you?
the house	was	→	was	the house?

- ☐ **Will Tom** be here tomorrow?
- ☐ **Have you** been working hard?
- ☐ When **was the house** built?

The subject is after the *first* verb:

- ☐ **Is Katherine** working today? (*not Is working Katherine*)

B

In *present simple* questions, we use **do/does**:

you live → **do** you **live**?
the film starts → **does** the film **start**?

- ☐ Do you **live** near here?
- ☐ What time **does** the film **start**?

In *past simple* questions, we use **did**:

you sold → **did** you **sell**?
the train stopped → **did** the train **stop**?

- ☐ Did you **sell** your car?
- ☐ Why **did** the train **stop**?

But do not use **do/does/did** if **who/what** etc. is the subject of the sentence. Compare:

who *object*

Emma phoned somebody.

object

Who **did** Emma **phone**?

who *subject*

Somebody phoned Emma.

subject.

Who **phoned** Emma?

In these examples, **who/what** etc. is the *subject*:

- ☐ **Who wants** something to eat? (*not* Who does want)
- ☐ **What happened** to you last night? (*not* What did happen)
- ☐ **How many people came** to the party? (*not* did come)
- ☐ **Which bus goes** to the centre? (*not* does go)

C

In questions beginning **who/what/which/where**, prepositions (**in, for** etc.) usually go at the end:

- ☐ **Where** are you **from**?
- ☐ **Who** do you want to speak **to**?
- ☐ **What** was the weather **like**?
- ☐ **Which** job has Tina applied **for**?

You can use *preposition* + **whom** in formal style:

- ☐ **To whom** do you wish to speak?

D

isn't it ...? / didn't you ...? etc. (negative questions)

We use negative questions especially to show surprise:

- ☐ **Didn't you** hear the doorbell? I rang it three times.
When we expect the listener to agree with us:
- ☐ **'Haven't we** met before?' 'Yes, I think we have.'

Note the meaning of **yes** and **no** in answers to negative questions:

- ☐ ‘Don’t you want to go?’ { ‘Yes.’ (= Yes, I want to go)
‘No.’ (= No, I don’t want to go)

We often use negative questions with **Why** ...?:

- ☐ **Why don't we** eat out tonight? (*not* Why we don't eat)
- ☐ **Why wasn't Emma** at work yesterday? (*not* Why Emma wasn't)

Questions 2 (do you know where ... ? / he asked me where ...)

A

Do you **know where ... ?** / **I don't know why ...** / **Could you tell me what ... ?** etc.

We say: Where **has Tom** gone?

but **Do you know** where **Tom has** gone? (*not has Tom gone*)

When the question (**Where has Tom gone?**) is part of a longer sentence (**Do you know ... ?** / **I don't know ...** / **Can you tell me ... ?** etc.), the word order changes. We say:

- | | |
|--|---|
| ☐ What time is it ? | but Do you know what time it is ? |
| ☐ Who are those people ? | I don't know who those people are . |
| ☐ Where can I find Louise? | Can you tell me where I can find Louise? |
| ☐ How much will it cost? | Do you have any idea how much it will cost? |

Be careful with **do/does/did** questions. We say:

- | | |
|---|---|
| ☐ What time does the film start ? | but Do you know what time the film starts ? |
| | (<i>not does the film start</i>) |
| ☐ What do you mean ? | Please explain what you mean . |
| ☐ Why did she leave early? | I wonder why she left early. |

Use **if** or **whether** where there is no other question word (**what, why** etc.):

- | | |
|---|--|
| ☐ Did anybody see you? | but I don't know if anybody saw me. |
| | or ... whether anybody saw me. |

B

He asked me where ...

The same changes in word order happen in questions in reported speech. Compare:

- | | |
|--|--|
| ☐ <i>direct</i> | The police officer said to us 'Where are you going ?' |
| <i>reported</i> | The police officer asked us where we were going . |
| ☐ <i>direct</i> | Clare asked 'What time do the shops close ?' |
| <i>reported</i> | Clare wanted to know what time the shops closed . |

In reported speech the verb usually changes to the past (**were, closed** etc.). See Unit 47.

Study these examples. You had a job interview and the interviewer asked you these questions:



Are you willing to travel?

What do you do in your spare time?

How long have you been working in your present job?

Why did you apply for the job?

Can you speak any other languages?

Do you have a driving licence?

Later you tell a friend what the interviewer asked you. You use *reported speech*:

- ☐ She asked if (or whether) **I was** willing to travel.
- ☐ She wanted to know what **I did** in my spare time.
- ☐ She asked how long **I had been working** in my present job.
- ☐ She asked why **I had applied** for the job. or ... why **I applied** ...
- ☐ She wanted to know if (or whether) **I could** speak any other languages.
- ☐ She asked if (or whether) **I had** a driving licence.

Auxiliary verbs (have/do/can etc.) I think so / I hope so etc.

A In these sentences there is an *auxiliary* verb and a *main* verb:

	<i>auxiliary</i>	<i>main</i>	
I	have	lost	my keys.
She	can't	come	to the party.
The hotel	was	built	ten years ago.
Why	do you	want	to go home?

In these examples **have/can't/was/do** are *auxiliary* (= helping) verbs.

You can use an auxiliary verb when you don't want to repeat something:

- ☐ 'Have you locked the door?' 'Yes, I **have**.' (= I have *locked the door*)
- ☐ Gary wasn't working, but Laura **was**. (= Laura *was working*)
- ☐ Jessica could lend me the money, but she **won't**. (= she *won't lend me the money*)

We use **do/does/did** for the present and past simple:

- ☐ 'Do you like onions?' 'Yes, I **do**.' (= I *like onions*)
- ☐ 'Does Simon live in London?' 'He **did**, but he **doesn't** any more.'

You can use auxiliary verbs to deny what somebody says (= say it is not true):

- ☐ 'You're sitting in my place.' 'No, I **'m not**.' (= I'm *not sitting in your place*)
- ☐ 'You didn't lock the door before you left.' 'Yes, I **did**.' (= I *locked the door*)

B We use **have you?** / **isn't she?** / **are they?** etc. to show that we are interested in what somebody has said, or to show surprise:

- ☐ 'I've just seen Steven.' 'Oh, **have you?** How is he?'
- ☐ 'Lisa isn't very well today.' '**Isn't she?** What's wrong with her?'
- ☐ 'It rained every day during our holiday.' '**Did it?** What a shame!'
- ☐ 'James and Tanya are getting married.' '**Are they?** Really?'

C We use auxiliary verbs with **so** and **neither**:

- ☐ 'I'm tired.' '**So am I**.' (= I'm tired too)
- ☐ 'I never read newspapers.' '**Neither do I**.' (= I never read newspapers either)
- ☐ Sarah can't drive and **neither can Mark**.

Note the word order after **so** and **neither** (verb before subject):

- ☐ I passed the exam and **so did Paul**. (*not so Paul did*)

Instead of **neither**, you can use **nor**. You can also use **not ... either**:

- ☐ 'I don't know.' '**Neither do I**.' or '**Nor do I**.' or '**I don't either**.'

D I think so / I suppose so etc.

You can say **I think so** / **I suppose so** etc. when we don't want to repeat something:

- ☐ 'Are those people Korean?' '**I think so**.' (= I think *they are Korean*)
- ☐ 'Is Kate working tomorrow?' '**I suppose so**.' (= I suppose *she is working tomorrow*)
- ☐ 'Will you be at home this evening?' '**I expect so**.' (= I expect *I'll be at home ...*)

In the same way we say: **I hope so**, **I guess so** and **I'm afraid so**.

The usual negative forms are:

- I think so / I expect so → I **don't think so** / I **don't expect so**
- I hope so / I'm afraid so → I **hope not** / I'm **afraid not**
- I guess so / I suppose so → I **guess not** / I **suppose not**

- ☐ 'Is that woman American?' '**I think so. / I don't think so.**'
- ☐ 'Do you think it will rain?' '**I hope so. / I hope not.**' (*not I don't hope so*)

Question tags (do you? isn't it? etc.)

A Study these examples:

You haven't seen Lisa today, **have you?**

No, I haven't.



It was a good film, **wasn't it?**

Yes, it was great.



Have you? and **wasn't it?** are *question tags*. These are mini-questions that you can put on the end of a sentence.

In question tags, we use an auxiliary verb (**have/was/will** etc.).

We use **do/does/did** for the present and past simple (see Unit 51):

- ☐ 'Karen plays the piano, **doesn't** she?' 'Well, yes, but not very well.'
- ☐ 'You didn't lock the door, **did** you?' 'No, I forgot.'

B Normally we use a *negative* question tag after a *positive* sentence:

positive sentence + *negative tag*
 Kate **will** be here soon, **won't she?**
 There **was** a lot of traffic, **wasn't there?**
 Joe **should** pass the exam, **shouldn't he?**

... and a *positive* question tag after a *negative* sentence:

negative sentence + *positive tag*
 Kate **won't** be late, **will she?**
 They **don't** like us, **do they?**
 You **haven't** eaten yet, **have you?**

Notice the meaning of **yes** and **no** in answer to a negative sentence:

- ☐ 'You're **not** going out this morning, **are you?**' { 'Yes.' (= Yes, I am going out)
 'No.' (= No, I am not going out)

C The meaning of a question tag depends on how you say it. If your voice goes *down*, you are not really asking a question. You expect the listener to agree with you:

- ☐ 'It's a nice day, **isn't it?**' 'Yes, beautiful.'
- ☐ 'Paul doesn't look well today, **does he?**' 'No, he looks very tired.'
- ☐ 'Lisa's very funny. She's got a great sense of humour, **hasn't she?**' 'Yes, she has.'

But if the voice goes *up*, it is a real question:

- ☐ 'You haven't seen Kate today, **have you?**' 'No, I haven't.'
 (= Have you seen Kate today?)

You can use a *negative sentence* + *positive tag* to ask for things or information, or to ask somebody to do something. The voice goes *up* at the end of the tag:

- ☐ 'You couldn't do me a favour, **could you?**' 'It depends what it is.'
- ☐ 'You don't know where Karen is, **do you?**' 'Sorry, I have no idea.'

D After **Let's ...** (= **Let us**) the question tag is **shall we**:

- ☐ **Let's** go for a walk, **shall we?** (the voice goes *up*)

After **Don't ...**, the question tag is **will you**:

- ☐ **Don't** be late, **will you?** (the voice goes *down*)

After **I'm ...**, the negative question tag is **aren't I?** (= am I not?):

- ☐ 'I'm right, **aren't I?**' 'Yes, you are.'

Verb + **-ing** (enjoy doing / stop doing etc.)

A

We say:

- ☐ I **enjoy reading**. (*not* I enjoy to read)
- ☐ Would you **mind closing** the door? (*not* mind to close)
- ☐ Chris **suggested going** to the cinema. (*not* suggested to go)

After **enjoy**, **mind** and **suggest**, we use **-ing** (*not to* ...).Some more verbs that are followed by **-ing**:

stop	recommend	admit	avoid	imagine
finish	consider	deny	risk	fancy

- ☐ Suddenly everybody **stopped talking**. There was silence.
- ☐ I'll do the shopping when I've **finished cleaning** the flat.
- ☐ He tried to **avoid answering** my question.
- ☐ I don't **fancy going** out this evening. (= I'm not enthusiastic about it)
- ☐ Have you ever **considered going** to live in another country?
- ☐ They said they were innocent. They **denied doing** anything wrong.

The negative form is **not -ing**:

- ☐ When I'm on holiday, I enjoy **not having** to get up early.



B

We also use **-ing** after:

give up (= stop)
put off (= delay until later)
go on or **carry on** (= continue)
keep or **keep on** (= do something continuously or repeatedly)

- ☐ I've **given up buying** newspapers. I don't read them any more.
- ☐ You shouldn't **put off telling** him what happened. You need to tell him now.
- ☐ Katherine doesn't want to retire. She wants to **go on working**. or ... to **carry on working**.
- ☐ You **keep interrupting** when I'm talking. or You **keep on interrupting** ...

C

With some verbs you can use the structure *verb* + somebody + **-ing**:

- ☐ You can't **stop people doing** what they want.
- ☐ I can't **imagine George riding** a motorbike.
- ☐ Did she really say that? I don't **remember her saying** that.
- ☐ Sorry to **keep you waiting** so long.

D

When you talk about finished actions, you can say **having done/stolen/said** etc.:

- ☐ They admitted **having stolen** the money.

But it is not necessary to use **having** (done). You can say:

- ☐ They admitted **stealing** the money.
- ☐ I now regret **saying** that. or I now regret **having said** that.

E

Other structures are possible with **admit**, **deny**, **suggest** and **recommend**. For example, you can say:

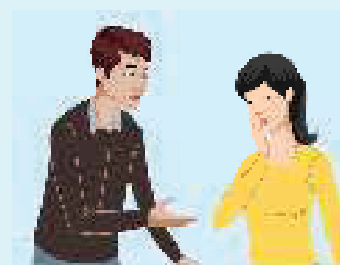
- ☐ They **denied** (that) **they had done** anything wrong. (= They **denied doing** ...)
- ☐ Chris **suggested** (that) **we go** to the cinema. (= Chris **suggested going** ...)
- ☐ I **recommend** (that) **you travel** by train. (= I **recommend travelling** ...)

Verb + **to** ... (decide to ... / forget to ... etc.)

A After these verbs you can use **to** ... (*infinitive*):

offer	plan	manage	deserve
agree	arrange	fail	afford
refuse	hope	promise	learn
decide	forget	threaten	tend

- ☐ It was a long way to walk, so we **decided to take** a taxi home.
- ☐ Simon was in a difficult situation, so I **agreed to help** him.
- ☐ I waved to Karen, but **failed to attract** her attention.
- ☐ I like Dan, but I think he **tends to talk** too much.
- ☐ How old were you when you **learnt to drive**?
or ... learnt **how** to drive?



Dan **tends to talk** too much.

The negative is **not to** ... :

- ☐ We **decided not to go** out because of the weather.
- ☐ I **promised not to be** late.

After some verbs, we use **-ing** (*not to* ...). For example, **enjoy/think/suggest**:

- ☐ I **enjoy reading**. (*not enjoy to read*)
- ☐ Andy **suggested meeting** for coffee. (*not suggested to meet*)
- ☐ Are you **thinking of buying** a car? (*not thinking to buy*)

For verb + **-ing**, see Units 53 and 62.

B After **dare** you can use the infinitive with or without **to**:

- ☐ I didn't **dare to tell** him. or I didn't **dare tell** him.

But after **dare not** (*or daren't*), we do not use **to**:

- ☐ I **daren't tell** him what happened. (*not I daren't to tell him*)

C We also use **to** ... after **seem, appear, pretend** and **claim**. For example:

- ☐ They **seem to have** plenty of money.
- ☐ Ann **pretended not to see** me when she passed me in the street.

You can also use **to be -ing** (*continuous infinitive*) and **to have (done)** (*perfect infinitive*):

- ☐ I **pretended to be reading** the newspaper. (= I pretended that I **was reading**)
- ☐ Have you seen my keys? I **seem to have lost** them. (= it seems that I **have lost** them)
- ☐ She **claimed not to have seen** me. (= she claimed that she **hadn't seen** me)

D After these verbs you can use a question word (**what/how** etc.) + **to** ... :

ask know decide remember forget learn explain understand wonder

For example:

We asked	how	to get	to the station.
Have you decided	where	to go	on holiday?
I don't know	whether	to apply	for the job or not.
Do you understand	what	to do?	

also

show/tell/ask/advise/teach somebody **what/how/where** to do something:

- ☐ Can somebody **show me how to use** this camera?
- ☐ Ask Jack. He'll **tell you what to do**.

Verb (+ object) + **to ...** (I want you to ...)

A We say:

verb + to ...		verb + object + to ...		
want	and	want	somebody something	to go
expect		expect		to be
ask		ask		to work
help		help		etc.
would like		would like		
would prefer		would prefer		

- ☐ We **expected to be** late. ☐ We expected **Dan to be** late.
☐ Would you **like to go** now? ☐ Would you like **me to go** now?
☐ He doesn't **want to know**. ☐ He doesn't want **anybody to know**.

We do not usually say 'want that':

- ☐ Do you **want me to come** with you? (*not* want that I come)

You can use **help** with or without **to**. You can say:

- ☐ Can you help me **to move** this table? *or* Can you help me **move** this table?

B These verbs have the structure *verb + object + to ...*:

verb	object	to ...
tell	somebody	to do to be to work etc.
advise		
remind		
warn		
invite		
encourage		
persuade		
get		
force		
teach		
allow		
enable		

- ☐ It's not a nice hotel. I wouldn't **advise you to stay** there.
☐ Can you **remind me to call** Sam tomorrow?
☐ Joe said the switch was dangerous and **warned me not to touch** it.
☐ I didn't move the piano by myself. I **got somebody to help** me.
☐ Who **taught you to drive**?
☐ They don't **allow people to park** in front of the building.

In these examples, the verb is *passive* (**I was warned** / **we are allowed** etc.):

- ☐ **I was warned not to touch** the switch.
☐ **Are we allowed to park** here?

We do not use **suggest** with **to ...**:

- ☐ Jane **suggested that I ask** you for advice. (*not* Jane suggested me to ask)

C We say '**make** somebody **do** something', '**let** somebody **do** something' (without **to**):

- ☐ I **made him promise** that he wouldn't tell anybody what happened.
 (*not* made him to promise)
☐ Hot weather **makes me feel** tired. (= causes me to feel tired)
☐ Her parents wouldn't **let her go** out alone. (= wouldn't allow her to go out)
☐ **Let me carry** your bag for you.

We say '**make** somebody **do**', but in the *passive* we say '(be) **made to do**' (with **to**):

- ☐ **We were made to wait** for two hours. (= They **made us wait** ...)

Verb + **-ing** or **to ...** 1 (remember, regret etc.)

A Some verbs are followed by **-ing** and some are followed by **to ...**

Verbs that you can use with **-ing** (*not to ...*):

admit	fancy	postpone
avoid	finish	risk
consider	imagine	stop
deny	keep (on)	suggest
enjoy	mind	

For examples, see Unit 53.

Verbs that you can use with **to ...**:

afford	fail	offer
agree	forget	plan
arrange	hope	promise
decide	learn	refuse
deserve	manage	tend

For examples, see Unit 54.

B Some verbs can be followed by **-ing** or **to ...** with a difference of meaning:

remember

I **remember doing** something = I did it and now I remember this.

You **remember doing** something *after* you have done it.

- ☐ I know I locked the door. I clearly **remember locking** it.
(= I locked it, and now I remember this)
- ☐ He could **remember driving** along the road just before the accident, but he couldn't remember the accident itself.

I **remembered to do** something =

I remembered that I had to do it, so I did it.

You **remember to do** something *before* you do it.

- ☐ I **remembered to lock** the door, but I forgot to shut the windows.
(= I remembered that I had to lock it, and so I locked it)
- ☐ **Remember to buy** some bananas.
(= Don't forget to buy them)

regret

I **regret doing** something = I did it and now I am sorry about it:

- ☐ I now **regret saying** what I said. I shouldn't have said it.
- ☐ Do you **regret not** going to college?

I **regret to say / to tell you / to inform** you = I am sorry that I have to say:

- ☐ (*from a formal letter*) I **regret to say** that we are unable to accept your offer.

go on

go on doing something = continue doing the same thing:

- ☐ The president paused for a moment and then **went on talking**.
- ☐ We need to change. We can't **go on living** like this.

go on to do something = do or say something new:

- ☐ After discussing the economy, the president **went on to talk** about foreign policy.

C We use the following verbs with **-ing** or **to ...** with no difference of meaning:

begin start continue intend bother

So you can say:

- ☐ It **started raining**. or It **started to rain**.
- ☐ Andy **intends buying** a house. or Andy **intends to buy** ...
- ☐ Don't **bother locking** the door. or Don't **bother to lock** ...

Normally we do not use **-ing** after **-ing**:

- ☐ It's **starting to rain**. (*not usually* It's starting raining)

Verb + **-ing** or **to ... 2** (**try, need, help**)**A** try to ... and try -ing

try to do = attempt to do, make an effort to do:

- ☐ I was very tired. I **tried to keep** my eyes open, but I couldn't.
- ☐ Please **try to be** quiet when you come home. Everyone will be asleep.

try something or **try doing something** = do it as an experiment or test:

- ☐ These cakes are delicious. You should **try one**. (= have one to see if you like it)
- ☐ We couldn't find anywhere to stay. We **tried every hotel** in the town, but they were all full.
(= we went to every hotel to see if they had a room)
- ☐ A: The photocopier doesn't seem to be working.
B: **Try pressing** the green button.
(= press the green button – perhaps this will help to solve the problem)

Compare:

- ☐ I **tried to move** the table, but it was too heavy. (so I couldn't move it)
- ☐ I didn't like the way the furniture was arranged, so I **tried moving** the table to the other side of the room. But it didn't look right, so I moved it back again.
(I **tried moving** it = I moved it to see if it looked better)

B need to ... and need -ing

I need to do something = it is necessary for me to do it:

- ☐ He **needs to work** harder if he wants to make progress.
- ☐ I don't **need to come** to the meeting, do I?

You can say that something **needs -ing**:

- ☐ My phone **needs charging**. (= it **needs to be charged**)
- ☐ Does your suit **need cleaning**? (= ... **need to be cleaned**)
- ☐ It's a difficult problem. It **needs thinking about** carefully.
(= it **needs to be thought about** carefully)

Compare:

- ☐ I **need to charge** my phone.
- but **My phone needs charging.**

**C** help and can't help

You can say **help to do** or **help do** (with or without **to**):

- ☐ Everybody **helped to clean** up after the party. or
Everybody **helped clean** up ...
- ☐ Can you **help me move** this table? or
Can you **help me to move** ...

I can't help doing something = I can't stop myself doing it:

- ☐ I don't like him, but he has a lot of problems.
I **can't help feeling** sorry for him.
- ☐ She tried to be serious, but she **couldn't help laughing**.
(= she couldn't stop herself laughing)
- ☐ I'm sorry I'm so nervous. I **can't help it**.
(= I can't help **being** nervous)



She **couldn't help laughing**.

Verb + **-ing** or **to ... 3** (like / would like etc.)**A** like / love / hate

When you talk about repeated actions, you can use **-ing** or **to ...** after these verbs.
So you can say:

- ☐ Do you **like getting** up early? or Do you **like to get** up early?
- ☐ Stephanie **hates flying**. or Stephanie **hates to fly**.
- ☐ I **love meeting** people. or I **love to meet** people.
- ☐ I don't **like being** kept waiting. or ... **like to be** kept waiting.
- ☐ I don't **like** friends **calling** me at work. or ... friends **to call** me at work.

but

(1) We use **-ing** (*not to ...*) when we talk about a situation that already exists (or existed).

For example:

- ☐ Paul lives in Berlin now. He **likes living** there.
(he lives there now and he likes it)
- ☐ Do you **like being** a student? (you are a student – do you like it?)
- ☐ The office I worked in was horrible. I **hated working** there. (I worked there and I hated it)

(2) There is sometimes a difference between **I like to do** and **I like doing**:

I like doing something = I do it and I enjoy it:

- ☐ I **like cleaning** the kitchen. (= I enjoy it.)

I like to do something = I choose to do it (but maybe I don't enjoy it):

- ☐ It's not my favourite job, but I **like to clean** the kitchen as often as possible.

Note that we use **-ing** (*not to ...*) with **enjoy** and **mind**:

- ☐ I **enjoy cleaning** the kitchen. (*not* I enjoy to clean)
- ☐ I **don't mind cleaning** the kitchen. (*not* I don't mind to clean)

B would like / would love / would hate / would prefer

Would like / would love etc. are usually followed by **to ...**:

- ☐ I'd **like** (= I **would like**) to go away for a few days.
- ☐ What **would** you **like to do** this evening?
- ☐ I **wouldn't like to go** on holiday alone.
- ☐ I'd **love to meet** your family.
- ☐ **Would** you **prefer to eat** now or later?

Compare **I like** and **I would like** (I'd like):

- ☐ I **like playing** tennis. / I **like to play** tennis. (= I like it in general)
- ☐ I'd **like to play** tennis today. (= I want to play today)

Would mind is followed by **-ing**:

- ☐ **Would** you **mind closing** the door, please? (*not* mind to close)

C I would like to have (done something)

I would like **to have done** something = I regret now that I didn't or couldn't do it:

- ☐ It's a shame we didn't see Anna. I **would like to have seen** her again.
- ☐ We'd **like to have gone** away, but we were too busy at home.

We use the same structure after **would love / would hate / would prefer**:

- ☐ Poor David! I **would hate to have been** in his position.
- ☐ I'd **love to have gone** to the party, but it was impossible.

prefer and would rather

A prefer to ... and prefer -ing

When you say what you prefer in general, you can use **prefer to ...** or **prefer -ing**:

- ☐ I don't like cities. I **prefer to live** in the country. or I **prefer living** in the country.

You can say:

prefer something	to something else
prefer doing something	to doing something else rather than (doing) something else
prefer to do something	rather than (do) something else

- ☐ I **prefer** this coat **to** the other one.
- ☐ I **prefer driving to travelling** by train. *or*
I **prefer driving rather than travelling** by train.
- ☐ I **prefer to drive rather than travel** by train.
- ☐ Sarah **prefers to live** in the country **rather than** in a city.

B would prefer (I'd prefer ...)

We use **would prefer** to say what somebody wants in a specific situation (not in general):

- ☐ 'Would you prefer tea or coffee?' 'Coffee, please.'

We say 'would prefer **to do** something' (*not usually* would prefer doing):

- ☐ 'Shall we go by train?' 'I'd prefer to drive.' (= I would prefer ...)
- ☐ I'd prefer to stay at home tonight rather than go to the cinema.

c would rather (I'd rather ...)

I'd rather = I **would** rather. **I'd rather do** something = I'd prefer to do it.

We say **I'd rather** do (*not* to do). Compare:

- ☐ 'Shall we go by train?' { 'I'd rather drive.' (*not* to drive)
'I'd prefer to drive.'
- ☐ Which **would** you **rather do**,
Which **would** you **prefer to do**, } go to the cinema or go shopping?

The negative is 'I'd rather not ...':

- ☐ I'm tired. I'd rather not go out this evening, if you don't mind.
- ☐ 'Do you want to go out this evening?' 'I'd rather not.'

We say 'I'd rather do one thing **than do** another':

- ☐ I'd rather stay at home tonight **than go** to the cinema.

D I'd rather somebody **did** something

We say **'I'd rather you did something'** (*not I'd rather you do*):

- ☐ 'Who's going to drive, you or me?' 'I'd rather you **drove**.' (= I would prefer this)
- ☐ 'Jack says he'll repair your bike tomorrow, OK?' 'I'd rather he **did** it today.'
- ☐ Are you going to tell Anna what happened, or **would** you rather I **told** her?

We use the *past* (**drove, did** etc.) here, but the meaning is present *not* past. Compare:

- ☐ I'd rather **make** dinner now.
I'd rather **you made** dinner now. (*not* I'd rather you make)

I'd rather **you didn't** (do something) = I'd prefer you not to do it:

- ☐ I'd rather you **didn't tell** anyone what I said.
- ☐ 'Shall I tell Anna what happened?' 'I'd rather you **didn't.**'
- ☐ 'Are you going to tell Anna what happened?' 'No. I'd rather she **didn't know.**'

Preposition (in/for/about etc.) + -ing

A If a preposition (**in/for/about** etc.) is followed by a verb, the verb ends in **-ing**:

	<i>preposition</i>	<i>verb (-ing)</i>	
Are you interested	in	working	for us?
I'm not good	at	learning	languages.
Kate must be fed up	with	studying	
What are the advantages	of	having	a car?
Thanks very much	for	inviting	me to your party.
How	about	meeting	for lunch tomorrow?
Why don't you go out	instead of	sitting	at home all the time?
Amy went to work	in spite of	feeling	ill.

You can also say 'instead of **somebody** doing something', 'fed up with **people** doing something' etc. :

- ☐ I'm fed up with **people** telling me what to do.

B We say:

before -ing, after -ing:

- ☐ **Before going** out, I phoned Sarah. (*not* Before to go out)
☐ What did you do **after leaving** school?

You can also say '**Before I went** out ...' and '... **after you left** school'.

by -ing (to say *how* something happens):

- ☐ You can improve your English **by reading** more.
☐ She made herself ill **by not eating** properly.
☐ Many accidents are caused **by people driving** too fast.
☐ The burglars got into the house **by breaking** a window and **climbing** in.

without -ing:

- ☐ We ran ten kilometres **without stopping**.
☐ It was a stupid thing to say. I said it **without thinking**.
☐ She needs to work **without** people **disturbing** her. *or* ... **without being** disturbed.
☐ I have enough problems of my own **without having** to worry about yours.

C **to + -ing** (look forward **to doing** something etc.)

We often use **to + infinitive** (**to do / to see** etc.):

- ☐ We decided **to travel** by train.
☐ Would you like **to meet** for lunch tomorrow?

But **to** is also a *preposition* (like **in/for/about/with** etc.). For example:

- ☐ We went from Paris **to Geneva**.
☐ I prefer tea **to coffee**.
☐ Are you looking forward **to the weekend**?

If we use a *preposition + verb*, the verb ends in **-ing**:

- ☐ I'm fed up **with travelling** by train.
☐ How **about going** away this weekend?

So, when **to** is a preposition and it is followed by a verb, we use **to -ing**:

- ☐ I prefer driving **to travelling** by train. (*not* to travel)
☐ Are you looking forward **to going** on holiday? (*not* looking forward to go)

be/get used to ... (I'm used to ...)

A

Study this example situation:



Lisa is American, but she lives in Britain. When she first drove a car in Britain, driving on the left was a problem for her because:

She **wasn't used to it**.

She **wasn't used to driving** on the left. (because Americans drive on the right)

But after some time, driving on the left became easier. She **got used to driving** on the left.

Now it's no problem for Lisa: She **is used to driving** on the left.

B

I'm used to something = it is not new or strange for me

You can say:

be get	used to	something or doing something
-----------	---------	------------------------------------

- ☐ Paul lives alone. He has lived alone for a long time, so it is not strange for him. He's **used to it**. He **is used to living** alone.
- ☐ I bought some new shoes. They felt a little strange at first because I **wasn't used to them**.
- ☐ Our new apartment is on a busy street. I expect we'll **get used to the noise**, but at the moment it's very disturbing.
- ☐ Helen has a new job. She has to get up much earlier now than before – at 6.30. She finds this difficult because she **isn't used to getting** up so early.
- ☐ Katherine's husband is often away from home. She doesn't mind this. She's **used to him being** away.

C

We say 'be/get used **to doing** something' (*not I'm used to do*).

- ☐ Lisa is used **to driving** on the left. (*not is used to drive*)
- ☐ I'm used **to living** alone. (*not I'm used to live*)

When we say '**I am used to ...**', **to** is a *preposition*:

- ☐ We're not used **to**

{	the noise.
	it.
	living here. (<i>not live here</i>)

Compare **to + infinitive (to do, to live etc.)**:

- ☐ We don't want **to live** here.

D

Compare **I am used to doing** and **I used to do**:

I am used to (doing) something = it isn't strange or new for me:

- ☐ I'm used **to the weather** here.
- ☐ I'm used **to driving** on the left because I've lived in Britain a long time.

I used to do something = I did it regularly in the past but no longer do it. We use this only for the past (**I used ...**), not for the present. See Unit 18.

- ☐ I **used to drive** to work every day, but these days I usually go by bike.
- ☐ We **used to live** just outside the town, but now we live near the centre.

Verb + preposition + -ing
(succeed in -ing / insist on -ing etc.)

A

We use some verbs + *preposition* + *object*. For example:

verb + *preposition* + *object*

We talked I apologised	about for	the problem. what I said.
---	----------------------------	------------------------------

If the *object* is another verb, we use **-ing**:

verb + *preposition* + **-ing**

We talked You should apologise	about for	going to South America. not telling the truth.
---	----------------------------	---

You can use these verbs in the same way:

approve of
decide against
dream of
feel like
insist on
look forward to
succeed in
think of/about

He doesn't approve We have decided I wouldn't dream I don't feel They insisted Are you looking forward Has Paul succeeded I'm thinking	of against of like on to in of/about	swearing. moving to London. asking them for money. going out tonight. paying for the meal. going away? finding a job yet? buying a house.
---	---	--

You can also say 'approve of **somebody** doing something', 'look forward to **somebody** doing something' etc.:

- ☐ I don't approve **of people killing** animals as a sport.
- ☐ We are all looking forward **to Andy coming** home next week.

B

Some verbs can have the structure *verb* + *object* + *preposition* + **-ing**.

For example:

verb + *object* + *preposition* + **-ing**

accuse ... of
congratulate ... on
prevent ... from
stop ... from
suspect ... of
thank ... for

He accused We congratulated What prevented The rain didn't stop Nobody suspected I thanked	me Lisa you us the general everyone	of on from from of for	telling lies. winning the first prize. coming to see us? enjoying our holiday. being a spy. helping me.
---	--	---	--

You can say '**stop** somebody **doing**' or '**stop** somebody **from doing**':

- ☐ You can't **stop** me **doing** what I want. or You can't **stop** me **from doing** ...

Note this example with **not -ing**:

- ☐ He accused me of **not telling** the truth.

Some of these verbs are often used in the *passive*. For example:

- ☐ We **were accused of telling** lies. (or ... **accused of lying**.)
- ☐ The general **was suspected of being** a spy.

Note that we say 'apologise **to somebody** for ...':

- ☐ I apologised **to them** for keeping them waiting. (not I apologised them)

there's no point in -ing, it's worth -ing etc.

A

We say:

there's no point in
it's no use
it's no good

doing something

- ☐ There's no point in **having** a car if you never use it.
- ☐ There was no point in **waiting** any longer, so we left.
- ☐ It's no use **worrying** about what happened. There's nothing you can do about it.
- ☐ It's no good **trying** to persuade me. You won't succeed.

We say 'no point in ...' but 'the point of ...':

- ☐ There's **no point in** having a car.
- ☐ What's **the point of** having a car if you never use it?

B

We say:

it's worth
it's not worth

doing something

- ☐ It's a nice town. **It's worth spending** a few days there.
- ☐ Our flight was very early in the morning, so **it wasn't worth going** to bed.

You can say that something is **worth it** or **not worth it**:

- ☐ You should spend a couple of days here. **It's worth it.**
- ☐ We didn't go to bed. **It wasn't worth it.**

You can also say that something is **worth doing**, a movie is **worth seeing** etc.:

- ☐ It's a great movie. It's **worth seeing**.
- ☐ Thieves broke into the house, but didn't take anything. There was nothing **worth stealing**.
- ☐ It's an interesting idea. It's **worth thinking** about.

C

We say:

have

trouble
difficulty
a problem

doing something

- ☐ I had no **trouble finding** a place to stay. (*not* trouble to find)
- ☐ Did you have **a problem getting** a visa?
- ☐ People sometimes have **difficulty reading** my writing.

D

We say:

spend
waste

(time)

doing something

- ☐ He **spent** hours **trying** to repair the clock.
- ☐ I **waste** a lot of time **doing** nothing.

We also say '(be) **busy doing** something':

- ☐ She said she couldn't meet me. She was too **busy doing** other things.

E

We use **go -ing** for sports and other activities. For example:

go sailing
go surfing

go swimming
go scuba diving

go fishing
go skiing

go riding
go jogging

go hiking
go camping

- ☐ How often do you **go swimming**?
- ☐ We **went skiing** last year.
- ☐ Tom isn't here. He's **gone shopping**.
- ☐ I've never **been sailing**.

to ..., for ... and so that ...

A

We say:

- ☐ I called the restaurant **to reserve** a table.
- ☐ What do you need **to make** bread?
- ☐ We shouted **to warn** everybody of the danger.
- ☐ This letter is **to confirm** the decisions we made at our meeting last week.
- ☐ The president has a team of bodyguards **to protect** him.

In these examples **to ... (to reserve ... / to make ... etc.)** tells us the *purpose* of something: why somebody does something, has something, needs something etc., or why something exists.

B

We say 'a place **to park**', 'something **to eat**', 'work **to do**' etc. :

- ☐ It's hard to find **a place to park** in the city centre. (= a place where you can park)
- ☐ Would you like **something to eat**? (= something that you can eat)
- ☐ Do you have **much work to do**? (= work that you must do)

Sometimes there is a preposition (**on, with** etc.) after the verb:

- ☐ Is there **a chair to sit on**? (= a chair that I can sit on)
- ☐ I get lonely if there's **nobody to talk to**.
- ☐ I need **something to open** this bottle **with**.

We also say **money/time/chance/opportunity/energy/courage** (etc.) **to** do something:

- ☐ They gave us **money to buy** food.
- ☐ Do you have **much opportunity to practise** your English?
- ☐ I need **a few days to think** about your proposal.

C

Compare **for ...** and **to ...****for + noun**

- ☐ We stopped **for petrol**.
- ☐ I had to run **for the bus**.

to + verb

- ☐ We stopped **to get** petrol.
- ☐ I had to run **to catch** the bus.

You can say '**for** somebody **to do** something':

- ☐ There weren't any chairs **for us to sit on**, so we sat on the floor.

We use **for (do)ing** to say what something is used for:

- ☐ This brush is **for washing** the dishes.

But we do not use **for -ing** to say why somebody does something:

- ☐ I went into the kitchen **to wash** the dishes. (*not* for washing)

You can use **What ... for?** to ask about purpose:

- ☐ **What** is this switch **for**? (= what is it used for?)
- ☐ **What** did you do that **for**? (= why did you do that?)

D

so thatWe use **so that (not to ...)** especially with **can/could** and **will/would**:

- ☐ She's learning English **so that** she **can** study in Canada.
- ☐ We moved to London **so that** we **could** see our friends more often.
- ☐ I hurried **so that** I **wouldn't** be late.
(= because I didn't want to be late)

You can leave out **that**. So you can say:

- ☐ I hurried **so that** I wouldn't be late. or I hurried **so** I wouldn't be late.

A hard to understand, interesting to talk to etc.

Compare sentences (a) and (b):

- ☐ James doesn't speak clearly. { (a) **It** is hard to **understand him**.
(b) **He** is hard to **understand**.

Sentences (a) and (b) have the same meaning. Note that we say:

- ☐ He is hard **to understand**. (*not* He is hard to understand him)

We use other adjectives in the same way. For example:

easy **nice** **safe** **cheap** **exciting** **impossible**
difficult **good** **dangerous** **expensive** **interesting**

- ☐ Do you think it is **safe to drink this water**?
Do you think this water is **safe to drink**? (*not* to drink it)
☐ The exam questions were very hard. It was **impossible to answer them**.
The exam questions were very hard. They were **impossible to answer**.
(*not* to answer them)
☐ Nicola has lots of interesting ideas. It's **interesting to talk** to her.
Nicola is **interesting to talk to**. (*not* to talk to her)

We also use this structure with *adjective + noun*:

- ☐ This is a **difficult question to answer**. (*not* to answer it)

B nice of (you) to ...

We say 'It's **nice of** somebody **to ...**':

- ☐ It was **nice of** you **to take** me to the airport. Thank you very much.

We use other adjectives in the same way. For example:

kind **generous** **careless** **silly** **stupid** **inconsiderate** **unfair** **typical**

- ☐ It's **silly of Ruth to give** up her job when she needs the money.
☐ I think it was **unfair of him to criticise** me.

C sorry to ... / surprised to ... etc.

You can use *adjective + to ...* to say how somebody reacts to something:

- ☐ I'm **sorry to hear** that your mother isn't well.

We use other adjectives in the same way. For example:

glad **pleased** **relieved** **surprised** **amazed** **sad** **disappointed**

- ☐ Was Julia **surprised to see** you?
☐ It was a long and tiring journey. We were **glad to get** home.

D You can use **to ...** after **the next / the last / the only / the first / the second** (etc.):

- ☐ **The next** train **to arrive** at platform 4 will be the 10.50 to Liverpool.
☐ Everybody was late except me. I was **the only** one **to arrive** on time.
☐ If I have any more news, you will be **the first to know**. (= the first person to know.)

E You can say that something is **sure/likely/bound to** happen:

- ☐ Carla is a very good student. She's **bound to pass** the exam. (= she is sure to pass)
☐ It's possible I'll win the lottery one day, but it's not **likely to happen**. (= it's not probable)

to ... (afraid to do) and preposition + -ing (afraid of -ing)

A afraid to (do) and afraid of (do)ing

I am **afraid to do** something =

I don't want to do it because it is dangerous or the result could be bad.

- ☐ This part of town is dangerous. People are **afraid to walk** here at night.
(= they don't walk here at night because it is dangerous)
- ☐ James was **afraid to tell** his parents what had happened.
(= he didn't tell them because he thought they would be angry)

I am **afraid of** something **happening** =

I am afraid that something bad will happen.

- ☐ The path was icy, so we walked very carefully. We were **afraid of falling**.
(= we were afraid that we would fall – *not* afraid to fall)
- ☐ I don't like dogs. I'm always **afraid of being** bitten.
(= I'm afraid that I will be bitten – *not* afraid to be bitten)

So, you are **afraid to do something** because you are **afraid of something happening** as a result:

- ☐ I was **afraid to go** near the dog because I was **afraid of being** bitten.

B interested in (do)ing and interested to (do)

I'm **interested in doing** something = I'm thinking of doing it, I would like to do it:

- ☐ Let me know if you're **interested in joining** the club. (*not* to join)
- ☐ I tried to sell my car, but nobody was **interested in buying** it. (*not* to buy)

I was **interested to hear/see/know** something = it was interesting for me. For example:

- ☐ I was **interested to hear** that Tanya left her job.
(= I heard this and it was interesting for me)
- ☐ I'll ask Mike for his opinion. I would be **interested to know** what he thinks.
(= it would be interesting for me to know what he thinks)

This structure is the same as **surprised to ... / glad to ...** etc. (see Unit 65C):

- ☐ I was **surprised to hear** that Tanya left her job.

C sorry for ... and sorry to ...

We use **sorry for** (doing) to apologise for something:

- ☐ I'm **sorry for shouting** at you yesterday. (*not* sorry to shout)

You can also say:

- ☐ I'm **sorry I shouted** at you yesterday.

We use **sorry to ...** to say that we regret something that happens:

- ☐ I'm **sorry to hear** that Nicky lost her job. (*not* sorry for)
- ☐ I've enjoyed my stay here. I'll be **sorry to leave**.

We also say '**I'm sorry to ...**' to apologise at the time we do something:

- ☐ I'm **sorry to bother** you, but I need to ask you a question.

D

We say:

I want to (do), I'd like to (do)	<i>but</i>	I'm thinking of (do)ing
I hope to (do)		I dream of (do)ing
I failed to (do)		I succeeded in (do)ing
I allowed them to (do)		I prevented them from (do)ing
I plan to (do)		I'm looking forward to (do)ing
I promised to (do)		I insisted on (do)ing

see somebody do and see somebody doing

A Study this example situation:

Tom got into his car and drove off. You saw this.
You can say:

- ☐ I saw Tom **get** into his car and **drive** off.

We say 'I saw him **do** something' (= he did it and I saw this). In the same way, you can say:

hear
listen to
watch
feel

somebody **do** something
something **happen**



- ☐ I didn't **hear** you **come** in. (you came in – I didn't hear this)
☐ Lisa suddenly **felt** somebody **touch** her on the shoulder.

B Study this example situation:

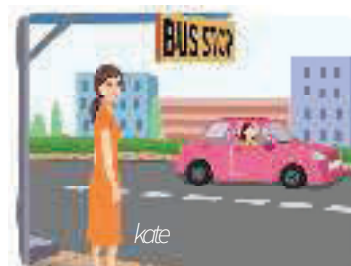
Yesterday you saw Kate. She was waiting for a bus.
You can say:

- ☐ I saw Kate **waiting** for a bus.

We say 'I saw her **doing** something' (= she was doing it and I saw this).
In the same way, you can say:

hear
listen to
watch
feel
smell
find

somebody **doing** something
something **happening**



- ☐ I could **hear** it **raining**. (it was raining – I could hear it)
☐ **Listen to** the birds **singing**!
☐ Can you **smell** something **burning**?
☐ We looked for Paul and finally we **found** him **sitting** under a tree **eating** an apple.

C Study the difference in meaning:

I **saw him do** something = he **did** something and I saw this.

I saw the complete action from start to finish:

- ☐ He **jumped** over the wall and **ran** away. I saw this.
→ I **saw** him **jump** over the wall and **run** away.
☐ They **went** out. I heard this. → I **heard** them **go** out.

I **saw him doing** something = he **was doing** something and I saw this.

I saw him *in the middle* of doing something (not from start to finish):

- ☐ I saw Tom as I drove past in my car. He **was walking** along the street.
→ I **saw** Tom **walking** along the street.
☐ I heard them. They **were talking**. → I **heard** them **talking**.

Sometimes the difference is not important and you can use either form:

- ☐ I've never seen her **dance**. or I've never seen her **dancing**.

-ing clauses (He hurt his knee **playing football.)****A**

Study this example:

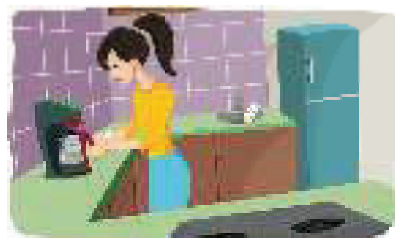
Kate is in the kitchen. She's making coffee.

You can say:

- ☐ Kate is in the kitchen **making coffee**.
-ing clause

You can use **-ing** in this way when two things happen at the same time:

- ☐ A man ran out of the house **shouting**.
 (= he ran out of the house *and* he was shouting)
- ☐ Do something! Don't just stand there **doing nothing**!
- ☐ Be careful **crossing the road**.



We also use **-ing** when one action happens during another action:

- ☐ Joe hurt his knee **playing football**. (= while he was playing)
- ☐ Did you cut yourself **shaving**? (= while you were shaving)

You can also say '**while doing** something' and '**when doing** something':

- ☐ Joe hurt his knee **while playing** football.
- ☐ Be careful **when crossing** the road. (= when you are crossing)

B

When one action happens before something else, we use **having (done)** for the first action:

- ☐ **Having found** a hotel, we looked for somewhere to eat.
- ☐ **Having finished** her work, she went home.

You can also say **after -ing**:

- ☐ **After finishing** her work, she went home.

These structures are used more in written English than in spoken English.

When we begin a sentence with '**Having** (done something)' or '**After** (doing something)', we write a comma (,) after this part of the sentence:

- ☐ **Having finished her work**, she went home.

↑
comma

C

You can also use **-ing** to explain something, or to say why somebody does something.

The sentence usually begins with **-ing**:

- ☐ **Feeling tired**, I went to bed early. (= because I felt tired)
-ing clause
- ☐ **Being** unemployed, he doesn't have much money. (= because he is unemployed)
- ☐ **Not having** a car, she finds it difficult to get around.
 (= because she doesn't have a car)

We use **having (done)** for something that is complete before something else:

- ☐ **Having seen** the film twice, I didn't want to see it again.
 (= because I had seen it twice)

These structures are used more in written English than in spoken English.

When we begin a sentence with **-ing (Feeling tired ... / Not knowing ... / Having seen ... etc.)**, we write a comma (,) after this part of the sentence.

- ☐ **Not knowing what to do**, I called my friend to ask her advice.

Countable and uncountable 1

A A noun can be *countable* or *uncountable*:

Countable

- ☐ I eat **a banana** every day.
- ☐ I like **bananas**.



Banana is a *countable* noun.

A countable noun can be singular (**banana**) or plural (**bananas**).

We can use numbers with countable nouns. So we can say **one banana, two bananas** etc.

Examples of nouns usually countable:

- ☐ Kate was singing **a song**.
- ☐ There's **a nice beach** near here.
- ☐ Do you have **a ten-pound note**?
- ☐ It wasn't your fault. It was **an accident**.
- ☐ There are no **batteries** in the radio.
- ☐ We don't have enough **cups**.

Uncountable

- ☐ I eat **rice** every day.
- ☐ I like **rice**.



Rice is an *uncountable* noun.

An uncountable noun has only one form (**rice**). There is no plural.

We cannot use numbers with uncountable nouns. We cannot say 'one rice', 'two rices' etc.

Examples of nouns usually uncountable:

- ☐ Kate was listening to **music**.
- ☐ There's **sand** in my shoes.
- ☐ Do you have any **money**?
- ☐ It wasn't your fault. It was bad **luck**.
- ☐ There is no **electricity** in this house.
- ☐ We don't have enough **water**.

B

You can use **a/an** with singular countable nouns:

a beach a student an umbrella

You cannot use singular countable nouns alone (without **a/the/my** etc.):

- ☐ Do you want **a banana**?
(*not* want banana)
- ☐ There's been **an accident**.
(*not* There's been accident)

You can use *plural* countable nouns alone:

- ☐ I like **bananas**. (= bananas in general)
- ☐ **Accidents** can be prevented.

We do not use **a/an** with uncountable nouns. We do not say 'a sand', 'a music', 'a rice'.

But you can often use **a ... of**. For example:
a bowl / a packet / a grain of rice

You can use uncountable nouns alone (without **the/my/some** etc.):

- ☐ I eat **rice** every day.
- ☐ There's **blood** on your shirt.
- ☐ Can you hear **music**?

C

You can use **some** and **any** with plural countable nouns:

- ☐ We sang **some songs**.
- ☐ Did you buy **any apples**?

We use **many** and **few** with plural countable nouns:

- ☐ We didn't take **many pictures**.
- ☐ I have a **few things** to do.

You can use **some** and **any** with uncountable nouns:

- ☐ We listened to **some music**.
- ☐ Did you buy **any apple juice**?

We use **much** and **little** with uncountable nouns:

- ☐ We didn't do **much shopping**.
- ☐ I have a **little work** to do.

Countable and uncountable 2

A

Many nouns are sometimes countable, and sometimes uncountable. Usually there is a difference in meaning. Compare:

Countable

- ☐ Did you hear **a noise** just now?
(= a specific noise)
- ☐ I bought **a paper** to read.
(= a newspaper)
- ☐ There's **a hair** in my soup!
(= one single hair)
- ☐ This is **a nice room**.
(= a room in a house)
- ☐ I had some interesting **experiences**
while I was travelling.
(= things that happened to me)
- ☐ Enjoy your trip. Have **a great time**!

Uncountable

- ☐ I can't work here. There's too much **noise**. (= noise in general)
- ☐ I need **some paper** to write on.
(= material for writing on)
- ☐ You've got very long **hair**. (*not* hairs)
(= all the hair on your head)
- ☐ You can't sit here. There isn't **room**.
(= space)
- ☐ I was offered the job because I had a lot of **experience**. (*not* experiences)
(= experience of that type of job)
- ☐ I can't wait. I don't have **time**.

Coffee/tea/juice/beer etc. (drinks) are normally uncountable:

- ☐ I don't like **coffee** very much.

But you can say **a coffee** (= a cup of coffee), **two coffees** (= two cups) etc. :

- ☐ **Two coffees** and **an orange juice**, please.

B

These nouns are usually uncountable:

accommodation	behaviour	damage	luck	permission	traffic
advice	bread	furniture	luggage	progress	weather
baggage	chaos	information	news	scenery	work

We do not normally use **a/an** with these nouns:

- ☐ I'm going to buy **some bread**. *or* ... **a loaf of bread**. (*not* a bread)
- ☐ Enjoy your holiday! I hope you have good **weather**. (*not* a good weather)

These nouns are not usually plural (so we do not say 'breads', 'furnitures' etc.):

- ☐ Where are you going to put all your **furniture**? (*not* furnitures)
- ☐ Let me know if you need more **information**. (*not* informations)

News is uncountable, not plural:

- ☐ The **news was** unexpected. (*not* The news were)

Travel (*noun*) means 'travelling in general' (uncountable). We do not say 'a travel' to mean **a trip** or **a journey**:

- ☐ They spend a lot of money on **travel**.
- ☐ We had a very good **trip/journey**. (*not* a good travel)

Compare these countable and uncountable nouns:

Countable

- ☐ I'm looking for **a job**.
- ☐ What **a beautiful view**!
- ☐ It's **a nice day** today.
- ☐ We had a lot of **bags**.
- ☐ **These chairs** are mine.
- ☐ That's **a good suggestion**.
- ☐ There were a lot of **cars**.

Uncountable

- ☐ I'm looking for **work**. (*not* a work)
- ☐ What beautiful **scenery**!
- ☐ It's nice **weather** today.
- ☐ We had a lot of **baggage/luggage**.
- ☐ **This furniture** is mine.
- ☐ That's good **advice**.
- ☐ There **was** a lot of **traffic**.

Countable nouns with **a/an** and **some**

A Countable nouns can be *singular* or *plural*:

a dog	a child	the evening	this party	an umbrella
dogs	some children	the evenings	these parties	two umbrellas

Before singular countable nouns you can use **a/an**:

- ☐ Bye! Have **a** nice **evening**.
- ☐ Do you need **an** **umbrella**?

You cannot use singular countable nouns alone (without **a/the/my** etc.):

- ☐ She never wears **a** **hat**. (*not* wears hat)
- ☐ Be careful of **the** **dog**.
- ☐ What **a** beautiful **day**!
- ☐ Did you hurt **your** **leg**?

B We use **a/an** ... to say what kind of thing something is, or what kind of person somebody is:

- ☐ That's a **nice** **table**.

In the plural we use the noun alone (*not* some ...):

- ☐ Those are **nice** **chairs**. (*not* some nice chairs)

Compare singular and plural:

- | | |
|--|--|
| ☐ A dog is an animal . | ☐ Dogs are animals . |
| ☐ I'm an optimist . | ☐ We're optimists . |
| ☐ My father is a doctor . | ☐ My parents are both doctors . |
| ☐ Jane is a really nice person . | ☐ Jane and Ben are really nice people . |
| ☐ What a lovely dress ! | ☐ What awful shoes ! |

We say that somebody has **a long nose** / **a nice face** / **blue eyes** / **long fingers** etc. :

- | | |
|---|---|
| ☐ Jack has a long nose .
(<i>not</i> the long nose) | ☐ Jack has blue eyes .
(<i>not</i> the blue eyes) |
|---|---|

We use **a/an** when we say what somebody's job is:

- ☐ Sandra is **a** **nurse**. (*not* Sandra is nurse)
- ☐ Would you like to be **an** **English teacher**?

C You can use **some** with plural countable nouns. We use **some** in two ways.

(1) **some** = a number (of) / a few (of) / a pair (of):

- ☐ I've seen **some** good **movies** recently. (*not* I've seen good movies)
- ☐ **Some** **friends** of mine are coming to stay at the weekend.
- ☐ I need **some** new **sunglasses**. (= a new pair of sunglasses)

Often you can say the same thing with or without **some**. For example:

- ☐ I need (**some**) new **clothes**.
- ☐ The room was empty apart from a table and (**some**) **chairs**.

Do not use **some** when you are talking about things in general (see Unit 75):

- ☐ I love **bananas**. (*not* some bananas)
- ☐ My aunt is a writer. She writes **books**. (*not* some books)

(2) **some** = some but not all:

- ☐ **Some** **children** learn very quickly. (but not all children)
- ☐ Tomorrow there will be rain in **some** **places**, but most of the country will be dry.

A Study this example:

I had **a sandwich** and **an apple** for lunch.

The sandwich wasn't very good, but **the apple** was nice.



Joe says '**a** sandwich', '**an** apple' because this is the first time he talks about them.

Joe now says '**the** sandwich', '**the** apple' because we know which sandwich and which apple he means – **the** sandwich and **the** apple he had for lunch.

Compare **a** and **the** in these examples:

- ☐ **A man** and **a woman** were sitting opposite me. **The man** was American, but I think **the woman** was British.
- ☐ When we were on holiday, we stayed at **a hotel**. Sometimes we ate at **the hotel** and sometimes we went to **a restaurant**.

B We use **the** when we are thinking of a specific thing. Compare **a/an** and **the**:

- ☐ Tim sat down on **a chair**. (maybe one of many chairs in the room)
- Tim sat down on **the chair nearest the door**. (a specific chair)
- ☐ Do you have **a car**? (not a specific car)
- I cleaned **the car** yesterday. (= my car)

We use **a/an** when we say what kind of thing or person we mean. Compare:

- ☐ We stayed at **a very cheap hotel**. (a type of hotel)
- The hotel where we stayed** was very cheap. (a specific hotel)

C We use **the** when it is clear which thing or person we mean. For example, in a room we talk about **the light / the floor / the ceiling / the door / the carpet** etc. :

- ☐ Can you turn off **the light**, please? (= the light in this room)
- ☐ I took a taxi to **the station**. (= the station in that town)
- ☐ (*in a shop*) I'd like to speak to **the manager**, please. (= the manager of this shop)

We also say '(go to) **the bank / the post office**':

- ☐ I have to go to **the bank** and then I'm going to **the post office**.
(The speaker is usually thinking of a specific bank or post office.)

and '(go to) **the doctor / the dentist**':

- ☐ Clare isn't well. She's gone to **the doctor**.
- ☐ I don't like going to **the dentist**.

Compare **the** and **a**:

- ☐ I have to go to **the bank** today.
Is there **a bank** near here?
- ☐ I don't like going to **the dentist**.
My sister is **a dentist**.

D We say 'once **a week** / three times **a day** / £1.50 **a kilo**' etc. :

- ☐ I go to the cinema about once **a month**.
- ☐ 'How much are those potatoes?' '£1.50 **a kilo**.'
- ☐ Helen works eight hours **a day**, six days **a week**.

A

We use **the** when there is only one of something:

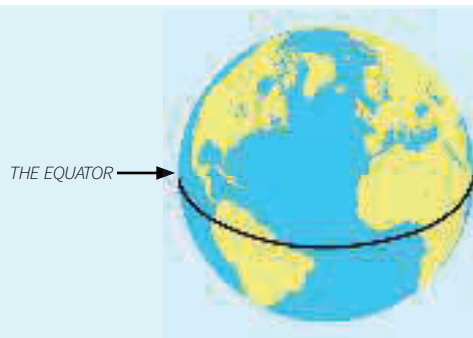
- ☐ Have you ever crossed **the equator**?
(there is only one equator)
- ☐ Our apartment is on **the tenth floor**.
- ☐ Buenos Aires is **the capital of Argentina**.
- ☐ I'm going away at **the end of this month**.

We use **the** + *superlative* (**best**, **oldest** etc.):

- ☐ What's **the longest river in Europe**?

Compare **the** and **a/an** (see also Units 71–72):

- ☐ **The sun** is **a star**. (= one of many stars)
- ☐ **The hotel** where we stayed was **a very old hotel**.
- ☐ We live in **an apartment** on **the tenth floor**.
- ☐ What's **the best way** to learn **a language**?



B

We say '**the same**':

- ☐ Your sweater is **the same** colour as mine. (*not* is same colour)
- ☐ 'Are these keys **the same**?' 'No, they're different.'

C

We say: **the world** **the universe** **the sun** **the moon** **the earth**
the sky **the sea** **the ground** **the country** (= not a town)

- ☐ I love to look at the stars in **the sky**. (*not* in sky)
- ☐ Do you live in a town or in **the country**?
- ☐ **The earth** goes round **the sun**, and **the moon** goes round **the earth**.

We also use **Earth** (without **the**) when we think of it as a planet in space (like **Mars**, **Jupiter** etc.).

- ☐ Which is the planet nearest **Earth**?

We say **space** (without **the**) when we mean 'space in the universe'. Compare:

- ☐ There are millions of stars **in space**. (*not* in the space)
- ☐ I tried to park my car, but **the space** was too small.

D

We say:

(go to) **the cinema**, **the theatre**

- ☐ I go to **the cinema** a lot, but I haven't been to **the theatre** for ages.

TV / television (without **the**), but **the radio**

- ☐ I watch **TV** a lot, but I don't listen to **the radio** much.

but Can you turn off **the television**, please? (**the** television = the TV set)

the internet

- ☐ **The internet** has changed the way we live.

E

We usually say **breakfast/lunch/dinner** (without **the**):

- ☐ What did you have for **breakfast**?
- ☐ We had **lunch** in a very nice restaurant.

But we say '**a big** lunch', '**a wonderful** dinner', '**an early** breakfast' etc.

- ☐ We had **a very nice lunch**. (*not* We had very nice lunch)

F

We say: **size 43**, **platform 5** etc. (without **the**)

- ☐ Our train leaves from **platform 5**. (*not* the platform 5)
- ☐ Do you have these shoes in **size 43**? (*not* the size 43)

In the same way, we say: **room 126**, **page 29**, **vitamin A**, **section B** etc.

the 2 (school / the school etc.)

A Compare **school** and **the school**:

Ellie is ten years old. Every day she goes **to school**. She's **at school** now. **School** starts at 9 and finishes at 3.

We say a child goes **to school** or is **at school** (as a student). We are not thinking of a specific school. We are thinking of **school** as a *general* idea – children learning in a classroom.



Today Ellie's mother wants to speak to her daughter's teacher. So she has gone to **the school** to see her. She's at **the school** now.

Ellie's mother is not a student. She is not 'at school', she doesn't 'go to school'. If she wants to see Ellie's teacher, she goes to **the school** (= Ellie's school, a specific building).

B We use **prison** (or **jail**), **hospital**, **university**, **college** and **church** in a similar way. We do not use **the** when we are thinking of the general idea of these places and what they are used for. Compare:

- ☐ When I leave school, I plan to go **to university** / go **to college**. (as a student)
- ☐ Joe had an accident last week. He was taken **to hospital**. He's still **in hospital** now. (as a patient)
- ☐ Ken's brother is **in prison** for robbery. (He is a prisoner. We are not thinking of a specific prison.)
- ☐ Sarah's father goes **to church** every Sunday. (for a religious service)

- ☐ I went to **the university** to meet Professor Thomas. (as a visitor, not as a student)
- ☐ Jane has gone to **the hospital** to visit Joe. She's **at the hospital** now. (as a visitor, not as a patient)
- ☐ Ken went to **the prison** to visit his brother. (He went as a visitor, not as a prisoner.)
- ☐ Some workmen went to **the church** to repair the roof. (a specific building)

With most other places, you need **the**. For example, **the station**, **the cinema** (see Units 72C and 73D).

C We say **go to bed** / **be in bed** etc. (*not* the bed):

- ☐ I'm going **to bed** now. Goodnight.
- ☐ Do you ever have breakfast **in bed**?

but

- ☐ I sat down on **the bed**. (a specific piece of furniture)

go to work / **be at work** / **start work** / **finish work** etc. (*not* the work):

- ☐ Chris didn't go **to work** yesterday.
- ☐ What time do you usually finish **work**?

go home / **come home** / **arrive home** / **get home** / **be (at) home** / do something **at home** etc. :

- ☐ It's late. Let's **go home**.
- ☐ I don't go out to work. I work **at home**.

the 3 (children / the children)

A

When we are talking about things or people in general, we do *not* use **the**:

- ☐ I'm afraid of **dogs**. (*not* the dogs)
(**dogs** = dogs in general, not a specific group of dogs)
- ☐ **Doctors** are usually paid more than **teachers**.
- ☐ Do you know anybody who collects **stamps**?
- ☐ **Life** has changed a lot in the last thirty years.
- ☐ Do you like **classical music** / **Chinese food** / **fast cars**?
- ☐ My favourite sport is **football/skiing/athletics**.
- ☐ My favourite subject at school was **history/physics/English**.



We say '**most** people / **most** shops / **most** big cities' etc. (*not* the most ...):

- ☐ **Most shops** accept credit cards. (*not* The most shops)

B

We use **the** when we mean specific things or people.

Compare:

*In general (without **the**)*

- ☐ **Children** learn from playing.
(= children in general)
- ☐ I couldn't live without **music**.
- ☐ All **cars** have wheels.
- ☐ **Sugar** isn't very good for you.
- ☐ **English people** drink a lot of tea.
(= English people in general)

*Specific people or things (with **the**)*

- ☐ We took **the children** to the zoo.
(= a specific group, perhaps the speaker's children)
- ☐ The film wasn't very good, but I liked **the music**. (= the music in the film)
- ☐ All **the cars in this car park** belong to people who work here.
- ☐ Can you pass **the sugar**, please?
(= the sugar on the table)
- ☐ **The English people I know** drink a lot of tea. (= only the English people I know, not English people in general)

C

The difference between 'something in general' and 'something specific' is not always very clear.

Compare:

*In general (without **the**)*

- ☐ I like working with **people**.
(= people in general)
- ☐ I like working with **people who say what they think**.
(not all people, but 'people who say what they think' is still a general idea)
- ☐ Do you like **coffee**?
(= coffee in general)
- ☐ Do you like **strong black coffee**?
(not all coffee, but 'strong black coffee' is still a general idea)

*Specific people or things (with **the**)*

- ☐ I like **the people I work with**.
(= a specific group of people)
- ☐ **The coffee we had after dinner** wasn't very good. (= specific coffee)

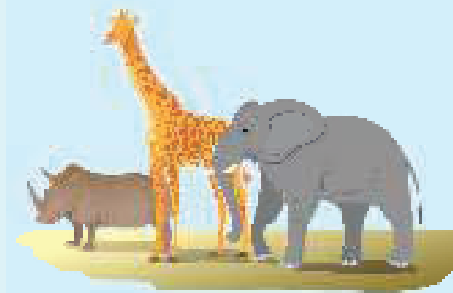
the 4 (the giraffe / the telephone / the old etc.)

A

Study these sentences:

- ☐ **The giraffe** is the tallest of all animals.
- ☐ **The bicycle** is an excellent means of transport.
- ☐ When was **the camera** invented?
- ☐ **The dollar** is the currency of the United States.

In these examples, **the** ... does not mean one specific thing.
The giraffe = a specific type of animal, not a specific giraffe.
 We use **the** ... in this way to talk about a type of animal, machine etc.



In the same way we use **the** for musical instruments:

- ☐ Can you play **the** guitar?
- ☐ **The** piano is my favourite instrument.

Compare **a** and **the**:

- ☐ I'd like to have **a** piano. *but* I can't play **the** piano.
- ☐ We saw **a** giraffe at the zoo. *but* **The** giraffe is my favourite animal.

Note that **man** (without **the**) = human beings in general, the human race:

- ☐ What do you know about the origins of **man**? (*not* the man)

B

the old, the rich etc.

We use **the** + *adjective* (without a noun) to talk about groups of people. For example:

the old	the rich	the homeless	the sick
the elderly	the poor	the unemployed	the injured

the old = old people, **the rich** = rich people etc. :

- ☐ Do you think **the rich** should pay higher taxes?
- ☐ We need to do more to help **the homeless**.

Note that we say: the **old** (*not* the olds), the **poor** (*not* the poors) etc.

The rich, the homeless etc. are *plural*. For one person, we say:

a rich man (*not* a rich) **a homeless person** (*not* a homeless)

C

the French, the Chinese etc.

We use **the** + a few nationality adjectives that end in **-ch** or **-sh**. For example:

the French the Dutch the British the English the Spanish

The meaning is *plural* – the people of that country.

- ☐ **The French** are famous for their food. (*not* French are ...)

We do not say 'a French' or 'an English' (*singular*). For example, we say:

- ☐ I met **a** French **woman** / **an** English **guy**.

We also use **the** + nationality words ending in **-ese** or **-ss**. For example:

the Chinese the Portuguese the Swiss

These words can also be singular (**a Chinese, a Swiss** etc.).

With other nationality words, the plural ends in **-s** (usually without **the**). For example:

an Italian → **Italians** a Mexican → **Mexicans** a Thai → **Thais**

- ☐ **Italians / Mexicans / Thais** are very friendly.

In all cases you can use *adjective* + **people**. For example, you can say:

- ☐ **French / Chinese / Mexican** people are very friendly.

Names with and without **the** 1

A

We do *not* use **the** with names of people ('Helen', 'Helen Taylor' etc.). In the same way, we do *not* use **the** with most names of places. For example:

continents
countries, states etc.
islands
cities, towns etc.
mountains

Africa (*not* the Africa), **South America**
France (*not* the France), **Japan, Texas**
Sicily, Tasmania
Cairo, Bangkok
Everest, Kilimanjaro



But we normally use **the** in names with **Republic, Kingdom, States** etc.:

the Czech Republic **the United Kingdom (the UK)**
the Dominican Republic **the United States of America (the USA)**

Compare:

☐ Have you been to **Canada** or **the United States**?

B

When we use **Mr/Ms/Captain/Doctor** etc. + a name, we do not use **the**. So we say:

Mr Johnson / **Doctor** Johnson / **Captain** Johnson / **President** Johnson etc. (*not* the ...)
Uncle Robert / **Saint** Catherine / **Queen** Catherine etc. (*not* the ...)

Compare:

- We called **the doctor**.
We called **Doctor** Johnson. (*not* the Doctor Johnson)

We use **Mount** (= mountain) and **Lake** before a name in the same way (without **the**):

Mount Everest (*not* the ...) **Mount** Etna **Lake** Superior **Lake** Victoria

- They live near **the lake**.
They live near **Lake Superior**. (*not the Lake Superior*)

C

We use **the** with the names of oceans, seas, rivers and canals:

the Atlantic (Ocean)	the Red Sea	the Amazon
the Indian Ocean	the Channel (between France and Britain)	the Nile
the Mediterranean (Sea)		the Suez Canal

We use **the** with the names of deserts:

the Sahara (Desert) the Gobi Desert

D

We use **the** with *plural* names of people and places:

people
countries
groups of islands
mountain ranges

the Taylors (= the Taylor family), **the Johnsons**
the Netherlands, **the Philippines**, **the United States**
the Canaries (or **the Canary Islands**), **the Bahamas**
the Andes, **the Alps**, **the Urals**

☐ The highest mountain in **the Andes** is (Mount) Aconcagua.

E

We say:

the north (of Brazil) *but* **northern** Brazil (*without* the)
the southeast (of Spain) *but* **southeastern** Spain

Compare:

Sweden is in **northern Europe**; Spain is in **the south**.

We also use **north/south** etc. (*without the*) in the names of some regions and countries:

North America South Africa southeast Asia

Note that on maps, **the** is not usually included in the name.

Names with and without **the** 2**A** Names without **the**

We do not use **the** with names of most city streets/roads/squares/parks etc. :

Union Street (*not the ...*) **Fifth Avenue** **Hyde Park**
Abbey Road **Broadway** **Times Square**

Names of many public buildings and institutions (airports, stations, universities etc.), and also some geographical names, are two words:

Manchester Airport **Harvard University**

The first word is the name of a place ('Manchester') or a person ('Harvard'). These names are usually without **the**. In the same way, we say:

Victoria Station (*not the ...*) **Canterbury Cathedral** **Edinburgh Castle**
Buckingham Palace **Cambridge University** **Sydney Harbour**

Compare:

Buckingham Palace (*not the ...*) *but* **the Royal Palace**
(‘Royal’ is an adjective – it is not a name like ‘Buckingham’.)

B Most other buildings have names with **the**. For example:

<i>hotels</i>	the Sheraton Hotel, the Holiday Inn
<i>theatres/cinemas</i>	the Palace Theatre, the Odeon (cinema)
<i>museums</i>	the Guggenheim Museum, the National Gallery
<i>other buildings</i>	the Empire State (Building), the White House, the Eiffel Tower

We often leave out the noun:

the Sheraton (Hotel) **the Palace** (Theatre) **the Guggenheim** (Museum)

Some names are only **the** + *noun*, for example:

the Acropolis **the Kremlin** **the Pentagon**

C Names with **of** usually have **the**. For example:

the Bank **of** England **the** Museum **of** Modern Art
the Great Wall **of** China **the** Tower **of** London

Note that we say:

the University **of** Cambridge *but* **Cambridge University** (*without the*)

D Many shops, restaurants, hotels etc. are named after people. These names end in **-s** or **-s**. We do not use **the** with these names:

McDonald's (*not the ...*) **Barclays** (bank)
Joe's Diner (restaurant) **Macy's** (department store)

Churches are often named after saints (St = Saint):

St John's Church (*not the ...*) **St Patrick's Cathedral**

E Most newspapers and many organisations have names with **the**:

the Washington Post **the** Financial Times **the** Sun (newspaper)
the European Union **the** BBC **the** Red Cross

Names of companies, airlines etc. are usually without **the**:

Fiat (*not the Fiat*) **Sony** **Singapore Airlines**
Kodak **IBM** **Yale University Press**

Singular and plural

A

Sometimes we use a *plural* noun for one thing that has two parts. For example:

				
trousers (<i>two legs</i>) also jeans/tights/shorts/pants	pyjamas (<i>top and bottom</i>)	glasses	binoculars	scissors

These words are plural, so they take a plural verb:

- ☐ My **trousers are** too long. (*not* My trousers is)

You can also use **a pair of** + these words:

- ☐ **Those are** nice **jeans**. or That's **a nice pair of** jeans. (*not* a nice jeans)
☐ I need **some** new **glasses**. or I need **a new pair of** glasses.

B

Some nouns end in **-ics**, but are not usually plural. For example:

athletics gymnastics economics politics
physics electronics maths (= mathematics)

- ☐ **Gymnastics is** my favourite sport. (*not* Gymnastics are)

News is not plural (see Unit 70B):

- ☐ I have **some news** for you. **It's** good news!

Some words that end in **-s** can be singular or plural. For example:

means a means of transport **many means** of transport
series a TV series **two TV series**
species a species of fish **200 species** of fish

C

Some singular nouns are often used with a plural verb. For example:

audience committee company family firm government staff team

These nouns are all groups of people. We often think of them as a number of people (= they), not as one thing (= it). So we often use a plural verb:

- ☐ **The government** (= they) **have decided** to increase taxes.
☐ **The staff** at the company (= they) **are** not happy with **their** working conditions.

In the same way, we often use a plural verb after the name of a company or a sports team:

- ☐ **Shell have** increased the price of petrol.
☐ **Italy are** playing Brazil next Sunday (in a football match).

You can also use a singular verb (The government **wants** ... / Shell **has** ... etc.).

We use a plural verb with **police**:

- ☐ **The police are** investigating the crime, but **haven't** arrested anyone yet.
(not The police is ... hasn't)

Note that we say **a police officer** / **a policeman** / **a policewoman** (*not* a police).

D

We do not often use the plural of **person** ('persons'). We normally use **people** (a *plural* word):

- ☐ He's **a nice person**. *but* They are nice **people**. (*not* nice persons)
☐ **Many people don't** have enough to eat. (*not* Many people doesn't)

E

We think of a sum of money, a period of time, a distance etc. as *one* thing. So we use a singular verb:

- ☐ **Fifty thousand pounds** (= it) **was** stolen in the robbery. (*not* were stolen)
☐ **Three years** (= it) **is** a long time to be without a job. (*not* Three years are)
☐ **Two miles isn't** very far to walk.

Noun + noun (a **bus driver** / a **headache**)

A You can use two nouns together (*noun + noun*) to mean *one* thing/person/idea etc. :
a **bus driver** **income tax** the **city centre** an **apple tree**

The first noun is like an adjective. It tells us what kind of thing/person/idea etc. :

a **bus driver** = the driver of a bus
income tax = tax that you pay on your income
 the **city centre** = the centre of the city
 an **apple tree** = a tree that has apples
 a **Paris hotel** = a hotel in Paris
 my **life story** = the story of my life

So you can say:

a **television** camera a **television** programme a **television** studio a **television** producer
 (things or people to do with television)
 language **problems** marriage **problems** health **problems** work **problems**
 (different kinds of problems)

Sometimes the first word ends in **-ing**:

a **frying** pan (= a pan for frying)
 a **washing** machine
 a **swimming** pool

B Sometimes there are more than two nouns together:

- ☐ I waited at the **hotel reception desk**.
- ☐ We watched the **World Swimming Championships** on TV.
- ☐ If you want to play table tennis (= a game), you need a **table tennis table** (= a table).

C When two nouns are together like this, sometimes we write them as one word and sometimes as two separate words. For example:

a **headache** **toothpaste** a **weekend** a **car park** a **road sign**

There are no clear rules for this. If you are not sure, write two words.

D Note the difference between:

a **coffee cup** (maybe empty) and a **cup of coffee** (= a cup with coffee in it)
 a **shopping bag** (maybe empty) and a **bag of shopping** (= a bag full of shopping)

E When we use *noun + noun*, the first noun is like an *adjective*. It is normally singular, but the meaning is often plural.

For example: a **car park** is a place to park **cars**, an **apple tree** is a tree that has **apples**.

In the same way we say:

a **three-hour** journey (= a journey that takes three **hours**)
 a **ten-pound** note (= a note with the value of ten **pounds**)
 a **four-week** course
 a **six-mile** walk
 two **14-year-old** girls

Compare:

☐ It was a **four-week** course. (*not* a four weeks course)
 but The course lasted four **weeks**.

's (your sister's name) and of ... (the name of the book)

A

We use **-s** (*apostrophe + s*) mostly for people or animals:

- ☐ **Tom's** computer isn't working. (*not* the computer of Tom)
- ☐ How old are **Chris's** children? (*not* the children of Chris)
- ☐ What's (= What is) **your sister's** name?
- ☐ What's **Tom's sister's** name?
- ☐ Be careful. Don't step on **the cat's** tail.

You can use **-s** without a noun after it:

- ☐ This isn't my book. It's **my sister's**. (= my sister's book)

We do not use **-s** after a long group of words. So we say:

my friend's mother

but the mother **of the man we met yesterday** (*not* the man we met yesterday's mother)

Note that we say **a woman's hat** (= a hat for a woman), **a boy's name** (= a name for a boy), **a bird's egg** (= an egg laid by a bird) etc.

B

With a *singular* noun we use **-s**:

my **sister's** room (= **her** room – *one sister*)

Mr Carter's house (= **his** house)

With a *plural* noun (sisters, friends etc.) we put an apostrophe (') after **s**:

my sisters' room (= **their** room – *two or more sisters*)

the Carters' house (= **their** house – *Mr and Mrs Carter*)

If a plural noun does not end in **-s** (for example **men/women/children/people**) we use **-s**:

the **men's** changing room a **children's** book (= a book for children)

You can use **-s** after more than one noun:

Jack and Karen's children **Mr and Mrs Carter's** house

C

For things, ideas etc., we normally use **of**:

the temperature **of the water** (*not* the water's temperature)

the name **of the book** the owner **of the restaurant**

We say **the beginning/end/middle of ... / the top/bottom of ... / the front/back/side of ...**:

the beginning of the month (*not* the month's beginning)

the top of the hill **the back of** the car

D

You can usually use **-s** or **of ...** for an organisation (= a group of people). So you can say:

the government's decision *or* the decision **of the government**

the company's success *or* the success **of the company**

We also use **-s** for places. So you can say:

the city's streets **the world's** population **Italy's** prime minister

E

We use **-s** with time words (**yesterday / next week** etc.):

- ☐ Do you still have **yesterday's** newspaper?

- ☐ **Next week's** meeting has been cancelled.

In the same way, you can say **today's / tomorrow's / this evening's / Monday's** etc.

We also use **-s** (or **-s'** with plural words) with periods of time:

- ☐ I've got **a week's holiday** starting on Monday.
- ☐ Julia has got **three weeks' holiday**.
- ☐ I live near the station – it's only **ten minutes' walk**.

A Study this example:



Steve **introduced himself** to the other guests.

We use **myself/yourself/himself** etc. (*reflexive pronouns*) when the *subject* and *object* are the same:

Steve introduced himself
subject object

The reflexive pronouns are:

singular (- self)	myself	yourself (one person)	himself/herself/itself
plural (- selves)	ourselves	yourselves (more than one)	themselves

- ☐ I don't want you to pay for me. I'll pay for **myself**. (not I'll pay for me)
- ☐ Amy had a great holiday. **She** really enjoyed **herself**.
- ☐ Do **you** talk to **yourself** sometimes? (said to one person)
- ☐ If you want more to eat, help **yourselves**. (said to more than one person)

Compare:

- ☐ **Lisa** introduced **me** to the other guests.
- ☐ **I** introduced **myself** to the other guests.

B We do not use **myself** etc. after **feel/relax/concentrate/meet**:

- ☐ I **feel** nervous. I can't **relax**.
- ☐ You need to **concentrate**. (not concentrate yourself)
- ☐ What time shall we **meet** tomorrow?

Normally we do not use **myself** etc. after **wash/shave/dress**:

- ☐ He got up, **washed, shaved and dressed**. (not washed himself etc.)

You can also say **get dressed** (He **got dressed**).

C Compare **-selves** and **each other**:

- ☐ Kate and Joe stood in front of the mirror and looked at **themselves**.
(= Kate and Joe together looked at Kate and Joe)
- ☐ Kate looked at Joe, and Joe looked at Kate. They looked at **each other**.



You can use **one another** instead of **each other**:

- ☐ How long have you and Ben known **each other**? or ... known **one another**?
- ☐ Sue and Alice don't like **each other**. or ... don't like **one another**.
- ☐ Do they live near **each other**? or ... near **one another**?

D We also use **myself/yourself** etc. in another way. For example:

- ☐ 'Who repaired your bike?' 'I repaired it **myself**.'

I repaired it myself = I repaired it, not another person. Here, **myself** is used to emphasise 'I' (= it makes it stronger). Some more examples:

- ☐ I'm not going to do your work for you. **You** can do it **yourself**. (= you, not me)
- ☐ **Let's** paint the house **ourselves**. It will be much cheaper.
- ☐ **The film itself** wasn't very good, but I loved the music.
- ☐ I don't think Lisa will get the job she applied for. **Lisa** doesn't think so **herself**. or **Lisa herself** doesn't think so.

a friend of mine my own house on my own / by myself

A a friend of mine / a friend of yours etc.

We say '(a friend) **of mine/yours/his/hers/ours/theirs**'.

A friend of mine = one of my friends:

- ☐ I'm going to a wedding on Saturday. **A friend of mine** is getting married. (*not* a friend of me)
- ☐ We went on holiday with **some friends of ours**. (*not* some friends of us)
- ☐ Harry had an argument with **a neighbour of his**.
- ☐ It was **a good idea of yours** to go to the cinema.

In the same way we say '(a friend) **of my sister's**' / (a friend) **of Tom's**' etc. :

- ☐ That woman over there is **a friend of my sister's**. (= one of my sister's friends)
- ☐ It was **a good idea of Tom's** to go to the cinema.

B my own ... / your own ... etc.

We say **my own / your own / her own** ... etc. :

my own house **your own** car **her own** room
(*not* an own house, an own car etc.)

my own ... / your own ... etc. = something that is only mine/yours, not shared or borrowed:

- ☐ I don't want to share a room with anybody. I want **my own room**.
- ☐ Vicky and Gary would like to have **their own house**.
- ☐ It's a shame that the apartment hasn't got **its own parking space**.
- ☐ It's **my own fault** that I have no money. I buy too many things I don't need.
- ☐ Why do you want to borrow my car? Why don't you use **your own**? (= your own car)

You can also say 'a room **of my own**', 'a house **of your own**', 'problems **of his own**' etc. :

- ☐ I'd like to have a room **of my own**.
- ☐ He won't be able to help you with your problems. He has too many problems **of his own**.

C He cuts his own hair

We also use **own** to say that we do something ourselves instead of somebody else doing it for us. For example:

- ☐ Paul usually cuts **his own hair**.
(= he cuts it himself)
- ☐ I'd like to have a garden so that I could grow **my own vegetables**.
(= grow them myself instead of buying them from shops)



D on my own / by myself

On my own and **by myself** both mean 'alone'. So you can say:

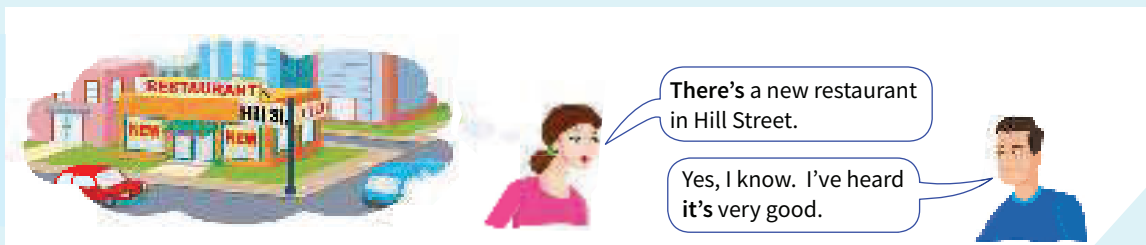
on { my / your
his / her / its
our / their } **own**

or

by { myself / yourself (*singular*)
himself / herself / itself
ourselves / yourselves (*plural*) / themselves

- ☐ I like living **on my own**. or I like living **by myself**.
- ☐ Some people prefer to live **on their own**. or ... live **by themselves**.
- ☐ Jack was sitting **on his own** in a corner of the cafe. or Jack was sitting **by himself** ...
- ☐ Did you go on holiday **on your own**? or Did you go on holiday **by yourself**?

A Study this example:



We use **there** ... when we talk about something for the first time, to say that it exists:

- ☐ **There's** a new restaurant in Hill Street.
- ☐ I'm sorry I'm late. **There was** a lot of traffic. (*not* It was a lot of traffic)
- ☐ Things are very expensive now. **There has been** a big rise in the cost of living.

It = a specific thing, place, fact, situation etc. :

- ☐ We went to the new restaurant. **It's** very good. (**It** = the restaurant)
- ☐ I wasn't expecting her to call me. **It** was a complete surprise. (**It** = that she called)

Compare **there** and **it**:

- ☐ I like this town. **There's** a lot to do here. **It's** an interesting place.

There also means 'to/at/in that place':

- ☐ The house is unoccupied. **There's** nobody living **there**. (= in the house)

B You can say:

there will be there must be there might be etc.	there must have been there should have been there would have been etc.	there is sure to be there is bound to be there is going to be	there is likely to be there is supposed to be there used to be
--	---	--	---

- ☐ 'Is **there** a flight to Rome tonight?' 'There **might be**. I'll check online.'
- ☐ If people drove more carefully, **there wouldn't be** so many accidents.
- ☐ I could hear music coming from the house. **There must have been** somebody at home.
- ☐ **There's bound to be** a cafe somewhere near here. (= There's **sure** to be ...)

Compare **there** and **it**:

- ☐ They live on a busy road. **There must be** a lot of noise from the traffic.
They live on a busy road. **It must be** very noisy. (**It** = living on a busy road)
- ☐ **There used to be** a cinema here, but it closed a few years ago.
That building is now a supermarket. **It used to be** a cinema. (**It** = that building)
- ☐ **There's sure to be** a flight to Rome tonight.
There's a flight to Rome tonight, but **it's sure to be** full. (**it** = the flight)

C We say:

- ☐ **It's** dangerous **to walk in the road**. (*not* To walk in the road is dangerous)

Normally we use **It** ... at the beginning of sentences like this. Some more examples:

- ☐ **It** didn't take us long **to get** here.
- ☐ **It's** a shame **(that) you can't come to the party**.
- ☐ **It's** not worth **waiting any longer**. Let's go.

We also use **it** to talk about distance, time and weather:

- ☐ **How far is it** from here to the airport?
- ☐ **It's a long time** since we last saw you.

Compare **it** and **there**:

- ☐ **It** was **windy**. *but* **There** was a cold wind.

- A** In general we use **some** (also **somebody/someone/something**) in positive sentences and **any** (also **anybody** etc.) in negative sentences:

some

- ☐ We **bought some** flowers.
- ☐ He's busy. He **has some** work to do.
- ☐ There's **somebody** at the door.
- ☐ I **want something** to eat.

any

- ☐ We **didn't** buy **any** flowers.
- ☐ He's lazy. He **never** does **any** work.
- ☐ There **isn't anybody** at the door.
- ☐ I **don't** want **anything** to eat.

We use **any** in the following sentences because the meaning is negative:

- ☐ She went out **without any** money. (she **didn't** take **any** money with her)
- ☐ He **refused** to eat **anything**. (he **didn't** eat **anything**)
- ☐ It's a very easy exam. **Hardly anybody** fails. (= almost **nobody** fails)

- B** We use both **some** and **any** in questions. We use **some/somebody/something** to talk about a person or thing that we know exists, or we think exists:

- ☐ Are you waiting for **somebody**? (I think you are waiting for somebody)

We use **some** in questions when we ask for or offer things:

- ☐ Can I have **some** sugar, please? (there is probably some sugar that I can have)
- ☐ Would you like **something** to eat? (there is something to eat)

But in most questions, we use **any**. We do not know if the thing or person exists:

- ☐ Do you have **any** luggage? (maybe you do, maybe not)
- ☐ Is there **anybody** in the house? (maybe there is, maybe not)

- C** You can use **if + any**:

- ☐ Let me know **if** you need **anything**.
- ☐ **If anyone** has **any** questions, I'll be pleased to answer them.

The following sentences have the idea of **if**:

- ☐ I'm sorry for **any** trouble I've caused. (= **if** I have caused **any** trouble)
- ☐ The police want to speak to **anyone** who saw the accident. (= **if** there is **anyone**)

- D** We also use **any** with the meaning 'it doesn't matter which':

- ☐ You can take **any** bus. They all go to the centre. (= it doesn't matter which bus you take)
- ☐ Come and see me **any** time you want.

We use **anybody/anyone/anything/anywhere** in the same way:

- ☐ We forgot to lock the door. **Anybody** could have come in.

Compare **some-** and **any-**:

- ☐ A: I'm hungry. I want **something** to eat.
B: What would you like?
A: I don't mind. **Anything**. (= it doesn't matter what)
- ☐ B: Let's go out **somewhere**.
A: Where shall we go?
B: **Anywhere**. I just want to go out.

- E** **Somebody/someone/anybody/anyone** are singular words:

- ☐ **Someone** is here to see you.

But we use **they/them/their** after these words:

- ☐ **Someone** has forgotten **their** umbrella. (= his or her umbrella)
- ☐ If **anybody** wants to leave early, **they** can. (= he or she can)

A no and none

We use **no** + *noun* (**no bus**, **no shops** etc.).

no = **not a** or **not any**:

- ☐ We had to walk home. There was **no bus**. (= There **wasn't a** bus.)
- ☐ Sarah will have **no trouble** finding a job. (= Sarah **won't** have **any** trouble ...)
- ☐ There were **no shops** open. (= There **weren't any** shops open.)

You can use **no** + *noun* at the beginning of a sentence:

- ☐ **No reason** was given for the change of plan.

We use **none** *without* a noun:

- ☐ 'How much money do you have?' '**None**.' (= no money)
- ☐ All the tickets have been sold. There are **none** left. (= no tickets left)

Or we use **none of** ...:

- ☐ This money is all yours. **None of it** is mine.

Compare **no**, **none** and **any**:

- ☐ I have **no luggage**.
- ☐ 'How much luggage do you have?' '**None**.' or 'I **don't** have **any**.'

After **none of** + *plural* (**none of the students**, **none of them** etc.) the verb can be singular or plural:

- ☐ None of the students **were** happy. or None of the students **was** happy.

B nothing nobody/no-one nowhere

You can use these words at the beginning of a sentence or alone (as answers to questions):

- ☐ 'What's going to happen?' '**Nobody** knows. / **No-one** knows.'
- ☐ 'What happened?' '**Nothing**.'
- ☐ 'Where are you going?' '**Nowhere**. I'm staying here.'

You can also use these words after a verb, especially after **be** and **have**:

- ☐ The house is empty. There's **nobody** living there.
- ☐ We **had nothing** to eat.

nothing/nobody etc. = **not** + **anything/anybody** etc.:

- ☐ I said **nothing**. = I **didn't** say **anything**.
- ☐ Jane told **nobody** about her plans. = Jane **didn't** tell **anybody** about her plans.
- ☐ They have **nowhere** to live. = They **don't** have **anywhere** to live.

With **nothing/nobody** etc., we do *not* use a negative verb (**isn't**, **didn't** etc.):

- ☐ I **said** nothing. (*not* I **didn't** say nothing)

C After **nobody/no-one** you can use **they/them/their** (see also Unit 85E):

- ☐ **Nobody** is perfect, are **they**? (= is he or she perfect?)
- ☐ **No-one** did what I asked **them** to do. (= him or her)
- ☐ **Nobody** in the class did **their** homework. (= his or her homework)

D Sometimes **any/anything/anybody** etc. means 'it doesn't matter which/what/who' (see Unit 85D). Compare **no-** and **any-**:

- ☐ There was **no** bus, so we walked home.
You can take **any** bus. They all go to the centre. (= it doesn't matter which bus)
- ☐ 'What do you want to eat?' '**Nothing**. I'm not hungry.'
I'm so hungry. I could eat **anything**. (= it doesn't matter what)
- ☐ It's a difficult job. **Nobody** wants to do it.
It's a very easy job. **Anybody** can do it. (= it doesn't matter who)

much, many, little, few, a lot, plenty

A

We use **much** and **little** with *uncountable* nouns:

much luck **much** time **little** energy **little** money

We use **many** and **few** with *plural* nouns:

many friends **many** people **few** cars **few** children

We use **a lot of** / **lots of** / **plenty of** with both *uncountable* and *plural* nouns:

a lot of luck **lots of** time **plenty of** money
a lot of friends **lots of** people **plenty of** ideas

plenty = more than enough:

- ☐ There's no need to hurry. We've got **plenty of** time.
- ☐ There's **plenty to do** in this town.

B

Much is unusual in positive sentences (especially in spoken English). Compare:

- ☐ We **didn't** spend **much** money. *but* We **spent a lot of** money.
- ☐ **Do you see** David **much**? *but* I **see** David **a lot**.

But we use **too much** / **so much** / **as much** in positive sentences:

- ☐ We **spent too much** money.

We use **many** and **a lot of** in all kinds of sentences:

- ☐ **Many** people drive too fast. *or* **A lot of** people drive too fast.
- ☐ Do you know **many** people? *or* Do you know **a lot of** people?
- ☐ There aren't **many** tourists here. *or* There aren't **a lot of** tourists here.

Note that we say **many years** / **many weeks** / **many days**:

- ☐ We've lived here for **many years**. (*not usually* a lot of years)

C

little = not much, **few** = not many:

- ☐ Gary is very busy with his job. He has **little time** for other things.
(= not much time, less time than he would like)
- ☐ Vicky doesn't like living in London. She has **few friends** there.
(= not many friends, not as many as she would like)

We often use **very little** and **very few**:

- ☐ Gary has **very little time** for other things.
- ☐ Vicky has **very few friends** in London.

D

a little = some, a small amount:

- ☐ Let's go and have coffee. We have **a little time** before the train leaves.
(**a little time** = some time, enough time to have a coffee)
- ☐ 'Do you speak English?' '**A little**.' (so we can talk a bit)

a few = some, a small number:

- ☐ I enjoy my life here. I have **a few friends** and we meet quite often.
(**a few friends** = not many, but enough to have a good time)
- ☐ 'When was the last time you saw Clare?' '**A few days ago**.' (= 3 or 4 days ago)

E

Compare **little** and **a little**, **few** and **a few**:

- ☐ He spoke **little English**, so it was difficult to communicate with him.
He spoke **a little English**, so we were able to communicate with him.
- ☐ She's lucky. She has **few problems**. (= not many problems)
Things are not going so well for her. She has **a few problems**. (= some problems)

We say **only a little** (*not only little*) and **only a few** (*not only few*):

- ☐ Hurry! We **only** have **a little time**. (= some, but not much time)
- ☐ The village was small. There were **only a few** houses. (= some but not many houses)

A

all	some	any	most	much	many	(a) little	(a) few	no
-----	------	-----	------	------	------	------------	---------	----

You can use these words with a noun (**some food** / **few books** etc.):

- ☐ **All cars** have wheels.
- ☐ **Some cars** can go faster than others.
- ☐ **Many people** drive too fast.
- ☐ I go away **most weekends**.
- ☐ I feel really tired. I've got **no energy**.

We do not say 'all of cars', 'some of people' etc. (see Section B):

- ☐ **Some people** learn more easily than others. (*not* Some of people)

B

all	half	some	any	most	much	many	(a) little	(a) few	none
-----	------	------	-----	------	------	------	------------	---------	------

You can use these words with **of** (**some of** / **most of** etc.):

some of	+	the ...	my ...
most of		this ...	these ...
none of etc.		that ...	those ... etc.

So you can say:

some **of the people**, some **of those people** (*but not* some of people)
 most **of my time**, most **of the time** (*but not* most of time)

- ☐ **Some of the people I work with** are very strange.
- ☐ **None of this money** is mine.
- ☐ Have you read **any of these books**?
- ☐ I was ill yesterday. I spent **most of the day** in bed.

You don't need **of** after **all** or **half**. So you can say:

- ☐ **All my friends** live near here. *or* All **of** my friends ...
- ☐ **Half this money** is mine. *or* Half **of** this money ...

Compare:

- ☐ **All flowers** are beautiful. (= all flowers in general)
- ☐ **All (of) these flowers** are beautiful. (= a specific group of flowers)
- ☐ **Most problems** have a solution. (= most problems in general)
- We were able to solve **most of the problems we had**. (= a specific group of problems)

C

You can use **all of** / **some of** / **none of** etc. + **it/us/you/them**:

all of	+	it us you them
some of		
any of		
most of		
none of etc.		

- ☐ A: Do you like this music?
B: **Some of it**. Not **all of it**.
- ☐ A: How many of these people do you know?
B: **None of them**. / **A few of them**.
- ☐ Do **any of you** want to come to a party tonight?
(*said to more than 2 people*)

We say: **all of us** / **all of you** / **half of it** / **half of them** etc. You need **of** before **it/us/you/them**:

- ☐ **All of us** were late. (*not* all us)
- ☐ I haven't finished the book yet. I've only read **half of it**. (*not* half it)

D

We also use **some/most** etc. alone, *without* a noun:

- ☐ Some cars have four doors and **some** have two.
- ☐ A few of the shops were open, but **most** (of them) were closed.
- ☐ Half this money is mine, and **half** (of it) is yours. (*not* the half)

both / both of neither / neither of either / either of

A

We use **both/neither/either** for *two* things.

You can use these words with a *noun* (**both books**, **neither book** etc.).

For example, you are going out to eat. There are two possible restaurants. You say:

- ☐ **Both restaurants** are good. (*not* the both restaurants)
- ☐ **Neither restaurant** is expensive.
- ☐ We can go to **either restaurant**. I don't mind. (= one or the other, it doesn't matter which)
- ☐ I haven't been to **either restaurant** before. (= not one or the other)

You can also use **both/neither/either** without a noun:

- ☐ 'Which do you prefer, basketball or tennis?' 'It's hard to say. I like **both**.'
- ☐ 'Is your friend British or American?' '**Neither**. She's Australian.'
- ☐ 'Do you want tea or coffee?' '**Either**. I don't mind.'

B

both of ... / neither of ... / either of ...

We use **both of / neither of / either of + the/these/my/Tom's ...** etc. So we say 'both of **the** restaurants', 'both of **those** restaurants' etc. (*but not* both of restaurants):

- ☐ **Both of these** restaurants are good.
- ☐ **Neither of the** restaurants we went to was expensive.
- ☐ I haven't been to **either of those** restaurants.

You don't need **of** after **both**. So you can say:

- ☐ **Both of these** restaurants are good. *or* **Both these** restaurants are good.

We also use **both of / neither of / either of + us/you/them**:

- ☐ (*talking to two people*) Can **either of you** speak Russian?
- ☐ I asked two people how to get to the station, but **neither of them** knew.

We say '**both of**' before **us/you/them** (you need to use **of**):

- ☐ **Both of us** were tired. (*not* Both us were ...)

After **neither of ...** a verb can be singular or plural:

- ☐ Neither of them **is** at home. *or* Neither of them **are** at home.

C

You can say:

both ... and ...

- ☐ **Both** Chris **and** Paul were late.
- ☐ I was **both** tired **and** hungry when I arrived home.

neither ... nor ...

- ☐ **Neither** Chris **nor** Paul came to the party.
- ☐ There was an accident outside our house, but we **neither** saw **nor** heard anything.

either ... or ...

- ☐ I'm not sure where Maria's from. She's **either** Spanish **or** Italian.
- ☐ **Either** you apologise, **or** I'll never speak to you again.

D

Compare **either/neither/both** (two things) and **any/none/all** (more than two):

- ☐ There are **two** good hotels here.
You could stay at **either** of them.

- ☐ We tried **two** hotels.
{ **Neither** of them had a room.
 Both of them were full.

- ☐ There are **many** good hotels here.
You could stay at **any** of them.

- ☐ We tried **a lot of** hotels.
{ **None** of them had a room.
 All of them were full.

A everybody/everyone/everything and all

We say:

- ☐ **Everybody** was happy. or **Everyone** was happy. (*not* all were happy)
- ☐ He thinks he knows **everything**. (*not* knows all)
- ☐ Our holiday was a disaster. **Everything** went wrong. (*not* all went wrong)

We do not often use **all** *alone* in this way. We do not say 'all were happy', 'he knows all' etc.

We use **all** in the following ways:

all + noun (**all cars**, **all my money** etc.)

all of + **us/you/them**

we/you/they ... all ... (see also Unit 110D)

all about ...

all ... = the only thing(s)

☐ **All my friends** were happy.

☐ **All of us** were happy.

☐ **We** were **all** happy.

☐ He knows **all about computers**.

☐ **All I've eaten today** is a banana.
(= the only thing I've eaten today)

B whole and all

Whole = complete, entire. We use **whole** mostly with *singular* nouns:

- ☐ Did you read **the whole book**? (= all the book, not just a part of it)
- ☐ Emily has lived **her whole life** in the same town.
- ☐ I was so hungry, I ate **a whole packet** of biscuits. (= a complete packet)

We do not normally use **whole** with *uncountable* nouns (**water, food, money** etc.).

We say:

- ☐ Did you spend **all the money** I gave you? (*not* the whole money)
- ☐ I read **all the information** carefully. (*not* the whole information)

We use **the/my/a** etc. before **whole**. Compare **whole** and **all**:

- ☐ I read **the whole** book. *but* I read **all the** information.

C every day / all day / the whole day

We use **every** to say how often something happens (**every day** / **every ten minutes** etc.):

- ☐ When we were on holiday, we went to the beach **every day**. (*not* all days)
- ☐ The bus service is excellent. There's a bus **every ten minutes**.
- ☐ We don't see each other very often – about **every six months**.

All day or **the whole day** = the complete day from beginning to end:

- ☐ We spent **all day** on the beach. or We spent **the whole day** ...
- ☐ Dan was very quiet. He didn't say a word **all evening**. or ... **the whole evening**.

Note that we say **all day** (*not* all the day), **all week** (*not* all the week) etc.

Compare **all the time** and **every time**:

- ☐ They never go out. They are at home **all the time**. (= always, continuously)
- ☐ **Every time** I see you, you look different. (= each time, on every occasion)

D Every/everybody/everyone/everything are singular words, so we use a singular verb:

- ☐ **Every seat** in the theatre **was** taken.
- ☐ **Everybody has** arrived. (*not* have arrived)

But we use **they/them/their** after **everybody/everyone**:

- ☐ **Everybody** said **they** enjoyed **themselves**. (= everybody enjoyed himself or herself)

each and every

A

Each and **every** are similar. Often it is possible to use **each** or **every**:

- ☐ **Each** time I see you, you look different. *or* **Every** time I see you ...

But **each** and **every** are not exactly the same.

We use **each** when we think of things separately, one by one.

- ☐ Study **each sentence** carefully.
(= study the sentences one by one)

each = X + X + X + X

Each is more usual for a small number:

- ☐ There were four books on the table.
Each book was a different colour.
☐ (*in a card game*) At the beginning of the game, **each player** has three cards.

We use **every** when we think of things as a group. The meaning is similar to **all**.

- ☐ **Every window** in the house was open.
(= all the windows in the house)

every = 

Every is more usual for a large number:

- ☐ Kate loves reading. She has read **every book** in the library. (= all the books)
☐ I'd like to visit **every country** in the world. (= all the countries)

Each (but not **every**) can be used for two things:

- ☐ In football, **each team** has eleven players. (*not every team*)

We use **every** (not **each**) to say how often something happens:

- ☐ 'How often do you use your car?' '**Every day**.' (*not Each day*)
☐ There's a bus **every ten minutes**. (*not each ten minutes*)

B

Compare the structures we use with **each** and **every**.

We use **each** with or without a noun:

- ☐ None of the rooms are the same.
Each room is different. *or*
Each is different.

Or you can use **each one**:

- ☐ **Each one** is different.

We say **each of** (the/these/them ... etc.):

- ☐ **Each of the** books was a different colour. (*not each of books*)
☐ **Each of them** was a different colour.
☐ Read **each of these** sentences carefully.

We use **every** with a noun:

- ☐ She's read **every book** in the library.

We don't use **every** alone, but you can say **every one**:

- ☐ A: Have you read all these books?
B: Yes, **every one**.

We say **every one of** ... (*but not every of*):

- ☐ I've read **every one of those** books.
(*not every of those books*)
☐ I've read **every one of them**.

C

We also use **each** in the middle of a sentence. For example:

- ☐ The students were **each** given a book. (= Each student was given a book.)

We say **a dollar each, ten pounds each** etc.:

- ☐ These oranges are **40 pence each**. (**each** = for one orange)

D

everyone and **every one**

Everyone (one word) is only for people (= everybody).

- ☐ **Everyone** enjoyed the party. (= **Everybody** ...)

Every one (two words) is for things or people:

- ☐ Sarah is invited to lots of parties and she goes to **every one**. (= to **every party**)

Relative clauses 1: clauses with **who/that/which**

A Study this example situation:

Last week we had a party and a lot of people came. Everybody enjoyed it.

Everybody **who came to the party** enjoyed it.

relative clause

A *clause* is a part of a sentence. A *relative clause* tells us which person or thing (or what kind of person or thing) the speaker means:

the woman **who lives next door to me**

(‘who lives next door to me’ tells us which woman)

people **who complain all the time**

(‘who complain all the time’ tells us what kind of people)

We use **who** in a relative clause for people (not things):

- ☐ The woman **who** lives next door to me is a doctor.
- ☐ I don't like **people who** complain all the time.
- ☐ An architect is **someone who** designs buildings.
- ☐ What was the name of **the person who** called?
- ☐ Do you know **anyone who** wants to buy a car?

We also use **that** for people, but not **which**:

- ☐ The woman **that lives next door to me** is a doctor. (*not* the woman which)

Sometimes you must use **who** (*not* that) for people – see Unit 95.

B When we are talking about things, we use **that** or **which** (*not* who) in a relative clause:

- ☐ I don't like **stories that** have unhappy endings.
or ... **stories which** have unhappy endings.
- ☐ Grace works for **a company that** makes furniture.
or ... **a company which** makes furniture.
- ☐ **The machine that** broke down is working again now.
or **The machine which** broke down ...

In these examples **that** is more usual than **which**, but sometimes you must use **which**. See Unit 95.

C In relative clauses we use **who/that/which**, not **he/she/they/it**.

Compare:

- ☐ I met a Canadian woman at the party. **She** is an English teacher. (*2 sentences*)
- ☐ I met **a Canadian woman who** is an English teacher. (*1 sentence*)
- ☐ I can't find the keys. **They** were on the table.
Where are **the keys that** were on the table? (*not* the keys they were)

D **What** = the thing(s) that

Compare **what** and **that**:

- ☐ **What happened** was my fault. (= the thing that happened)
- but
- ☐ Everything **that happened** was my fault.
(*not* Everything what happened)
 - ☐ The machine **that broke down** is now working again.
(*not* The machine what broke down)

Relative clauses 2: clauses with and without **who/that/which**

A

Look at these example sentences from Unit 92:

- ☐ **The woman who** lives next door to me is a doctor. (or The woman **that** lives ...)
The woman lives next door to me **who** (= the woman) is the *subject*
- ☐ Where are **the keys that** were on the table? (or ... the keys **which** were ...)
The keys were on the table **that** (= the keys) is the *subject*

You must use **who/that/which** when it is the *subject* of the relative clause. You cannot leave out **who/that/which** in these examples.

B

Sometimes **who/that/which** is the *object* of the verb. For example:

- ☐ The woman **who** I wanted to see was away on holiday.
I wanted to see the woman **who** (= the woman) is the *object*
I is the *subject*
- ☐ Did you find the keys **that** you lost?
you lost the keys **that** (= the keys) is the *object*
you is the *subject*

When **who/that/which** is the object, you can leave it out. So you can say:

- ☐ **The woman I wanted to see** was away. or The woman **who** I wanted to see ...
- ☐ Did you find **the keys you lost**? or ... the keys **that** you lost?
- ☐ **The dress Lisa bought** doesn't fit her very well. or The dress **that** Lisa bought ...
- ☐ Is there **anything I can do**? or ... anything **that** I can do?

Note that we say:

the keys you lost (not the keys you lost them)
the dress Lisa bought (not the dress Lisa bought it)

C

Note the position of prepositions (**to/in/for** etc.) in relative clauses:

- Tom is **talking to** a woman. Do you know her? (2 sentences)
- Do you know the woman Tom is **talking to**? (or ... the woman **who/that** Tom is talking to)
- I **slept in** a bed. It wasn't comfortable. (2 sentences)
- The bed I **slept in** wasn't comfortable. (or The bed **that/which** I slept in ...)
- ☐ Are these **the books you were looking for**? or
Are these the books **that/which** you were ...
- ☐ **The man I was sitting next to on the plane** talked all the time. or
The man **who/that** I was sitting next to ...

Note that we say:

the books **you were looking for** (not the books you were looking for them)
the man **I was sitting next to** (not the man I was sitting next to him)

D

We say:

- ☐ **Everything** (that) **they said** was true. (*not* Everything what they said)
- ☐ I gave her **all the money** (that) **I had**. (*not* all the money what I had)

What = the thing(s) that:

- **What they said** was true. (= The things that they said)

A **whose**

Study this example situation:

When we were driving home, we saw some people standing by the road. Their car had broken down, so we stopped to help them.

We helped some people **whose** car had broken down.
(= **their** car had broken down)



We use **whose** mostly for people:

- ☐ A widow is a woman **whose husband is dead**.
(**her** husband is dead)
- ☐ I met someone **whose brother I went to school with**.
(I went to school with **his/her** brother)

Compare **who** and **whose**:

- ☐ I met a man **who** knows you. (**he** knows you)
- ☐ I met a man **whose sister** knows you. (**his sister** knows you)

Do not confuse **whose** and **who's**. The pronunciation is the same, but **who's** = who **is** or who **has**:

- ☐ I have a friend **who's learning** Arabic. (**who's** = who **is**)
- ☐ I have a friend **who's just started** learning Arabic. (**who's** = who **has**)
- ☐ I have a friend **whose** sister is learning Arabic.

B **whom**

Whom is possible instead of **who** when it is the *object* of the verb (see Unit 93B):

- ☐ George is a person **whom I admire** very much. (I admire **him**)

You can also use a preposition + **whom** (**to whom** / **from whom** / **with whom** etc.):

- ☐ It's important to have friends **with whom** you can relax. (you can relax **with them**)

Whom is a formal word and we do not often use it in spoken English. We usually prefer to say:

- ☐ **a person I admire** a lot or a person **who/that** I admire a lot
- ☐ **friends you can relax with** or friends **who/that** you can relax with

C **where**

We use **where** in a relative clause to talk about a place:

- ☐ I recently went back to **the town where** I grew up. (I grew up **there**)
- ☐ **The restaurant where** we had lunch was near the airport.
- ☐ I would like to live in **a place where** there is plenty of sunshine.

D **the day, the time, the reason ...**

We say '**the day** we got married', '**the year** I was born', '**the last** time they met' etc.:

- ☐ I can't meet you on Friday. That's **the day I'm going away**.
- ☐ **The last time I saw her**, she looked great.

You can also use **that**:

- ☐ The last time **that** I saw her, she looked great.

We say '**the reason** I'm calling you', '**the reason** she didn't get the job' etc.

- ☐ **The reason I'm calling you** is to ask your advice.

You can also use **that**:

- ☐ The reason **that** I'm calling you ... or The reason **why** I'm calling you ...

Relative clauses 4: extra information clauses (1)

A

There are two types of relative clause. In these examples, the relative clauses are underlined. Compare:

Type 1

- ☐ The woman who lives next door to me is a doctor.
- ☐ Grace works for a company that makes furniture.
- ☐ We stayed at the hotel (that) you recommended.

In these examples, the relative clauses tell you which person or thing (or what kind of person or thing) the speaker means:

‘The woman **who lives next door to me**’ tells us *which* woman.

‘A company **that makes furniture**’ tells us *what kind* of company.

‘The hotel **(that) you recommended**’ tells us *which* hotel.

We do not use commas (,) with these clauses:

- ☐ We know a lot of people who live in London.

Type 2

- ☐ My brother Ben, who lives in Hong Kong, is an architect.
- ☐ Anna told me about her new job, which she’s enjoying a lot.
- ☐ We stayed at the Park Hotel, which a friend of ours recommended.

In these examples, the relative clauses do not tell you which person or thing the speaker means. We already know which thing or person is meant: ‘My brother Ben’, ‘Anna’s new job’ and ‘the Park Hotel’.

The relative clauses in these sentences give us *extra information* about the person or thing.

We use commas (,) with these clauses:

- ☐ My brother Ben, who lives in Hong Kong, is an architect.

B

In both types of relative clause we use **who** for people and **which** for things. But:

Type 1

You can use **that**:

- ☐ Do you know anyone **who/that** speaks French and Italian?
- ☐ Grace works for a company **which/that** makes furniture.

You can leave out **who/which/that** when it is the object (see Unit 93):

- ☐ We stayed at **the hotel** (that/which) **you recommended**.
- ☐ This morning I met **somebody** (who/that) **I hadn’t seen for ages**.

We do not often use **whom** in this type of clause (see Unit 94B).

Type 2

You cannot use **that**:

- ☐ John, **who** speaks French and Italian, works as a tour guide. (*not that speaks*)
- ☐ Anna told me about her new job, **which** she’s enjoying a lot.

You cannot leave out **who** or **which**:

- ☐ We stayed at the Park Hotel, **which** a friend of ours recommended.
- ☐ This morning I met Chris, **who** I hadn’t seen for ages.

You can use **whom** for people (when it is the object):

- ☐ This morning I met Chris, **whom** I hadn’t seen for ages.

C

In both types of relative clause you can use **whose** and **where**:

- ☐ We helped some people **whose** car had broken down.
- ☐ What’s the name of the place **where** you went on holiday?
- ☐ Lisa, **whose** car had broken down, was in a very bad mood.
- ☐ Kate has just been to Sweden, **where** her daughter lives.

Relative clauses 5: extra information clauses (2)

A *preposition + whom/which*

You can use a *preposition* + **whom** (for people) and **which** (for things).

So you can say:

to whom	with whom	about whom	<i>etc.</i>
of which	without which	from which	<i>etc.</i>

- ☐ Mr Lee, **to whom I spoke** at the meeting, is interested in our proposal.
- ☐ Fortunately we had a good map, **without which** we would have got lost.

In spoken English we often keep the preposition after the verb in the relative clause:

- ☐ Katherine told me she works for a company called 'Latoma', **which** I'd never **heard of** before.

We do not use **whom** when the preposition is in this position:

- ☐ Mr Lee, **who I spoke to** at the meeting, is interested in our proposal.
(*not* Mr Lee, whom I spoke to ...)

For prepositions in relative clauses, see also Unit 93C.

B *all of / most of etc. + whom/which*

You can say:

- ☐ Helen has three brothers, **all of whom** are married.
- ☐ They asked me a lot of questions, **most of which** I couldn't answer.

In the same way you can say:

many of whom	some of whom	neither of whom	<i>etc.</i>	(for people)
none of which	both of which	one of which	<i>etc.</i>	(for things)

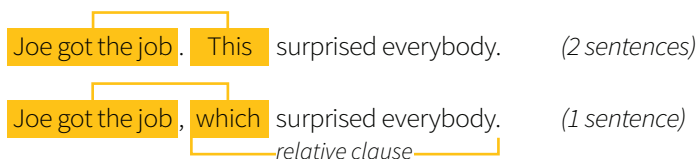
- ☐ Martin tried on three jackets, **none of which** fitted him.
- ☐ Two men, **neither of whom** I had seen before, came into the office.
- ☐ They have three cars, **two of which** they rarely use.
- ☐ Sue has a lot of friends, **many of whom** she was at school with.

You can also say:

- the cause of which** **the name of which** *etc.*
- ☐ The house was damaged in a fire, **the cause of which** was never established.
- ☐ We stayed at a beautiful hotel, **the name of which** I don't remember now.

C *which (not what)*

Study this example:



In this example, **which** = 'the fact that Joe got the job'. We use **which** (*not* what) in sentences like these:

- ☐ Sarah couldn't meet us, **which** was a shame. (*not* what was a shame)
- ☐ The weather was good, **which** we hadn't expected. (*not* what we hadn't expected)

For **what** and **that**, see Units 92D and 93D.

-ing and -ed clauses (the woman **talking to Tom, the boy **injured in the accident**)**

A

A *clause* is a part of a sentence. Some clauses begin with **-ing**. For example:

Who is the woman **talking to Tom?**
 └─ *ing clause* ─┘

the woman
talking to Tom



We use **-ing** clauses to say what somebody (or something) is (or was) doing at a particular time:

- ☐ Who is the woman **talking to Tom**? (the woman **is talking to** Tom)
- ☐ Police **investigating the crime** are looking for three men. (police **are investigating** the crime)
- ☐ Who were those people **waiting outside**? (they **were waiting**)
- ☐ I was woken up by a bell **ringing**. (a bell **was ringing**)

You can also use an **-ing** clause to say what happens all the time, not just at a particular time:

- ☐ The road **connecting** the two villages is very narrow. (the road **connects** the two villages)
- ☐ I have a large room **overlooking** the garden. (the room **overlooks** the garden)
- ☐ Can you think of the name of a flower **beginning with T**? (the name **begins** with T)

B

Some clauses begin with **-ed** (**injured, painted** etc.). For example:

The boy **injured in the accident** was taken to hospital.

the boy injured
in the accident



-ed clauses have a *passive* meaning:

- ☐ The boy **injured in the accident** was taken to hospital.
(he **was injured** in the accident)
- ☐ George showed me some pictures **painted by his father**.
(they **were painted** by his father)
- ☐ The gun **used in the robbery** has been found.
(the gun **was used** in the robbery)

Injured/painted/used are *past participles*. Most past participles end in **-ed**, but many are irregular (**stolen/made/built** etc.):

- ☐ The police never found the money **stolen in the robbery**.
- ☐ Most of the goods **made in this factory** are exported.

C

You can use **there is / there was** (etc.) + **-ing** and **-ed** clauses:

- ☐ **There were** some children **swimming** in the river.
- ☐ **Is there** anybody **waiting**?
- ☐ **There was** a big red car **parked** outside the house.

We use **left** in this way, with the meaning ‘not used, still there’:

- We've eaten nearly all the chocolates. **There are** only a few **left**.

Adjectives ending in **-ing** and **-ed** (**boring/bored** etc.)

- A** Many adjectives end in **-ing** and **-ed**, for example: **boring** and **bored**.
Study this example situation:



Jane has been doing the same job for a very long time. Every day she does exactly the same thing again and again. She doesn't enjoy her job any more and would like to do something different.

Jane's job is **boring**.

Jane is **bored** with her job.

Somebody is **bored** or gets **bored** if something (or somebody else) is **boring**.
If something is **boring**, you get **bored** with it.

So:

- ☐ Jane is **bored** because her job is **boring**.
- ☐ Jane's job is **boring**, so Jane is **bored**. (*not* Jane is boring)

If a person is **boring**, this means that they make other people **bored**:

- ☐ Paul always talks about the same things. He's really **boring**.

- B** Compare adjectives ending in **-ing** and **-ed**:

- ☐ My job is { **boring**
interesting
tiring
satisfying
depressing (etc.)

In these examples, the **-ing** adjective tells you about the job

- ☐ I'm **bored** with my job.
- ☐ I'm not **interested** in my job any more.
- ☐ I get very **tired** doing my job.
- ☐ I'm not **satisfied** with my job.
- ☐ My job makes me **depressed**. (etc.)

In these examples, the **-ed** adjective tells you how somebody feels (about the job).

Compare these examples:

interesting

- ☐ Julia thinks politics is **interesting**.
- ☐ Did you meet anyone **interesting** at the party?

surprising

- ☐ It was **surprising** that he passed the exam.

disappointing

- ☐ The movie was **disappointing**. We expected it to be better.

shocking

- ☐ The news was **shocking**.

interested

- ☐ Julia is **interested** in politics. (*not* interesting in politics)
- ☐ Are you **interested** in buying a car? I'm trying to sell mine.

surprised

- ☐ Everybody was **surprised** that he passed the exam.

disappointed

- ☐ We were **disappointed** with the movie. We expected it to be better.

shocked

- ☐ I was **shocked** when I heard the news.

Adjectives: a **nice new** house, you look **tired**

A

Sometimes we use two or more adjectives together:

- ☐ My brother lives in a **nice new** house.
- ☐ In the kitchen there was a **beautiful large round wooden** table.

Adjectives like **new/large/round/wooden** are *fact* adjectives. They give us information about age, size, colour etc.

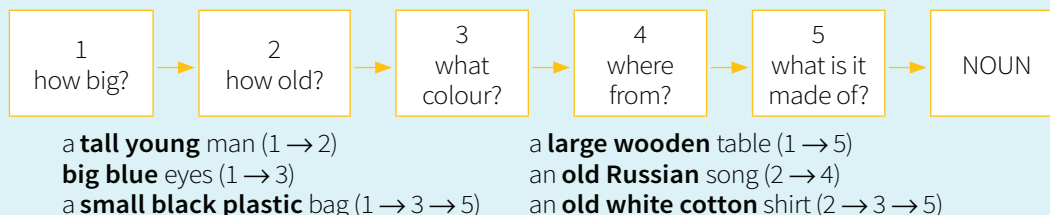
Adjectives like **nice/beautiful** are *opinion* adjectives. They tell us what the speaker thinks of something or somebody.

Opinion adjectives usually go before fact adjectives.

	<i>opinion</i>	<i>fact</i>	
a	nice	long	summer holiday
an	interesting	young	man
	delicious	hot	vegetable soup
a	beautiful	large round wooden	table

B

Sometimes we use two or more fact adjectives together. Usually (not always) we put fact adjectives in this order:



Adjectives of size and length (**big/small/tall/short/long** etc.) usually go before adjectives of shape and width (**round/fat/thin/slim/wide** etc.):

a **large round** table a **tall thin** girl a **long narrow** street

When there are two or more colour adjectives, we use **and**:

a **black and white** dress a **red, white and green** flag

This does not usually happen with other adjectives before a noun:

a **long black** dress (not a long and black dress)

C

We use adjectives after **be/get/become/seem**:

- ☐ **Be careful!**
- ☐ I'm **tired** and I'm **getting hungry**.
- ☐ As the film went on, it **became** more and more **boring**.
- ☐ Your friend **seems** very **nice**.

We also use adjectives to say how somebody/something looks, feels, sounds, tastes or smells:

- ☐ You **look tired**. / I **feel tired**. / She **sounds tired**.
- ☐ The dinner **smells good**.
- ☐ This tea **tastes** a bit **strange**.

But to say *how* somebody *does something* you must use an *adverb* (see Units 100–101):

- ☐ Drive **carefully!** (not Drive careful)
- ☐ Suzanne plays the piano very **well**. (not plays ... very good)

D

We say 'the **first two** days', 'the **next few** weeks', 'the **last ten** minutes' etc. :

- ☐ I didn't enjoy the **first two** days of the course. (not the two first days)
- ☐ They'll be away for the **next few** weeks. (not the few next weeks)

Adjectives and adverbs 1 (quick/quickly)

A

You can say:

- ☐ Our holiday was too short – the time passed very **quickly**.
- ☐ Two people were **seriously** injured in the accident.

Quickly and **seriously** are *adverbs*. Many adverbs are *adjective + -ly*:

<i>adjective</i>	quick	serious	careful	bad	heavy	terrible
<i>adverb</i>	quickly	seriously	carefully	badly	heavily	terribly

For spelling, see Appendix 6.

Not all words ending in **-ly** are adverbs. Some *adjectives* end in **-ly** too, for example:

friendly **lively** **elderly** **lonely** **lovely**

- ☐ It was a **lovely** day.

B

Adjective or adverb?

Adjectives (**quick/careful** etc.) tell us about a *noun* (somebody or something). We use adjectives before nouns:

- ☐ Sam is a **careful driver**.
(*not* a carefully driver)
- ☐ We didn't go out because of the **heavy rain**.

Adverbs (**quickly/carefully** etc.) tell us about a *verb* (*how* somebody does something or *how* something happens):

- ☐ Sam **drove carefully** along the narrow road. (*not* drove careful)
- ☐ We didn't go out because it was **raining heavily**. (*not* raining heavy)

Compare:

- ☐ She speaks **perfect English**.
adjective + noun

- ☐ She **speaks English perfectly**.
verb + noun + adverb

C

We use adjectives after some verbs, especially **be**, and also **look/feel/sound** etc.

Compare:

- ☐ Please **be quiet**.
- ☐ My exam results **were** really **bad**.
- ☐ Why do you always **look** so **serious**?
- ☐ I **feel** happy.

- ☐ Please **speak** quietly.
- ☐ I **did** really **badly** in the exam.
- ☐ Why do you never **take** me **seriously**?
- ☐ The children were **playing** happily.

D

You can also use adverbs before *adjectives* and *other adverbs*. For example:

reasonably cheap (*adverb + adjective*)
terribly sorry (*adverb + adjective*)
incredibly quickly (*adverb + adverb*)

- ☐ It's a **reasonably cheap** restaurant and the food is **extremely good**.
- ☐ I'm **terribly sorry**. I didn't mean to push you.
- ☐ Maria learns languages **incredibly quickly**.
- ☐ The exam was **surprisingly easy**.

You can also use an adverb before a *past participle* (**injured/organised/written** etc.):

- ☐ Two people were **seriously injured** in the accident. (*not* serious injured)
- ☐ The conference was **badly organised**.

Adjectives and adverbs 2 (well, fast, late, hard/hardly)

A good and well

Good is an *adjective*. The *adverb* is **well**:

- ☐ Your English is **good**. *but* You **speak** English **well**.
- ☐ Sophie is a **good** pianist. *but* Sophie **plays** the piano **well**.

We use **well** (*not* good) with *past participles* (**known/educated** etc.). For example:

- well-known well-educated well-paid well-behaved**
- ☐ Sophie's father is a **well-known** writer.

Well is also an adjective meaning 'in good health':

- ☐ 'How are you today?' 'I'm very **well**, thanks.'

B fast, hard and late

These words are both adjectives and adverbs:

- | <i>adjective</i> | <i>adverb</i> |
|--|--|
| ☐ Darren is a fast runner. | Darren can run fast . |
| ☐ It's hard to find a job right now. | Kate works hard . (<i>not</i> works hardly) |
| ☐ Sorry I'm late . | I got up late . |

lately = recently:

- ☐ Have you seen Kate **lately**?

C hardly

hardly = very little, almost not:

- ☐ Sarah wasn't very friendly at the party. She **hardly** spoke to me. (= she spoke to me very little)
- ☐ We've only met once or twice. We **hardly** know each other.

Compare **hard** and **hardly**:

- ☐ He tried **hard** to find a job, but he had no luck. (= he tried a lot, with a lot of effort)
- ☐ I'm not surprised he didn't find a job. He **hardly** tried. (= he tried very little)

Hardly goes before the verb:

- ☐ We **hardly** **know** each other. (*not* We know each other hardly)

I **can hardly** do something = it's very difficult for me, almost impossible:

- ☐ Your writing is terrible. I **can hardly** read it. (= it is almost impossible to read it)
- ☐ My leg was hurting. I **could hardly** walk.

D You can use **hardly** + **any/anybody/anyone/anything/anywhere**:

- ☐ A: How much money do we have?
B: **Hardly any**. (= very little, almost none)
- ☐ These two cameras are very similar. There's **hardly any** difference between them.
- ☐ The exam results were bad. **Hardly anybody** in our class passed. (= very few students passed)
- ☐ She was very quiet. She said **hardly anything**. *or* She **hardly** said **anything**.

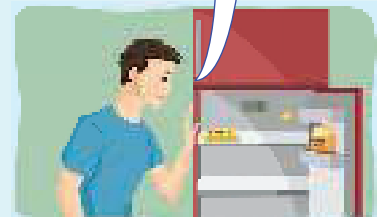
hardly ever = almost never:

- ☐ I'm nearly always at home in the evenings. I **hardly ever** go out.

Hardly also means 'certainly not'. For example:

- ☐ It's **hardly surprising** that you're tired. You haven't slept for three days. (= it's certainly not surprising)
- ☐ The situation is serious, but it's **hardly a crisis**. (= it's certainly not a crisis)

There's **hardly anything** in the fridge.



A Compare **so** and **such**:We use **so** + *adjective/adverb*:

so stupid **so quick**
so nice **so quickly**

- ☐ I didn't like the book. The story was **so stupid**.
- ☐ Everything happened **so quickly**.

We use **such** + *noun*:

such a story **such people**

We also use **such** + *adjective* + *noun*:

such a stupid story **such nice people**

- ☐ I didn't like the book. It was **such a stupid story**. (*not a so stupid story*)
- ☐ I like Liz and Joe. They are **such nice people**. (*not so nice people*)

We say **such a ...** (*not a such*):

such a big dog

B **So** and **such** make the meaning stronger:

- ☐ I've had a busy day. I'm **so tired**. (= really tired)
- ☐ It's difficult to understand him. He talks **so quietly**.

You can use **so ... that**:

- ☐ I was **so tired that** I fell asleep in the armchair.

We usually leave out **that**:

- ☐ I was **so tired** I fell asleep.

- ☐ We had a great trip. We had **such a good time**. (= a really good time)
- ☐ You always think good things are going to happen. You're **such an optimist**.

You can use **such ... that**:

- ☐ It was **such nice weather that** we spent the whole day on the beach.

We usually leave out **that**:

- ☐ It was **such nice weather** we spent ...

C **So** and **such** also mean 'like this':

- ☐ Somebody told me the house was built 100 years ago. I didn't realise it was **so old**. (= as old as it is)
- ☐ I'm tired because I got up at six. I don't usually get up **so early**.
- ☐ I expected the weather to be cooler. I'm surprised it is **so warm**.

- ☐ I didn't realise it was **such an old house**.
- ☐ You know it's not true. How can you say **such a thing**? (= a thing like this)

Note the expression **no such ...**:

- ☐ You won't find the word 'blid' in the dictionary. There's **no such word**. (= this word does not exist)

D Compare:

so long

- ☐ I haven't seen her for **so long** I've forgotten what she looks like.

such a long time

- ☐ I haven't seen her for **such a long time**. (*not so long time*)

so far

- ☐ I didn't know it was **so far**.

such a long way

- ☐ I didn't know it was **such a long way**.

so much, so many

- ☐ I'm sorry I'm late – there was **so much** traffic.

such a lot (of)

- ☐ I'm sorry I'm late – there was **such a lot** of traffic.

A enough

Enough goes *after* adjectives and adverbs:

- ☐ I can't run very far. I'm not **fit enough**. (*not enough fit*)
- ☐ Let's go. We've waited **long enough**.

Enough normally goes *before* nouns:

- ☐ We have **enough money**. We don't need any more.
- ☐ There weren't **enough chairs**. Some of us had to sit on the floor.

We also use **enough** alone (without a noun or adjective):

- ☐ We don't need more money. We have **enough**.

I'm not fit enough.



B too and enough

Compare **too ...** and **not ... enough**:

- ☐ You never stop working. You work **too hard**. (= more than is necessary)
- ☐ You're lazy. You **don't** work **hard enough**. (= less than is necessary)

Compare **too much/many** and **enough**:

- ☐ There's **too much furniture** in this room. There's not **enough space**.
- ☐ There were **too many people** and not **enough chairs**.

C enough/too + for ... and to ...

We say **enough/too ... for** somebody/something:

- ☐ Does Joe have enough experience **for the job**?
- ☐ This bag isn't big enough **for all my clothes**.
- ☐ That shirt is too small **for you**. You need a larger size.

We say **enough/too ... to** do something. For example:

- ☐ Does Joe have enough experience **to do** the job?
- ☐ Let's get a taxi. It's too far **to walk** home from here.
- ☐ She's not old enough **to have** a driving licence.

The next example has both **for ...** and **to ...**:

- ☐ The bridge is just wide enough **for two cars to pass** one another.

D too hot to eat etc.

We say:

The food was very hot. We couldn't eat **it**.
and
The food was so hot that we couldn't eat **it**.
but
The food was **too hot to eat**. (*not to eat it*)

In the same way we say:

- ☐ These boxes are **too heavy to carry**. (*not to carry them*)
- ☐ The wallet was **too big to put in my pocket**. (*not to put it*)
- ☐ This chair isn't **strong enough to stand on**. (*not to stand on it*)

The wallet doesn't fit in my pocket.



quite, pretty, rather and fairly

A

Quite and **pretty** are similar in meaning (= less than 'very', but more than 'a little'):

- ☐ I'm surprised you haven't heard of her. She's **quite famous**. or She's **pretty famous**. (= less than 'very famous', but more than 'a little famous')
- ☐ Anna lives **quite near** me, so we see each other **pretty often**.

Pretty is an informal word and is used mainly in spoken English.

Quite goes before **a/an**:

- ☐ We live in **quite an old house**. (*not* a quite old house)

Compare:

- ☐ Sarah has **quite a** good job.
Sarah has **a pretty** good job.

You can also use **quite** (but not **pretty**) in the following ways:

quite a/an + noun (without an adjective):

- ☐ I didn't expect to see them. It was **quite a surprise**. (= quite a big surprise)

quite a lot (of ...):

- ☐ There were **quite a lot of** guests at the wedding.

quite + verb, especially **like** and **enjoy**:

- ☐ I **quite like** tennis, but it's not my favourite sport.

B

Rather is similar to **quite** and **pretty**. We often use **rather** for negative ideas (things we think are not good):

- ☐ The weather isn't so good. It's **rather cloudy**.
- ☐ Paul is **rather shy**. He doesn't talk very much.

Quite is also possible in these examples.

When we use **rather** for positive ideas (**good/nice** etc.), it means 'unusually' or 'surprisingly':

- ☐ These oranges are **rather good**. Where did you get them?

C

Fairly is weaker than **quite/rather/pretty**. For example, if something is **fairly good**, it is not very good and it could be better:

- ☐ My room is **fairly big**, but I'd prefer a bigger one.
- ☐ We see each other **fairly often**, but not as often as we used to.

D

Quite also means 'completely'. For example:

- ☐ 'Are you sure?' 'Yes, **quite sure**.' (= completely sure)

Quite means 'completely' with a number of adjectives, especially:

sure	right	true	clear	different	incredible	amazing
certain	wrong	safe	obvious	unnecessary	extraordinary	impossible

- ☐ She was **quite different** from what I expected. (= completely different)
- ☐ Everything they said was **quite true**. (= completely true)

We also use **quite** (= completely) with some verbs. For example:

- ☐ I **quite agree** with you. (= I completely agree)

not quite = not completely:

- ☐ I **don't quite understand** what you mean.
- ☐ 'Are you ready yet?' '**Not quite**.' (= not completely)

Compare the two meanings of **quite**:

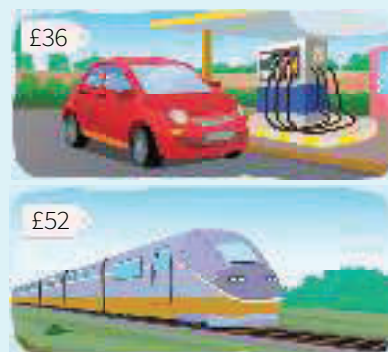
- ☐ The story is **quite interesting**. (= less than 'very interesting')
- ☐ The story is **quite true**. (= completely true)

Comparative 1 (**cheaper, more expensive** etc.)**A** Look at these examples:

How shall we travel? Shall we drive or go by train?

Let's drive. It's **cheaper**.Don't go by train. It's **more expensive**.**Cheaper** and **more expensive** are *comparative* forms.After comparatives you can use **than** (see Unit 107):

- ☐ It's **cheaper** to drive **than** go by train.
- ☐ Going by train is **more expensive than** driving.

**B** The comparative form is **-er** or **more** ...We use **-er** for short words (one syllable):

cheap → cheaper **fast** → faster
large → larger **thin** → thinner

We also use **-er** for two-syllable words that end in **-y** (**-y** → **-ier**):

lucky → luckier **early** → earlier
easy → easier **pretty** → prettier

For spelling, see Appendix 6.

We use **more** ... for longer words (two syllables or more):

more serious **more expensive**
more often **more comfortable**

We also use **more** ... for adverbs that end in **-ly**:

more slowly **more seriously**
more easily **more quietly**

Compare these examples:

- ☐ You're **older** than me.
- ☐ The exam was quite easy – **easier** than I expected.
- ☐ Can you walk a bit **faster**?
- ☐ I'd like to have a **bigger** car.
- ☐ Last night I went to bed **earlier** than usual.

- ☐ You're **more patient** than me.
- ☐ The exam was quite difficult – **more difficult** than I expected.
- ☐ Can you walk a bit **more slowly**?
- ☐ I'd like to have a **more reliable** car.
- ☐ I don't play tennis much these days. I used to play **more often**.

We use both **-er** or **more** ... with some two-syllable adjectives, especially:**clever** **narrow** **quiet** **shallow** **simple**

- ☐ It's too noisy here. Can we go somewhere **quieter**? or ... somewhere **more quiet**?

C A few adjectives and adverbs have irregular comparative forms:**good/well** → **better**

- ☐ The garden looks **better** since you tidied it up.
- ☐ I know him well – probably **better** than anybody else knows him.

bad/badly → **worse**

- ☐ 'How's your headache? Better?' 'No, it's **worse**.'
- ☐ He did very badly in the exam – **worse** than expected.

far → **further** (or **farther**)

- ☐ It's a long walk from here to the park – **further** than I thought. (or **farther** than)

Note that **further** (*but not farther*) also means 'more' or 'additional':

- ☐ Let me know if you hear any **further** news. (= any more news)

Comparative 2 (much better / any better etc.)

A much / a lot etc. + comparative

Before comparatives you can use:

much **a lot** **far** (= a lot) **a bit** **a little** **slightly** (= a little)

- ☐ I felt ill earlier, but I feel **much better** now. (or **a lot better**)
- ☐ Don't go by train. It's **a lot more expensive**. (or **much more expensive**)
- ☐ Could you speak **a bit more slowly**? (or **a little more slowly**)
- ☐ This bag is **slightly heavier** than the other one.
- ☐ The problem is **far more serious** than we thought at first.

B any / no + comparative

You can use **any** and **no** + comparative (**any longer** / **no bigger** etc.):

- ☐ I've waited long enough. I'm not waiting **any longer**. (= not even a little longer)
- ☐ We expected their apartment to be very big, but it's **no bigger** than ours.
or ... it **isn't any bigger** than ours. (= not even a little bigger)
- ☐ How do you feel now? Do you feel **any better**?
- ☐ This hotel is better than the other one, and it's **no more expensive**.

C better and better, more and more etc.

We repeat comparatives (**better and better** etc.) to say that something changes continuously:

- ☐ Your English is improving. It's getting **better and better**.
- ☐ The city has grown fast in recent years. It's got **bigger and bigger**.
- ☐ As I listened to his story, I became **more and more convinced** that he was lying.
- ☐ **More and more tourists** are visiting this part of the country.

D the ... the ...

You can say **the sooner the better**, **the more the better** etc.:

- ☐ A: What time shall we leave?
B: **The sooner the better**. (= as soon as possible)
- ☐ A: What sort of bag do you want? A big one?
B: Yes, **the bigger the better**. (= as big as possible)
- ☐ When you're travelling, **the less luggage** you have **the better**.

We also use **the ... the ...** to say that one thing depends on another thing:

- ☐ **The sooner** we leave, **the earlier** we'll arrive. (= if we leave sooner, we'll arrive earlier)
- ☐ **The younger** you are, **the easier** it is to learn.
- ☐ **The more expensive** the hotel, **the better** the service.
- ☐ **The more** I thought about the plan, **the less** I liked it.

E older and elder

The comparative of **old** is **older**:

- ☐ David looks **older** than he really is. (not looks elder)

We use **elder** only when we talk about people in a family (**my elder sister**, **their elder son** etc.).

You can also use **older**:

- ☐ **My elder sister** is a TV producer. (or **My older sister** ...)

But we do not say that 'somebody is elder':

- ☐ My sister is **older** than me. (not elder than me)

Comparative 3 (as ... as / than)

A Study this example situation:



Sarah, Joe and David are all very rich.
Sarah has \$20 million, Joe has \$15 million
and David has \$10 million. So:

Joe is rich.

He is **richer than** David.

But he **isn't as rich as** Sarah.
(= Sarah is **richer than** he is)

Some more examples of **not as ... (as)**:

- ☐ Jack **isn't as old as** he looks. (= he looks **older than** he is)
- ☐ The town centre **wasn't as crowded as** usual. (= it is usually **more crowded**)
- ☐ Lisa **didn't do as well** in the exam **as** she had hoped. (= she had hoped to do **better**)
- ☐ The weather is better today. It's **not as cold**. (= yesterday was **colder than** today)
- ☐ I **don't know as many** people **as** you do. (= you know **more** people **than** me)
- ☐ 'How much was it? Fifty dollars?' 'No, **not as much** as that.' (= **less than** fifty dollars)

You can also say **not so ... (as)**:

- ☐ It's not warm, but it's **not so cold as** yesterday. (= it's not **as cold as** ...)

Less than is similar to **not as ... as**:

- ☐ I spent **less** money **than** you. (= I **didn't** spend **as** much money **as** you)
- ☐ The city centre was **less** crowded **than** usual. (= it **wasn't as** crowded **as** usual)
- ☐ I play tennis **less than** I used to. (= I **don't** play **as** much **as** I used to)

B We also use **as ... as** (*but not so ... as*) in positive sentences and in questions:

- ☐ I'm sorry I'm late. I got here **as fast as** I could.
- ☐ There's plenty of food. You can have **as much as** you want.
- ☐ Can you send me the information **as soon as** possible, please?
- ☐ Let's walk. It's just **as quick as** taking the bus.

also **twice as ... as, three times as ... as** etc.:

- ☐ Petrol is **twice as expensive as** it was a few years ago.
- ☐ Their house is about **three times as big as** ours.
(or ... **three times the size of** ours)

C We say **the same as** (*not the same like*):

- ☐ Laura's salary is **the same as** mine. or Laura gets **the same** salary **as** me.
- ☐ David is **the same** age **as** James.
- ☐ Sarah hasn't changed. She still looks **the same as** she did ten years ago.

D **than me / than I am** etc.

You can say:

- ☐ You're taller **than me**. or You're taller **than I am**.
(*not usually* You're taller than I)
- ☐ He's not as clever **as her**. or He's not as clever **as she is**.
- ☐ They have more money **than us**. or They have more money **than we have**.
- ☐ I can't run as fast **as him**. or I can't run as fast **as he can**.

Superlative (**the longest / the most enjoyable** etc.)**A**

Look at these examples:

What is **the longest** river in the world?

What was **the most enjoyable** holiday you've ever had?

Longest and **most enjoyable** are *superlative* forms.

The superlative form is **-est** or **most** In general, we use **-est** for short words and **most** ... for longer words.

long → longest	hot → hottest	easy → easiest	hard → hardest
but most famous	most boring	most enjoyable	most difficult

A few superlative forms are irregular:

good → **best** bad → **worst** far → **furthest** or **farthest**

The rules are the same as those for the comparative – see Unit 105.

For spelling, see Appendix 6.

B

We normally use **the** (or **my/your** etc.) with a superlative:

- ☐ Yesterday was **the hottest** day of the year.
- ☐ The Louvre in Paris is one of **the most famous** museums in the world.
- ☐ She is really nice – one of **the nicest** people I know.
- ☐ What's **the best** movie you've ever seen, and what's **the worst**?
- ☐ How old is **your youngest** child?

Compare the superlative and the comparative:

- ☐ This hotel is **the cheapest** in town. (*superlative*)
It's **cheaper** than all the others in town. (*comparative*)
- ☐ He's **the most patient** person I've ever met.
He's much **more patient** than I am.

C

oldest and **eldest**

The superlative of **old** is **oldest**:

- ☐ That church is **the oldest** building in the town. (*not* the eldest)

We use **eldest** only when we talk about people in a family (you can also use **oldest**):

- ☐ **Their eldest son** is 13 years old. (*or* Their **oldest** son)
- ☐ Are you **the eldest** in your family? (*or* the **oldest**)

D

After superlatives we normally use **in** with places:

- ☐ What's the longest river **in the world**? (*not* of the world)
- ☐ We had a nice room. It was one of the best **in the hotel**. (*not* of the hotel)

We also use **in** for organisations and groups of people (a class / a company etc.):

- ☐ Who is the youngest student **in the class**? (*not* of the class)

For a period of time (**day, year** etc.), we normally use **of**:

- ☐ Yesterday was the hottest day **of the year**.
- ☐ What was the happiest day **of your life**?

E

We often use the *present perfect* (I **have done**) after a superlative (see also Unit 8A):

- ☐ What's **the most important** decision **you've ever made**?
- ☐ That was **the best** holiday **I've had** for a long time.

Word order 1: verb + object; place and time

A Verb + object

The *verb* and the *object* normally go together. We do not usually put other words between them:

	<i>verb</i>	<i>object</i>	
I	like	my job	very much. (<i>not</i> I like very much)
Our guide	spoke	English	fluently. (<i>not</i> spoke fluently English)
I didn't	use	my phone	yesterday.
Do you	eat	meat	every day?

Two more examples:

- ☐ I lost all my money and I also **lost my passport**.
(*not* I lost also my passport)
- ☐ At the end of this street you'll **see a supermarket** on your left.
(*not* see on your left a supermarket)

B Place

The *verb* and *place* (where?) normally go together:

go home **live in a city** **walk to work** etc.

If the verb has an *object*, the order is:

	<i>verb</i>	<i>object</i>	<i>place</i>
We	took	the children	to the zoo. (<i>not</i> took to the zoo the children)
Don't	put	anything	on the table.
Did you	learn	English	at school?

C Time

Normally *time* (when? / how often? / how long?) goes after *place*:

	<i>place</i>	<i>time</i>
Ben walks	to work	every morning. (<i>not</i> every morning to work)
I'm going	to Paris	on Monday.
They've lived	in the same house	for a long time.
We need to be	at the airport	by 8 o'clock.
Sarah gave me a lift	home	after the party.
You really shouldn't go	to bed	so late.

Sometimes we put *time* at the beginning of the sentence:

- ☐ **On Monday** I'm going to Paris.
- ☐ **After the party** Sarah gave me a lift home.

Some time words (for example, **always/never/usually**) go with the verb in the middle of the sentence. See Unit 110.

Word order 2: adverbs with the verb

A

Some adverbs (for example, **always, also, probably**) go with the verb in the middle of a sentence:

- ☐ Emily **always drives** to work.
- ☐ We were feeling very tired and we **were also** hungry.
- ☐ The meeting **will probably be cancelled**.

B

If the verb is one word (**drives/cooked** etc.), the adverb goes *before* the verb:

	adverb	verb	
Emily	always	drives	to work.
I	almost	fell	as I was going down the stairs.

- ☐ I cleaned the house and **also cooked** the dinner. (*not* cooked also)
- ☐ Laura **hardly ever watches** television and **rarely reads** newspapers.
- ☐ 'Shall I give you my address?' 'No, I **already have** it.'

Note that these adverbs (**always/usually/also** etc.) go before **have to** ...:

- ☐ Joe never phones me. I **always have to** phone him. (*not* I have always to phone)

But adverbs go *after* **am/is/are/was/were**:

- ☐ We were feeling very tired and we **were also** hungry. (*not* also were)
- ☐ You're **always** late. You're **never** on time.
- ☐ The traffic **isn't usually** as bad as it was this morning.

C

If the verb is two or more words (for example, **can remember / will be cancelled**), the adverb usually goes *after the first verb* (**can/doesn't/will** etc.):

	verb 1	adverb	verb 2	
I	can	never	remember	her name.
Clare	doesn't	usually	drive	to work.
Are you	Are	definitely	going	away next week?
The meeting	will	probably	be	cancelled.

- ☐ You've **always been** very kind to me.
- ☐ Jack can't cook. He **can't even boil** an egg.
- ☐ **Do you still work** for the same company?
- ☐ The house **was only built** a year ago and it's **already falling** down.

Note that **probably** goes before a negative (**isn't/won't** etc.). So we say:

- ☐ I **probably won't see** you. *or*
I'll **probably not see** you. (*but not* I won't probably)

D

We also use **all** and **both** with the verb in the middle of a sentence:

- ☐ We **all felt** ill after the meal. (*not* felt all ill)
- ☐ My parents **are both** teachers.
- ☐ Sarah and Jane **have both applied** for the job.
- ☐ My friends **are all going** out tonight.

E

Sometimes we use **is/will/did** etc. instead of repeating part of a sentence (see Unit 51):

- ☐ Tom says he isn't clever, but I think he **is**. (= he **is clever**)

When we do this, we put **always/never** etc. *before* the verb:

- ☐ He always says he won't be late, but he **always is**. (= he **is always** late)
- ☐ I've never done it and I **never will**. (= I **will never** do it)

A

We use **still** to say that a situation or action is continuing. It hasn't changed or stopped:

- ☐ It's ten o'clock and Joe is **still** in bed.
- ☐ When I went to bed, Chris was **still** working.
- ☐ Do you **still** want to go away or have you changed your mind?

Still also means 'in spite of this'. For example:

- ☐ He has everything he needs, but he's **still** unhappy.

Still usually goes in the middle of the sentence with the verb. See Unit 110.

B

We use **not ... any more** or **not ... any longer** to say that a situation has changed.

Any more and **any longer** go at the end of a sentence:

- ☐ Lucy **doesn't** work here **any more**. She left last month. *or*
Lucy **doesn't** work here **any longer**.
- ☐ We used to be good friends, but we **aren't any more**. *or* ... we **aren't any longer**.

You can write **any more** (2 words) or **anymore** (1 word).

You can also use **no longer**. **No longer** goes in the middle of the sentence:

- ☐ Lucy **no longer** works here.

We do not normally use **no more** in this way:

- ☐ We are **no longer** friends. (*not* we are no more friends)

Compare **still** and **not ... any more**:

- ☐ Sally **still** works here, but Lucy **doesn't** work here **any more**.

C

We use **yet** mainly in negative sentences (**He isn't** here **yet**) and questions (**Is he** here **yet**?).

Yet (= until now) shows that the speaker expects something to happen.

Yet usually goes at the end of a sentence:

- ☐ It's 10 o'clock and Joe **isn't** here **yet**.
- ☐ **Have** you **decided** what to do **yet**?
- ☐ 'Where are you going on holiday?' 'We **don't** know **yet**.'

We often use **yet** with the *present perfect* ('**Have** you **decided** ... **yet**?'). See Unit 7C.

Compare **yet** and **still**:

- ☐ Mike lost his job six months ago and **is still** unemployed.
Mike lost his job six months ago and **hasn't found** another job **yet**.
- ☐ **Is it still** raining?
Has it stopped raining **yet**?

Still is also possible in *negative* sentences (before the negative):

- ☐ She said she would be here an hour ago and she **still hasn't** come.

This is similar to 'she hasn't come **yet**'. But **still ... not** shows a stronger feeling of surprise or impatience. Compare:

- ☐ I sent him an invitation last week. He **hasn't** replied **yet**. (but I expect he will reply soon)
- ☐ I sent him an invitation weeks ago and he **still hasn't** replied. (he should have replied before now)

D

We use **already** to say that something happened sooner than expected.

- ☐ 'What time is Sue leaving?' 'She has **already** left.' (= sooner than you expected)
- ☐ Shall I tell Joe what happened or does he **already** know?
- ☐ I've just had lunch and I'm **already** hungry.

Already usually goes in the middle of a sentence (see Unit 110) or at the end:

- ☐ She's **already** left. *or* She's left **already**.

Unit 112

even

A Study this example situation:

Tina loves watching TV.

She has a television in every room of the house,
even the bathroom.

We use **even** to say that something is unusual or surprising. It is not usual to have a television in the bathroom.



Some more examples:

- ☐ These pictures are really awful. **Even I** take better pictures than these. (and I'm certainly not a good photographer)
- ☐ He always wears a coat, **even in hot weather.**
- ☐ The print was very small. I couldn't read it, **even with glasses.**
- ☐ Nobody would help her, **not even her best friend.** or **Not even** her best friend would help her.

B You can use **even** with the verb in the middle of a sentence (see Unit 110):

- ☐ Laura has travelled all over the world. She's **even** been to the Antarctic.
- ☐ They are very rich. They **even** have their own private jet.

You can use **even** with a negative (**not even**, **can't even**, **don't even** etc.):

- ☐ I can't cook. I **can't even** boil an egg. (and boiling an egg is very easy)
- ☐ They weren't very friendly to us. They **didn't even** say hello.
- ☐ Jessica is very fit. She's been running quite fast and she's **not even** out of breath.

C You can use **even** + comparative (**cheaper** / **more expensive** etc.):

- ☐ I got up very early, but Jack got up **even earlier.**
- ☐ I knew I didn't have much money, but I have **even less** than I thought.
- ☐ We were very surprised to get an email from her. We were **even more surprised** when she came to see us a few days later.

D **even though** / **even when** / **even if**

We use **even though** / **even when** / **even if** + *subject + verb*:

- ☐ **Even though** Tina can't drive, she has a car.
subject + verb
- ☐ He never shouts, **even when he's** angry.
- ☐ This river is dangerous. It's dangerous to swim in it, **even if you're** a strong swimmer.

We do not use **even** + *subject + verb*. We say:

- ☐ **Even though she can't** drive, she has a car. (*not even she can't drive*)
- ☐ I can't reach the shelf **even if I stand** on a chair. (*not even I stand*)

Compare **even if** and **even** (without **if**):

- ☐ It's dangerous to swim here **even if you're** a strong swimmer. (*not even you are*)
- ☐ The river is dangerous, **even for strong swimmers.**

Compare **even if** and **if**:

- ☐ We're going to the beach tomorrow. It doesn't matter what the weather is like. We're going **even if** the weather is bad.
- ☐ We want to go to the beach tomorrow, but we won't go **if** the weather is bad.

although though even though
in spite of despite

A

Study this example situation:



Last year Paul and Sarah had a holiday by the sea.
It rained a lot, but they had a good time.

You can say:

Although it rained a lot, they had a good time.
(= It rained a lot, but they ...)

or

In spite of } **the rain**, they had a good time.
Despite

B

After **although** we use a *subject + verb*:

- ☐ **Although it rained** a lot, they had a good time.
- ☐ I didn't apply for the job **although I had** the necessary qualifications.

Compare the meaning of **although** and **because**:

- ☐ We went out **although** it was raining heavily.
- ☐ We didn't go out **because** it was raining heavily.

C

After **in spite of** or **despite**, we use a *noun*, a *pronoun* (**this/that/what** etc.) or **-ing**:

- ☐ In spite of the rain, we had a good time.
- ☐ She wasn't well, but **in spite of this** she continued working.
- ☐ **In spite of what** I said yesterday, I still love you.
- ☐ I didn't apply for the job **in spite of having** the necessary qualifications.

Despite is the same as **in spite of**. We say **in spite of**, but **despite** (*without of*):

- ❑ She wasn't well, but **despite this** she continued working. (*not despite of this*)

You can say **'in spite of the fact (that) ...'** and **'despite the fact (that) ...'**:

- ☐ I didn't apply for the job **in spite of the fact** (that) **despite the fact** (that) I had the necessary qualifications.

Compare **in spite of** and **because of**:

- ☐ We went out **in spite of the rain.** (*or ... despite the rain.*)
- ☐ We didn't go out **because of the rain.**

D

Compare **although** and **in spite of / despite**:

- **Although the traffic was bad,** } we arrived on time. (*not in spite of the traffic was bad*)
In spite of the traffic, }
- I couldn't sleep { **although I was** very tired.
despite being very tired. (*not despite I was tired*)

F

though = although:

- ☐ I didn't apply for the job **though** I had the necessary qualifications.

In spoken English we often use **though** at the end of a sentence:

- The house isn't so nice. I like the garden **though**. (= but I like the garden)
○ I see them every day. I've never spoken to them **though**. (= but I've never spoken to them)

Even though (*but not 'even' alone*) is similar to **although**:

- ☐ **Even though** I was really tired, I couldn't sleep. (*not even I was really tired*)

A

Study this example situation:



Your car should have a spare wheel **in case** you have a puncture.

(= because it is possible you will have a puncture)

in case something happens =
because it is possible it will happen

Some more examples of **in case**:

- ☐ I'd better write down my password **in case I forget it**.
(= because it is possible I will forget it)
- ☐ Shall I draw a map for you **in case you have a problem** finding our house?
(= because it is possible you will have problems finding it)
- ☐ I'll remind them about the meeting **in case they've forgotten**.
(= because it is possible they have forgotten)

We use **just in case** for a smaller possibility:

- ☐ I don't think it will rain, but I'll take an umbrella **just in case**. (= **just in case** it rains)

We do not use **will** after **in case** (see also Unit 25):

- ☐ I'll write down my password **in case I forget it**. (*not in case I will forget*)

B

In case and **if** are not the same. We use **in case** to say *why* somebody does (or doesn't do) something. You do something *now in case* something happens *later*.

Compare:

in case

- ☐ We'll buy some more food **in case** Tom comes.
(= Maybe Tom will come. We'll buy some more food now, whether he comes or not. Then we'll *already* have the food *if* he comes.)
- ☐ I'll give you my phone number **in case** you need to contact me.
- ☐ You should insure your bike **in case** it is stolen.

if

- ☐ We'll buy some more food **if** Tom comes.
(= Maybe Tom will come. If he comes, we'll buy some more food. If he doesn't come, we won't buy any more food.)
- ☐ You can call me on this number **if** you need to contact me.
- ☐ You should inform the police **if** your bike is stolen.

C

You can use **in case** + *past* to say why somebody did something:

- ☐ I gave him my phone number **in case he needed** to contact me.
(= because it was possible that he would need to contact me)
- ☐ I drew a map for Sarah **in case she had** a problem finding our house.
- ☐ We rang the doorbell again **in case they hadn't heard** it the first time.

D

in case of = if there is ... (especially on notices, instructions etc.):

- ☐ **In case of fire**, please leave the building as quickly as possible. (= if there is a fire)
- ☐ **In case of emergency**, call this number. (= if there is an emergency)

A**unless**

Study this example situation:

The club is for members only.

You can't go in **unless you are a member**.

This means:

You can't go in *except if* you are a member.

You can go in *only if* you are a member.

unless = except if



Some more examples of **unless**:

- ☐ I'll see you tomorrow **unless I have to work late**.
(= except if I have to work late)
- ☐ There are no buses to the beach. **Unless you have a car**, it's difficult to get there.
(= except if you have a car)
- ☐ A: Shall I tell Lisa what happened?
B: **Not unless** she asks you. (= tell her only if she asks you)
- ☐ Ben hates to complain. He wouldn't complain about something **unless it was really bad**.
(= except if it was really bad)
- ☐ We can take a taxi to the restaurant – **unless you'd prefer to walk**. (= except if you'd prefer to walk)

Instead of **unless** it is often possible to say **if ... not**:

- ☐ **Unless we leave now**, we'll be late. or **If we don't leave now**, we'll ...

B**as long as / so long as** and **provided / providing**

You can say **as long as** or **so long as** (= if, on condition that):

- ☐ You can borrow my car $\left\{ \begin{array}{l} \text{as long as} \\ \text{so long as} \end{array} \right\}$ you promise not to drive too fast.
(= You can borrow my car, but you must promise not to drive too fast. This is a condition.)

You can also say **provided (that)** or **providing (that)**:

- ☐ Travelling by car is convenient $\left\{ \begin{array}{l} \text{provided (that)} \\ \text{providing (that)} \end{array} \right\}$ you have somewhere to park.
(= It's convenient but only if you have somewhere to park.)
- ☐ $\left\{ \begin{array}{l} \text{Providing (that)} \\ \text{Provided (that)} \end{array} \right\}$ the room is clean, I don't mind which hotel we stay at.
(= The room must be clean, but otherwise I don't mind.)

C**unless / as long as** etc. for the future

When we are talking about the future, we do *not* use **will** after **unless / as long as / so long as / provided / providing**. We use a *present* tense (see Unit 25):

- ☐ I'm not going out **unless it stops** raining. (*not* unless it will stop)
- ☐ **Providing** the weather **is** good, we're going to have a picnic tomorrow.
(*not* providing the weather will be good)

as (as I walked ... / as I was ... etc.)**A** **as** = at the same time as

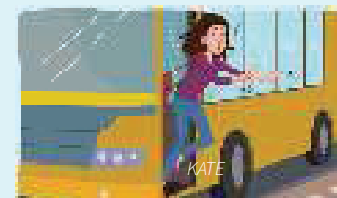
You can use **as** when two things happen together at the same time:

- ☐ We all waved goodbye to Liz **as she drove away**.
(we **waved** and she **drove** away at the same time)
- ☐ **As I walked along the street**, I looked in the shop windows.
- ☐ Can you turn off the light **as you go out**, please?



Or you can say that something happened **as you were doing** something else (in the middle of doing something else):

- ☐ Kate slipped **as she was getting off the bus**.
- ☐ We met Paul **as we were leaving the hotel**.



For the *past continuous* (**was getting** / **were going** etc.), see Unit 6.

You can also use **just as** (= exactly at that moment):

- ☐ **Just as I sat down**, the doorbell rang.
- ☐ I had to leave **just as** the conversation was getting interesting.

We also use **as** when two things happen together in a longer period of time:

- ☐ **As the day went on**, the weather got worse.
- ☐ I began to enjoy the job more **as I got used to it**.

the day went on

the weather got worse

Compare **as** and **when**:

We use **as** only if two things happen at the same time.

- ☐ **As I drove home**, I listened to music.
(= at the same time)

Use **when** (*not as*) if one thing happens after another.

- ☐ **When I got home**, I had something to eat.
(*not as* I got home)

B **as** = because

As also means 'because':

- ☐ **As I was hungry**, I decided to find somewhere to eat.
(= because I was hungry)
- ☐ **As it's late and we're tired**, let's get a taxi home. (= because it's late ...)
- ☐ We watched TV all evening **as we didn't have anything better to do**.
- ☐ **As I don't watch TV any more**, I gave my television to a friend of mine.

You can also use **since** in this way:

- ☐ **Since** it's late and we're tired, let's get a taxi home.

Compare **as** (= because) and **when**:

- ☐ David wasn't in the office **as he was on holiday**. (= because he was on holiday)
- ☐ **As they lived near us**, we used to see them quite often.
(= because they lived near us)

- ☐ David lost his passport **when he was on holiday**.
(= during the time he was away)
- ☐ **When they lived near us**, we used to see them quite often.
(= at the time they lived near us)

A

Like = similar to, the same as:

- ☐ What a beautiful house! It's **like a palace**. (*not as a palace*)
- ☐ Be careful! The floor has been polished. It's **like walking on ice**. (*not as walking*)
- ☐ It's raining again. I hate weather **like this**. (*not as this*)
- ☐ 'What's that noise?' 'It sounds **like a baby crying**.' (*not as a baby crying*)

In these examples, **like** is a *preposition*. So it is followed by a *noun* (like **a palace**), a *pronoun* (like **this**) or **-ing** (like walking).

Sometimes **like** = for example. You can also use **such as**:

- ☐ I enjoy water sports, **like** surfing, scuba diving and water-skiing. *or*
I enjoy water sports, **such as** surfing ...

B

As = in the same way as, in the same condition as.

We use **as** with *subject (S) + verb (V)*:

- ☐ I didn't move anything. I left everything **as it was**.
- ☐ You should have done it **as I showed** you.

S + V	
as it	was
as I	showed

We also use **like** in this way (+ *subject + verb*):

- ☐ I left everything **like it was**.

Compare **as** and **like**. You can say:

- ☐ You should have done it **as I showed you**. *or* ... **like I showed you**.

but You should have done it **like this**. (*not as this*)

We say **as usual** / **as always**:

- ☐ You're late **as usual**.
- ☐ **As always**, Nick was the first to complain.

We say **the same as** ... :

- ☐ Your phone is **the same as** mine. (*not the same like*)

C

Sometimes **as** (+ *subject + verb*) has other meanings. For example, after **do**:

- ☐ You can do **as you like**. (= do what you like)
- ☐ They did **as they promised**. (= They did what they promised.)

We also say **as you know** / **as I said** / **as she expected** / **as I thought** etc. :

- ☐ **As you know**, it's Emma's birthday next week. (= you know this already)
- ☐ Andy failed his driving test, **as he expected**. (= he expected this before)

Like is not usual in these expressions, except with **say** (*like I said*):

- ☐ **As I said** yesterday, I'm sure we can solve the problem. *or* **Like I said** yesterday ...

D

As can also be a *preposition* (**as** + *noun*), but the meaning is different from **like**.

Compare:

- ☐ **As a taxi driver**, I spend most of my working life in a car.
(I am a taxi driver, it's my job.)

- ☐ Everyone in the family wants me to drive them to places. I'm **like a taxi driver**.
(I'm not a taxi driver, but I'm like one.)

As (*preposition*) = in the position of, in the form of etc. :

- ☐ Many years ago I worked **as a photographer**. (I was a photographer)
- ☐ Many words, for example 'work' and 'rain', can be used **as verbs or nouns**.
- ☐ London is fine **as a place to visit**, but I wouldn't like to live there.
- ☐ The news of the tragedy came **as a great shock**.

A

We use **like** or **as if** to say how somebody/something looks, sounds or feels:

- ☐ That house **looks like** it's going to fall down. or
That house **looks as if** it's going to fall down.
- ☐ Amy **sounded like** she had a cold, didn't she? or
Amy **sounded as if** she had a cold, didn't she?
- ☐ I've just had a holiday, but I feel very tired.
I don't **feel like** I've had a holiday. or
I don't **feel as if** I've had a holiday.

You can also use **as though** in these examples:

- ☐ I don't **feel as though** I've had a holiday.

Compare:

- ☐ You **look tired**. (**look** + *adjective*)
- ☐ You **look like you haven't slept**. } (**look like** / **as if** + *subject* + *verb*)
- You **look as if you haven't slept**.



B

We say: **it looks like** ... or **it looks as if** ...
it sounds like ... or **it sounds as if** ...

- ☐ Sarah is very late. **It looks like** she isn't coming.
or **It looks as if** she isn't coming.
- ☐ **It looked like** it was going to rain, so we took an umbrella.
or **It looked as if** it was going to rain ...
- ☐ The noise is very loud next door.
It sounds like they're having a party.
or **It sounds as if** they're ...

You can also use **as though**:

- ☐ **It sounds as though** they're having a party.

It sounds like they're having a party next door.



C

You can use **like** / **as if** / **as though** with other verbs to say how somebody does something:

- ☐ He ran **like he was running for his life**.
- ☐ After the interruption, the speaker went on talking **as if nothing had happened**.
- ☐ When I told them my plan, they looked at me **as though I was mad**.

D

After **as if**, we sometimes use the *past* when we are talking about the *present*.

For example:

- ☐ I don't like him. He talks **as if he knew** everything.

The meaning is not past. We use the past (as if he **knew**) because the idea is not real: he does *not* know everything. We use the past in the same way with **if** and **wish** (see Unit 39).

We do not normally use **like** in this way.

Some more examples:

- ☐ She's always asking me to do things for her – **as if I didn't** have enough to do already. (I *have* enough to do already)
- ☐ Joe's only 40. Why do you talk about him **as if he was** an old man? (he *isn't* an old man)

When you use the past in this way, you can use **were** instead of **was**:

- ☐ Why do you talk about him **as if he were** an old man?
- ☐ They treat me **as if I were** their own son. or ... **as if I was** their own son. (I'm *not* their son)

A during

during = at a time between the start and end of something:

- ☐ I fell asleep **during the movie**. (= at a time between the start and end of the movie)
- ☐ We met some really nice people **during our holiday**.
- ☐ The ground is wet. It must have rained **during the night**.

With 'time words' (**the morning, the night, the summer** etc.), you can usually say **in** or **during**:

- ☐ It rained **in the night**. or ... **during the night**.
- ☐ It's lovely here **during the summer**. or ... **in the summer**.



I fell asleep **during the movie**.

B for and during

We use **for** (+ a period of time) to say how long something goes on:

- ☐ We watched TV **for two hours** last night.
- ☐ Jess is going away **for a week** in September.
- ☐ How are you? I haven't seen you **for ages**.
- ☐ Are you going away **for the weekend**?

We do not use **during** to say *how long* something goes on. We do not say 'during two hours', 'during five years' etc.:

- ☐ It rained **for** three days without stopping. (*not during three days*)

We use **during** to say *when* something happens (*not how long*). Compare **during** and **for**:

- ☐ 'When did you fall asleep?' 'During the movie.'
- ☐ 'How long were you asleep?' 'For half an hour.'

C during and while

Compare:

We use **during** + *noun*:

- ☐ I fell asleep **during the movie**.
└── noun ──┘
- ☐ We met a lot of interesting people **during our holiday**.
- ☐ Robert suddenly began to feel ill **during the exam**.

We use **while** + *subject + verb*:

- ☐ I fell asleep **while I was watching** TV.
└── subject + verb ──┘
- ☐ We met a lot of interesting people **while we were on holiday**.
- ☐ Robert suddenly began to feel ill **while he was doing the exam**.

Some more examples of **while**:

- ☐ We saw Clare **while we were waiting** for the bus.
- ☐ **While you were** out, there was a phone call for you.
- ☐ Alex read a book **while Amy watched** TV.

When we are talking about the future, we use the *present* after **while**. Do not use 'will' (see Unit 25):

- ☐ I'm going to Moscow next week. I hope the weather will be good **while I'm** there. (*not while I will be*)
- ☐ What are you going to do **while you're** waiting? (*not while you'll be waiting*)



Alex read a book **while Amy watched** TV.

A by ... = not later than:

- ☐ I sent the documents today, so they should arrive **by Monday**.
(= on or before Monday, not later than Monday)
- ☐ We'd better hurry. We have to be home **by 5 o'clock**.
(= at or before 5 o'clock, not later than 5 o'clock)
- ☐ Where's Sarah? She should be here **by now**.
(= now or before now – so she should already be here)



This milk has to be used **by 14 August**.

B We use **until** (or **till**) to say *how long* a situation continues:

- ☐ A: Shall we go now?
B: No, let's **wait until** it stops raining. or ... **till** it stops raining.
- ☐ I was very tired this morning. { I **stayed in bed until** half past ten.
I **didn't get up until** half past ten.

Compare **until** and **by**:

Something *continues* **until** a time in the future:

- ☐ Joe **will be away until** Monday.
(so he'll be back *on* Monday)
- ☐ I'll **be working until** 11.30.
(so I'll stop working *at* 11.30)

Something *happens* **by** a time in the future:

- ☐ Joe **will be back by** Monday.
(= not later than Monday)
- ☐ I'll **have finished my work by** 11.30.
(= I'll finish it not later than 11.30)

C You can say '**by the time** something happens':

- ☐ It's too late to go to the bank now. **By the time we get there**, it will be closed.
(= it will close between now and the time we get there)
- ☐ You'll need plenty of time at the airport. **By the time you check in and go through security**, it will be time for your flight.
(= check-in and security will take a long time)
- ☐ Hurry up! **By the time we get to the cinema**, the film will already have started.

You can say '**by the time** something happened' (for the past):

- ☐ Karen's car broke down on the way to the party last night. **By the time she arrived**, most of the other guests had left.
(= it took her a long time to get there and most of the guests left during this time)
- ☐ I had a lot of work to do yesterday evening. I was very tired **by the time I finished**.
(= it took me a long time to do the work, and I became more and more tired)
- ☐ We went to the cinema last night. It took us a long time to find somewhere to park the car. **By the time we got to the cinema**, the film had already started.

You can say **by then** or **by that time**:

- ☐ Karen finally got to the party at midnight, but **by then** most of the other guests had left.
or ... but **by that time**, most of the other guests had left.

ACompare **at**, **on** and **in**:

- ☐ They arrived **at 5 o'clock**.
- ☐ They arrived **on Friday**.
- ☐ They arrived **in June**. / They arrived **in 2012**.

We use:

at for the time of day**at five o'clock at 11.45 at midnight at lunchtime at sunset etc.****on** for days and dates**on Friday / on Fridays on 16 May 2012 on New Year's Day on my birthday****in** for longer periods (months/years/seasons etc.)**in June in 2012 in the 1990s in the 20th century in the past in winter****B**

We say:

at the moment / at the minute / at present / at this time (= now):

- ☐ Can we talk later? I'm busy **at the moment**.

at the same time

- ☐ Kate and I arrived **at the same time**.

at the weekends / at weekends (or **on the weekend / on weekends** in American English):

- ☐ Will you be here **at the weekend?** (or ... **on the weekend**)

at Christmas (but **on Christmas Day**)

- ☐ Do you give each other presents **at Christmas?**

at night (= during nights in general), **in the night** (= during a particular night):

- ☐ I don't like working **at night**. but I was woken up by a noise **in the night**.

C

We say:

in the morning(s)*but***in the afternoon(s)****in the evening(s)****on Friday morning(s)****on Sunday afternoon(s)****on Monday evening(s)** etc.

- ☐ I'll see you **in the morning**.
- ☐ Do you work **in the evenings?**

- ☐ I'll see you **on Friday morning**.
- ☐ Do you work **on Saturday evenings?**

DWe do not use **at/on/in** before **last/next/this/every**:

- ☐ I'll see you **next Friday**. (not on next Friday)
- ☐ They got married **last June**.

We often leave out **on** before days. So you can say:

- ☐ I'll see you **on Friday**. or I'll see you **Friday**.
- ☐ I don't work **on Monday mornings**. or I don't work **Monday mornings**.

EWe say that something will happen **in a few minutes / in six months** etc. :

- ☐ The train will be leaving **in a few minutes**. (= a few minutes from now)
- ☐ Andy has gone away. He'll be back **in a week**. (= a week from now)
- ☐ They'll be here **in a moment**. (= a moment from now, very soon)

We also use **in ...** to say how long it takes to do something:

- ☐ I learnt to drive **in four weeks**. (= it took me four weeks to learn)

A on time and in time

on time = punctual, not late

If something happens **on time**, it happens at the time that was planned:

- ☐ The 11.45 train left **on time**. (= it left at 11.45)
- ☐ Please be **on time**. Don't be late.
- ☐ The conference was well-organised. Everything began and finished **on time**.

in time (for something / to do something) = soon enough

- ☐ Will you be home **in time for dinner**? (= soon enough for dinner)
- ☐ I sent Amy a birthday present. I hope it arrives **in time**.
(= on or before her birthday)
- ☐ I'm in a hurry. I want to get home **in time to watch** the game on TV.
(= soon enough to see the game)

The opposite of **in time** is **too late**:

- ☐ I got home **too late** to watch the game on TV.

You can say **just in time** (= almost too late):

- ☐ We got to the station **just in time** for our train.
- ☐ A child ran into the road in front of the car, but I managed to stop **just in time**.

B at the end and in the end

at the end (of something) = at the time when something ends

For example:

- | | | |
|--------------------------------|---------------------------------|----------------------------------|
| at the end of the month | at the end of January | at the end of the game |
| at the end of the film | at the end of the course | at the end of the concert |
- ☐ I'm going away **at the end of January / at the end of the month**.
 - ☐ **At the end of the concert**, everyone applauded.
 - ☐ The players shook hands **at the end of the game**.

We do not say 'in the end of ...'. For example, we do not say 'in the end of January'.

The opposite of **at the end** is **at the beginning**:

- ☐ I'm going away **at the beginning of January**. (*not* in the beginning)

in the end = finally

We use **in the end** when we say what the final result of a situation was:

- ☐ We had a lot of problems with our car. We sold it **in the end**. (= finally we sold it)
- ☐ He got more and more angry. **In the end** he just walked out of the room.
- ☐ Alan couldn't decide where to go for his holidays. He didn't go anywhere **in the end**.
(*not* at the end)

The opposite of **in the end** is **at first**:

- ☐ **At first** we didn't get on very well, but **in the end** we became good friends.

A in



in a room
in a building
in a box
etc.



in a garden
in a town
in the city centre
etc.



in a pool
in the sea
in a river
etc.

- ☐ There's no-one **in the room** / **in the building** / **in the garden**.
- ☐ What do you have **in your hand** / **in your mouth**?
- ☐ When we were **in Italy**, we spent a few days **in Venice**.
- ☐ I have a friend who lives **in a small village in the mountains**.
- ☐ There were some people swimming **in the pool** / **in the sea** / **in the river**.

B at



at the bus stop



at the door



at the roundabout



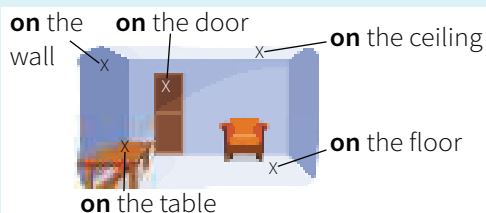
at her desk

- ☐ Who is that man standing **at the bus stop** / **at the door** / **at the window**?
- ☐ Turn left **at the traffic lights** / **at the next junction** / **at the roundabout** / **at the church**.
- ☐ We have to get off the bus **at the next stop**.
- ☐ When you leave the hotel, please leave your key **at reception**. (= at the reception desk)

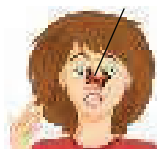
Compare **in** and **at**:

- ☐ There were a lot of people **in the shop**. It was crowded.
Go along this road, then turn left **at the shop**.
- ☐ I'll meet you **in the hotel lobby**. (= in the building)
I'll meet you **at the entrance to the hotel**. (= outside the building)

C on



on her nose



on a page



on an island

- ☐ I sat **on the floor** / **on the ground** / **on the grass** / **on the beach** / **on a chair**.
- ☐ There's a dirty mark **on the ceiling** / **on your nose** / **on your shirt**.
- ☐ Did you see the notice **on the wall** / **on the door**?
- ☐ You'll find details of TV programmes **on page seven** of the newspaper.
- ☐ The hotel is **on a small island** in the middle of a lake.

Compare **in** and **on**:

- ☐ There is some water **in the bottle**.
There is a label **on the bottle**.

Compare **at** and **on**:

- ☐ There is somebody **at the door**. Shall I go and see who it is?
There is a notice **on the door**. It says 'Do not disturb'.



A We say that somebody/something is:

in a line, in a row, in a queue
in a picture, in a photo(graph)
in a newspaper, in a magazine, in a book

in an office, in a department
in the sky, in the world
in the country (= not in a town)

- ☐ When I go to the cinema, I like to sit **in the front row**.
- ☐ Amy works **in the sales department**.
- ☐ Who is the woman **in that picture**?
- ☐ Do you live in a city or **in the country**?
- ☐ It's a lovely day. There isn't a cloud **in the sky**.



They're standing **in a row**.

B We say that somebody/something is:

on the left, on the right (or **on the left-hand side, on the right-hand side**)

- ☐ Do you drive **on the left** or **on the right** in your country?

on the ground floor, on the first floor, on the second floor etc.

- ☐ Our apartment is **on the second floor** of the building.

on a map, on a menu, on a list, on a page, on a website

- ☐ Here's the shopping list. Don't buy anything that's not **on the list**.
- ☐ You'll find the information you need **on our website**.

We say that a place is **on a river / on a road / on the coast**:

- ☐ Vienna is **on the** (river) **Danube**.
- ☐ The town where you live – is it **on the coast** or is it inland?

We say **on the way** (from one place to another):

- ☐ We stopped at a shop **on the way** home.



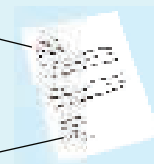
C We say:

at the top (of ...), **at the bottom** (of ...), **at the end** (of ...)

- ☐ Write your name **at the top of the page**.
- ☐ Jane lives **at the other end of the street**.

at the top (of the page)

at the bottom (of the page)



D We say:

in the front, in the back of a car

- ☐ I was **in the back** (of the car) when we had the accident.

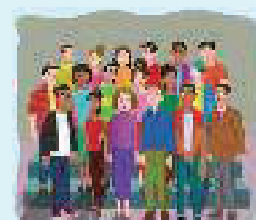
at the front, at the back of a building / theatre / group of people etc.

- ☐ The garden is **at the back of the house**.
- ☐ Let's sit **at the front** (of the cinema).
- ☐ We were **at the back**, so we couldn't see very well.

on the front, on the back of an envelope / a piece of paper etc.

- ☐ I wrote the date **on the back of the photo**.

at the back



at the front

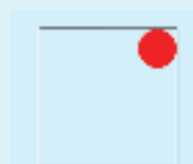
E We say:

in the corner of a room

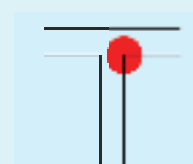
- ☐ The TV is **in the corner** of the room.

at the corner or **on the corner** of a street

- ☐ There is a small shop **at the corner** (of the street).
or ... **on the corner** (of the street).



in the corner



at or on the corner

A in hospital / at work etc.

We say that somebody is **in bed** / **in hospital** / **in prison**:

- ☐ James isn't up yet. He's still **in bed**.
- ☐ Anna's mother is **in hospital**.

We say that somebody is **at home** / **at work** / **at school** / **at university** / **at college**:

- ☐ I'll be **at work** until 5.30.
- ☐ My sister is **at university**. My brother is still **at school**.

We say **be at home** or **be home** (with or without **at**), but **do something at home** (with **at**):

- ☐ I'll **be home** all evening. *or* I'll **be at home** all evening.
- ☐ Shall we go to a restaurant or **eat at home**?

B at a party / at a concert etc.

We say that somebody is **at** an event (**at a party**, **at a conference** etc.):

- ☐ Were there many people **at the party** / **at the meeting** / **at the wedding**?
- ☐ I saw Steve **at a conference** / **at a concert** on Saturday.

C in and at for buildings

You can often use **in** or **at** with buildings. For example, you can eat **in a restaurant** or **at a restaurant**; you can buy food **in a supermarket** or **at a supermarket**.

We usually say **at** when we say where an event takes place (a concert, a party, a meeting etc.):

- ☐ We went to a concert **at the National Concert Hall**.
- ☐ The meeting took place **at the company's head office** in Frankfurt.
- ☐ There was a robbery **at the supermarket**.

We say **at** somebody's house:

- ☐ I was **at Helen's house** last night. *or* I was **at Helen's** last night.

In the same way we say **at the doctor's**, **at the hairdresser's** etc.

We use **in** when we are thinking about the building itself. Compare **at** and **in**:

- ☐ I was **at Helen's** (house) last night.
- ☐ It's always cold **in Helen's house**. The heating doesn't work well. (*not* at Helen's house)
- ☐ We had dinner **at the hotel**.
- ☐ All the rooms **in the hotel** have air conditioning. (*not* at the hotel)

We say **at the station** / **at the airport**:

- ☐ There's no need to meet me **at the station**. I can get a taxi.

D in and at for towns etc.

We normally use **in** with cities, towns and villages:

- ☐ The Louvre is a famous art museum **in Paris**. (*not* at Paris)
- ☐ Sam's parents live **in a village** in the south of France. (*not* at a village)

We use **at** when we think of the place as a point or station on a journey:

- ☐ Does this train stop **at Oxford**? (= at Oxford station)

E on a bus / in a car etc.

We usually say **on a bus** / **on a train** / **on a plane** / **on a ship** *but* **in a car** / **in a taxi**:

- ☐ **The bus** was very full. There were too many people **on it**.
- ☐ Laura arrived **in a taxi**.

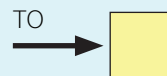
We say **on a bike** (= bicycle) / **on a motorbike** / **on a horse**:

- ☐ Jane passed me **on her bike**.

A

We say **go/come/travel** (etc.) **to** a place or event. For example:

go to China	go to work	come to my house
go back to Italy	go to the bank	drive to the airport
return to London	go to a party	be taken to hospital



- ☐ When are your friends **going back to Italy**? (*not* going back in Italy)
- ☐ Three people were injured in the accident and **taken to hospital**.

In the same way we say **Welcome to** ..., a **trip to** ..., a **visit to** ..., on **my way to** ... etc. :

- ☐ **Welcome to our country!** (*not* Welcome in)
- ☐ We had to cancel **our trip to Paris**.

Compare **to** (for *movement*) and **in/at** (for *position*):

- ☐ They are **going to** France. *but* They **live in** France.
- ☐ Can you **come to** the party? *but* I'll **see you at** the party.

We say '(I've) **been to**' a place or an event:

- ☐ I've **been to Italy** four times, but I've never **been to Rome**.
- ☐ Amanda has never **been to a football match** in her life.

B

get and arrive

We say **get to** a place:

- ☐ They **got to the hotel** at midnight.
- ☐ What time did you **get to the party**?

We say **arrive in** ... or **arrive at** ... (*not* arrive to).

We say **arrive in** a town or country:

- ☐ They **arrived in Madrid / in Spain** a week ago.

For other places (buildings etc.) or events, we say **arrive at**:

- ☐ What time did you **arrive at the hotel / at the airport / at the party**?

C

home

We say: **go home, come home, get home, arrive home, on the way home** etc. (no preposition).

We do not say 'to home':

- ☐ What time did you **get home**? (*not* get to home)
- ☐ I met Lisa **on my way home**.

D

into

go into, get into ... etc. = enter (a room / a building / a car etc.):

- ☐ I opened the door, **went into the room** and sat down.
- ☐ A bird **flew into the kitchen** through the window.
- ☐ Every month my salary **is paid directly into my bank account**.



With some verbs (especially **go/get/put**) we often use **in** (instead of **into**):

- ☐ She **got in the car** and drove away. *or* She **got into** the car ...
- ☐ I read the letter and **put it back in the envelope**.

The opposite of **into** is **out of**:

- ☐ She **got out of** the car and **went into** a shop.

For buses, trains and planes, we usually say **get on** and **get off**:

- ☐ She **got on the bus** and I never saw her again.
- ☐ You need to **get off** (the train) at the next station.

in/on/at (other uses)

A in

in the rain / in the sun / in the shade / in the dark / in bad weather etc.

- ☐ We sat **in the shade**. It was too hot to sit **in the sun**.
- ☐ Don't go out **in the rain**. Wait until it stops.

in a language / **in** a currency etc.

- ☐ How do you say 'thank you' **in Russian**?
- ☐ How much is a hundred pounds **in dollars**?

(be/fall) **in love** (with somebody)

- ☐ They're very happy together. They're **in love**.

in a (good/bad) **mood**

- ☐ You seem to be **in a bad mood**. What's the matter?

in (my) **opinion**

- ☐ **In my opinion** the movie wasn't very good.



in the shade

B on

on TV / on television

on the radio

on the phone

on fire

on purpose (= intentionally)

on the whole (= in general)

- ☐ I didn't see the news **on TV**.
- ☐ I heard the weather forecast **on the radio**.
- ☐ I've never met her, but I've spoken to her **on the phone**.
- ☐ Look! That car is **on fire**.
- ☐ I'm sorry. I didn't mean to hurt you. I didn't do it **on purpose**.
- ☐ Sometimes I have problems at work, but **on the whole** I enjoy my job.

C

on holiday / on a trip etc.

(be/go) **on holiday / on vacation**

(be/go) **on a trip / on a tour / on a cruise** etc.

(be/go to a place) **on business**

(be/go) **on strike**

(be/go) **on a diet**

- ☐ I'm going **on holiday** next week.
- ☐ One day I'd like to go **on a world tour**.
- ☐ Emma's away **on business** at the moment.
- ☐ There are no trains today. The drivers are **on strike**.
- ☐ I've put on weight. I'll have to go **on a diet**.

We also say 'go somewhere **for a holiday**':

- ☐ Steve has gone to France **for a holiday**.

D

at the age of ... etc.

at the age of 16 / at 90 miles an hour / at 100 degrees etc. :

- ☐ Tracy left school **at 16**. or
Tracy left school **at the age of 16**.
- ☐ The train was travelling **at 120 miles an hour**.
- ☐ Water boils **at 100 degrees Celsius**.

We are now flying **at a speed** of 800 kilometres an hour and **at an altitude** of 9,000 metres.



A

You can say that something happens **by mistake** / **by accident** / **by chance**:

- ☐ We hadn't arranged to meet. We met **by chance**.

But we say 'do something **on purpose**' (= you mean to do it):

- ☐ I didn't do it **on purpose**. It was an accident.

Note that we say **by chance**, **by accident** etc. (*not* by the chance / by an accident).

In these expressions we use **by** + *noun* without **the** or **a**.

B

We use **by** ... to say how somebody travels. For example, you can travel:

by car **by train** **by plane** **by boat** **by ship** **by bus** **by bike** etc.

- ☐ Jess usually goes to work **by bus** / **by bike** / **by car**.

We do not use **by** if we say **my car** / **the train** / **a taxi** etc. We say:

by car *but* **in my car** (*not* by my car)

by train *but* **on the train** (*not* by the train)

We use **in** for cars and taxis:

- ☐ They didn't come **in their car**. They came **in a taxi**.

We use **on** for bikes and public transport (buses, trains etc.):

- ☐ We travelled **on the 6.45 train**, which arrived at 8.30.

Note that we usually say **on foot** (*not usually* by foot):

- ☐ Did you come here **by car** or **on foot**?

We also use **by** to say how we do other things. For example, you can:

send something **by post** pay **by card** / **by cheque** do something **by hand**

- ☐ Can I pay **by credit card**?

But note that we say **pay cash** or **pay in cash** (*not usually* by cash).

C

We say that 'something is done **by** ...' (*passive*):

- ☐ Have you ever been bitten **by a dog**?
- ☐ The programme was watched **by millions of people**.

Compare **by** and **with**:

- ☐ The door must have been opened **with a key**. (*not* by a key)
(= somebody used a key to open it)
- ☐ The door must have been opened **by somebody** with a key.

We say: a play **by Shakespeare**, a painting **by Rembrandt**, a novel **by Tolstoy** etc.

- ☐ Have you read any poems **by Shakespeare**?
- ☐ 'Who is this painting **by**? Picasso?' 'I have no idea.'

D

By also means 'next to / beside':

- ☐ The light switch is **by the door**.
- ☐ Come and sit **by me**. (= next to me)

LIGHT SWITCH →



E

You can also use **by** ... to show the difference between two things:

- ☐ Clare's salary has increased **by ten per cent**.
(= it's now ten per cent more than before)
- ☐ Carl won the race **by five metres**.
(= he was five metres in front of the other runners)



Noun + preposition (reason for, cause of etc.)

A noun + for ...

a **demand** / a **need** **FOR** ...

- ☐ The company went out of business. There was no **demand for** its product any more.
- ☐ There's no excuse for behaviour like that. There's no **need for** it.

a **reason** **FOR** ...

- ☐ The train was late, but nobody knew the **reason for** the delay. (*not* reason of)

B noun + of ...

a **cause** **OF** ...

- ☐ The **cause of** the explosion is unknown.

a **picture** / a **photo** / a **photograph** / a **map** / a **plan** / a **drawing** (etc.) **OF** ...

- ☐ Rachel showed me some **pictures of** her family.
- ☐ I had a **map of** the town, so I was able to find my way around.

an **advantage** / a **disadvantage** **OF** ...

- ☐ The **advantage of** living alone is that you can do what you like.

but

there is an advantage **IN** doing something *or* **TO** doing something:

- ☐ **There are** many advantages **in** living alone. *or* ... many advantages **to** living alone.

C noun + in ...

an **increase** / a **decrease** / a **rise** / a **fall** **IN** (prices etc.)

- ☐ There has been an **increase in** the number of road accidents recently.
- ☐ Last year was a bad one for the company. There was a big **fall in** sales.

D noun + to ...

damage **TO** ...

- ☐ The accident was my fault, so I had to pay for the **damage to** the other car.

an **invitation** **TO** ... (a party / a wedding etc.)

- ☐ Did you get an **invitation to** the wedding?

a **solution** **TO** a problem / a **key** **TO** a door / an **answer** **TO** a question / a **reply** **TO** a letter / a **reaction** **TO** something

- ☐ I hope we find a **solution to** the problem. (*not* a solution of the problem)
- ☐ I was surprised at her **reaction to** my suggestion.

an **attitude** **TO** ... *or* an **attitude** **TOWARDS** ...

- ☐ His **attitude to** his job is very negative. *or* His **attitude towards** his job ...

E noun + with ... / between ...

a **relationship** / a **connection** / **contact** **WITH** ...

- ☐ Do you have a good **relationship with** your parents?
- ☐ The police want to question a man in **connection with** the robbery.

a **relationship** / a **connection** / **contact** / a **difference** **BETWEEN** two things or people

- ☐ The police believe that there is no **connection between** the two crimes.
- ☐ There are some **differences between** British and American English.

Adjective + preposition 1

A nice of you, nice to me

nice / kind / good / generous / polite / honest / stupid / silly etc. **OF** somebody (to do something)

- ☐ Thank you. It was very **nice of** you to help me.
- ☐ It was **stupid of** me to go out without a coat in such cold weather.

(be) **nice / kind / good / generous / polite / rude / friendly / cruel** etc. **TO** somebody

- ☐ They have always been very **nice to** me. (*not with me*)
- ☐ Why were you so **unfriendly to** Lucy?

B adjective + about / with

angry / annoyed / furious / upset { **ABOUT** something
 WITH somebody **FOR** doing something

- ☐ There's no point in getting **angry about** things that don't matter.
- ☐ Are you **annoyed with** me **for** being late?
- ☐ Lisa is **upset about** not being invited to the party.

excited / worried / nervous / happy etc. **ABOUT** something

- ☐ Are you **nervous about** the exam?

pleased / satisfied / happy / delighted / disappointed **WITH** something you get or experience

- ☐ They were **delighted with** the present I gave them.
- ☐ Were you **happy with** your exam results?

C adjective + at / by / with / of

surprised / shocked / amazed / astonished / upset **AT / BY** something

- ☐ Everybody was **surprised at** the news. *or ... by* the news.
- ☐ I hope you weren't **shocked by** what I said. *or ... at* what I said.

impressed **WITH / BY** somebody/something

- ☐ I'm very **impressed with** (*or by*) her English. It's very good.

fed up / bored **WITH** something

- ☐ I don't enjoy my job any more. I'm **fed up with** it. / I'm **bored with** it.

tired **OF** something

- ☐ Come on, let's go! I'm **tired of** waiting.

D sorry about / for

sorry **ABOUT** a situation or something that happened

- ☐ I'm **sorry about** the mess. I'll clear it up later.
- ☐ **Sorry about** last night. (= Sorry about something that happened last night)

sorry **FOR / ABOUT** something you did or caused

- ☐ I'm **sorry for** shouting at you yesterday. (*or sorry about* shouting)
- ☐ **Sorry for** the delay. (*or Sorry about* the delay)

You can also say 'I'm sorry I (did something)':

- ☐ I'm **sorry I shouted** at you yesterday.

feel / be sorry **FOR** somebody in a bad situation

- ☐ I **feel sorry for** Mark. He's had a lot of bad luck. (*not I feel sorry about Mark*)

A adjective + of

afraid / scared / frightened / terrified OF ...

- ☐ 'Are you **afraid of** spiders?' 'Yes, I'm **terrified of** them.'

fond / proud / ashamed / jealous / envious OF ...

- ☐ Why is he so **jealous of** other people?

suspicious / critical / tolerant OF ...

- ☐ They didn't trust me. They were **suspicious of** my motives.

aware / conscious OF ...

- ☐ 'Did you know he was married?' 'No, I wasn't **aware of** that.'

capable / incapable OF ...

- ☐ I'm sure you are **capable of** doing the job well.

full / short OF ...

- ☐ Amy is a very active person. She's always **full of** energy.
☐ I'm a bit **short of** money. Can you lend me some?

typical OF ...

- ☐ He's late again. It's **typical of** him to keep everybody waiting.

certain / sure OF or ABOUT ...

- ☐ I think she's arriving this evening, but I'm not **sure of** that. *or* ... not **sure about** that.

B adjective + at / to / from / in / on / with / for

good / bad / brilliant / better / hopeless etc. AT ...

- ☐ I'm not very **good at** repairing things. (*not* good in repairing things)

married / engaged TO ...

- ☐ Louise is **married to** an American. (*not* married with)

but Louise is married **with three children**. (= she is married and has three children)

similar TO ...

- ☐ Your handwriting is **similar to** mine.

different FROM or different TO ...

- ☐ The film was **different from** what I'd expected. *or* ... **different to** what I'd expected.

interested IN ...

- ☐ Are you **interested in** art?

keen ON ...

- ☐ We stayed at home. Chris wasn't **keen on** going out.

dependent ON ... (but independent OF ...)

- ☐ I don't want to be **dependent on** anybody.

crowded WITH (people etc.)

- ☐ The streets were **crowded with** tourists. (*but* ... **full of** tourists)

famous FOR ...

- ☐ The Italian city of Florence is **famous for** its art treasures.

responsible FOR ...

- ☐ Who was **responsible for** all that noise last night?

A verb + **to****talk / speak TO** somebody (**talk/speak with** is also possible)

- ☐ Who were you **talking to**?

listen TO ...

- ☐ When I'm driving, I like to **listen to** the radio. (*not* listen the radio)

apologise TO somebody (for ...)

- ☐ They **apologised to me** for their mistake. (*not* apologised me)

explain something **TO** somebody

- ☐ Can you **explain this word to me**? (*not* explain me this word)

explain / describe (to) somebody what/how/why ...

- ☐ I **explained to them** why I was worried. (*not* I explained them)

- ☐ Let me **describe to you** what I saw. (*not* Let me describe you)

B **phone** somebody, **ask** somebody etc. (*without to*)**phone / call / email / text** somebody

- ☐ I **called the airline** to cancel my flight. (*not* called to the airline)

But we say '**write** (a letter) **to** somebody'.**answer** somebody/something

- ☐ You didn't **answer my email**. (*not* answer to my email)

But we say **reply to** (an email / a letter etc.).**ask** somebody (a question)

- ☐ If there's anything you want to know, you can **ask me**. (*not* ask to me)

thank somebody (**for** ...)

- ☐ He **thanked me** for helping him. (*not* He thanked to me)

C verb + **at****look / stare / glance AT** ..., **have a look / take a look AT** ...

- ☐ Why are you **looking at** me like that?

laugh AT ...

- ☐ I look stupid with this haircut. Everybody will **laugh at** me.

aim / point (something) **AT** ..., **shoot / fire** (a gun) **AT** ...

- ☐ Don't **point** that knife **at** me. It's dangerous.

- ☐ We saw someone with a gun **shooting at** birds, but he didn't hit any.

D Some verbs can be followed by **at** or **to**, with a difference in meaning. For example:**shout AT** somebody (when you are angry or aggressive)

- ☐ He got very angry and started **shouting at** me.

shout TO somebody (so that they can hear you)

- ☐ He **shouted to** me from the other side of the street.

throw something **AT** somebody/something (to hit them)

- ☐ Somebody **threw** an egg **at** the politician.

throw something **TO** somebody (for somebody to catch)

- ☐ Lisa shouted 'Catch!' and **threw** the keys **to** me from the window.

A verb + **about****talk / read / know ABOUT ...**

- ☐ We **talked about** a lot of things at the meeting.

have a discussion ABOUT something

- ☐ We had **a discussion about** what we should do.

But we say '**discuss** something' (no preposition):

- ☐ We **discussed** what we should do. (*not discussed about*)

do something/nothing **ABOUT** something = *do something/nothing to improve a situation*

- ☐ If you're worried about the problem, you should **do** something **about** it.

B verb + **for****ask** (somebody) **FOR** ...

- ☐ I sent an email to the company **asking** them **for** more information about the job.

But we say 'ask somebody **the way / the time**' etc. (no preposition):

- ☐ I **asked** somebody **the way to the station**.

apply (TO a company etc.) **FOR** a job etc.

- ☐ I think you could do this job. Why don't you **apply for** it?

wait FOR somebody, **wait FOR** something (to happen)

- ☐ Don't **wait for** me. I'll join you later.
☐ I'm not going out yet. I'm **waiting for** the rain to stop.

search (a person / a place / a bag etc.) **FOR** ...

- ☐ I've **searched** the house **for** my keys, but I still can't find them.

leave (a place) **FOR** another place

- ☐ I haven't seen her since she **left** (home) **for** work. (*not left to work*)

C **take care of, care for** and **care about****take care OF** ... = *look after, keep safe, take responsibility for*

- ☐ Don't worry about me. I can **take care of** myself.
☐ I'll **take care of** the travel arrangements. You don't need to do anything.

care FOR somebody = *take care of them, keep them safe*

- ☐ Alan is 85 and lives alone. He needs somebody to **care for** him.

I don't **care FOR** something = *I don't like it*

- ☐ I don't **care for** hot weather. (= I don't like ...)

care ABOUT ... = *think that somebody/something is important*

- ☐ He's very selfish. He doesn't **care about** other people.

care what/where/how ... etc. (*without about*)

- ☐ You can do what you like. I don't **care what** you do.

D **look for** and **look after****look FOR** ... = *search for, try to find*

- ☐ I've lost my keys. Can you help me to **look for** them?

look AFTER ... = *take care of, keep safe or in good condition*

- ☐ Alan is 85 and lives alone. He needs somebody to **look after** him. (*not look for*)
☐ You can borrow this book, but please **look after** it.

A**hear ABOUT** ... = *be told about something*

- ☐ Did you **hear about** the fire at the hotel?

hear OF ... = *know that somebody/something exists*

- ☐ A: Who is Tom Hart?
B: I have no idea. I've never **heard of** him. (*not heard from him*)

hear FROM ... = *be in contact with somebody*

- ☐ A: Have you **heard from** Jane recently?
B: Yes, she called me a few days ago.

B**think ABOUT** something = *consider it, concentrate your mind on it:*

- ☐ I've **thought about** what you said and I've decided to take your advice.
☐ A: Will you lend me the money?
B: I'll **think about** it. (*not think of it*)

think OF something = *produce an idea:*

- ☐ It was my idea. I **thought of** it first. (*not thought about it*)
☐ I felt embarrassed. I couldn't **think of** anything to say. (*not think about anything*)

We also use **think of** when we ask for or give an opinion:

- ☐ A: What did you **think of** the movie?
B: I didn't **think** much **of** it. (= I didn't like it much)

Sometimes the difference is very small and you can use **of** or **about**:

- ☐ When I'm alone, I often **think of** you. or ... **think about** you.

You can say **think of** or **think about** doing something (for possible future actions):

- ☐ My sister is **thinking of** going to Canada. or ... **thinking about** going ...

C**dream ABOUT** ... (when you are asleep)

- ☐ I **dreamt about** you last night.

dream OF/ABOUT being something / doing something = *imagine*

- ☐ Do you **dream of** being rich and famous? or ... **dream about** being rich ...

I **wouldn't dream OF** doing something = *I would never do it*

- ☐ 'Don't tell anyone what I said.' 'No, I **wouldn't dream of** it.'

D**complain (TO somebody) ABOUT** ... = *say that you are not satisfied*

- ☐ We **complained to** the manager of the restaurant **about** the food.

complain OF a pain, an illness etc. = *say that you have a pain etc.*

- ☐ We called the doctor because George was **complaining of** a pain in his stomach.

E**remind** somebody **ABOUT** ... = *tell somebody not to forget*

- ☐ It's good you **reminded me about** the meeting. I'd completely forgotten about it.

remind somebody **OF** ... = *cause somebody to remember*

- ☐ This house **reminds me of** the one I lived in when I was a child.
☐ Look at this photograph of Richard. Who does he **remind you of**?

A verb + **of****accuse / suspect** somebody **OF** ...

- ☐ Tina **accused** me **of** being selfish.
- ☐ Some students were **suspected of** cheating in the exam.

approve / disapprove OF ...

- ☐ His parents don't **approve of** what he does, but they can't stop him.

die OF or die FROM an illness etc.

- ☐ 'What did he **die of**?' 'A heart attack.'

consist OF ...

- ☐ We had an enormous meal. It **consisted of** seven courses.

B verb + **for****pay** (somebody) **FOR** ...

- ☐ We didn't have enough money to **pay for** the meal. (*not* pay the meal)
- But we say '**pay** a bill / a fine / a fee / tax / rent / a sum of money' etc. (no preposition)
- ☐ We didn't have enough money to **pay the rent**.

thank / forgive somebody **FOR** ...

- ☐ I'll never **forgive** them **for** what they did.

apologise (TO somebody) FOR ...

- ☐ When I realised I was wrong, I **apologised (to them) for** my mistake.

blame somebody/something **FOR** ... , somebody is **to blame FOR** ...

- ☐ Everybody **blamed** me **for** the accident.
- ☐ Everybody said that I was **to blame for** the accident.

blame (a problem etc.) **ON** ...

- ☐ It wasn't my fault. Don't **blame** it **on** me.

C verb + **from****suffer FROM** an illness etc.

- ☐ There's been an increase in the number of people **suffering from** heart disease.

protect somebody/something **FROM** ...

- ☐ Sun cream **protects** the skin **from** the sun.

D verb + **on****depend ON** ... , **rely ON** ...

- ☐ I don't know what time we'll arrive. It **depends on** the traffic.
 - ☐ You can **rely on** Anna. She always keeps her promises.
- You can use **depend + when/where/how** etc. with or without **on**:
- ☐ 'Are you going to buy it?' 'It **depends how much** it is.' (*or* 'It depends **on** how much ...')

live ON money/food

- ☐ Michael's salary is very low. It isn't enough to **live on**.

congratulate / compliment somebody **ON** ...

- ☐ I **congratulated** her **on** doing so well in her exams.
- ☐ The meal was really good. I **complimented** Mark **on** his cooking skills.

A verb + **in**

believe IN ... = *believe that something exists, believe that it's good to do something*

☐ Do you **believe in** God? (= do you believe that God exists?)

☐ I **believe in** saying what I think. (= I believe it is right to say what I think)

but '**believe** something' (= believe that it is true), '**believe** somebody' (= believe what they say):

☐ The story can't be true. I don't **believe it**. (*not believe in it*)

specialise IN ...

☐ Helen is a lawyer. She **specialises in** company law.

succeed IN ...

☐ I hope you **succeed in** finding the job you want.

B verb + **into**

break INTO ...

☐ Our house was **broken into** a few days ago, but nothing was stolen.

crash / drive / bump / run INTO ...

☐ He lost control of the car and **crashed into** a wall.

divide / cut / split something **INTO** two or more parts

☐ The book is **divided into** three parts.

translate a book etc. **FROM** one language **INTO** another

☐ She's a famous writer. Her books have been **translated into** many languages.

C verb + **with**

collide WITH ...

☐ There was an accident this morning. A bus **collided with** a car.

fill something **WITH** ... (*but full of* – see Unit 131A)

☐ Take this saucepan and **fill it with** water.

provide / supply somebody **WITH** ...

☐ The school **provides** all its students **with** books.

D verb + **to**

happen TO ...

☐ What **happened to** that gold watch you used to have? (= where is it now?)

invite somebody **TO** a party / a wedding etc.

☐ They only **invited** a few people **to** their wedding.

prefer one thing **TO** another

☐ I **prefer** tea **to** coffee.

E verb + **on**

concentrate ON ...

☐ I tried to **concentrate on** my work, but I kept thinking about other things.

insist ON ...

☐ I wanted to go alone, but some friends of mine **insisted on** coming with me.

spend (money) **ON** ...

☐ How much do you **spend on** food each week?

A We often use verbs with:

in	on	up	away	by	about	over	round or around
out	off	down	back	through	along	forward	

So you can say **look out** / **get on** / **take off** / **run away** etc. These are *phrasal verbs*.

We often use **on/off/out** etc. with verbs of movement. For example:

- | | |
|-------------------|--|
| get on | ☐ The bus was full. We couldn't get on . |
| drive off | ☐ A woman got into the car and drove off . |
| come back | ☐ Sarah is leaving tomorrow and coming back on Saturday. |
| turn round | ☐ When I touched him on the shoulder, he turned round . |

B Often the second word (**on/off/out** etc.) gives a special meaning to the verb. For example:

- | | |
|-------------------|---|
| break down | ☐ Sorry I'm late. The car broke down . (= the engine stopped working) |
| find out | ☐ I never found out who sent me the flowers. (= I never discovered) |
| take off | ☐ It was my first flight. I was nervous as the plane took off . (= went into the air) |
| give up | ☐ I tried many times to contact her. In the end I gave up . (= stopped trying) |
| get on | ☐ How was the exam? How did you get on ? (= How did you do?) |
| get by | ☐ My French isn't good, but it's enough to get by . (= enough to manage) |

For more phrasal verbs, see Units 138–145.

C Sometimes a phrasal verb is followed by a *preposition*. For example:

- | <i>phrasal verb</i> | <i>preposition</i> | |
|---------------------|--------------------|--|
| look up | at | ☐ We looked up at the plane as it flew above us. |
| run away | from | ☐ Why did you run away from me? |
| keep up | with | ☐ You're walking too fast. I can't keep up with you. |
| look forward | to | ☐ Are you looking forward to your trip? |

D Sometimes a phrasal verb has an *object*. For example:

- ☐ I turned on **the light**. (**the light** is the *object*)

Usually there are two possible positions for the object. You can say:

- ☐ I **turned on** the light. or I **turned** the light **on**.
- object* *object*

But if the object is a *pronoun* (**it/them/me/him** etc.), only one position is possible:

- ☐ I turned **it** on. (*not* I turned on it)

In the same way, you can say:

- ☐ I'm going to **take off** my shoes.
 take my shoes **off**.

but These shoes are uncomfortable. I'm going to **take them off**. (*not* take off them)

- ☐ Don't **wake up** the baby.
 wake the baby **up**.

but The baby is asleep. Don't **wake her up**. (*not* wake up her)

- ☐ Don't **throw away** this box.
 throw this box **away**.

but I want to keep this box, so don't **throw it away**. (*not* throw away it)

A Compare **in** and **out**:**in** = into a room, a building, a car etc.

- ☐ How did the thieves **get in**?
- ☐ Here's a key, so you can **let yourself in**.
- ☐ Lisa walked up to the edge of the pool and **dived in**. (= into the water)
- ☐ I've got a new apartment. I'm **moving in** on Friday.
- ☐ As soon as I got to the airport, I **checked in**.

In the same way you can say **go in, come in, walk in, break in** etc.Compare **in** and **into**:

- ☐ I'm moving **in** on Friday.
- ☐ I'm moving **into my new flat** on Friday

out = out of a room, a building, a car etc.

- ☐ Stay in the car. Don't **get out**.
- ☐ I had no key, so I was **locked out**.
- ☐ She swam up and down the pool, and then **climbed out**.
- ☐ Andy opened the window and **looked out**.
- ☐ We paid the hotel bill and **checked out**.

In the same way you can say **go out, get out, move out, let somebody out** etc.Compare **out** and **out of**:

- ☐ She climbed **out**.
- ☐ She climbed **out of the pool**.

B Other verbs + **in****drop in** = visit somebody at home without arranging to do this

- ☐ I **dropped in** to see Chris on my way home.

join in = take part in something that is already going on

- ☐ They were playing cards, so I **joined in**.

plug in an electrical machine = connect it to the electricity supply

- ☐ The fridge isn't working because you haven't **plugged it in**.



PLUG IN

take somebody in = deceive somebody

- ☐ The man said he was a policeman and I believed him. I was completely **taken in**.

fill in or **fill out** a form, a questionnaire etc. = write the necessary information on a form

- ☐ Please **fill in** the application form and send it to us by 28 February. or
Please **fill out** the application form ...

C Other verbs + **out****eat out** = eat at a restaurant, not at home

- ☐ There wasn't anything to eat at home, so we decided to **eat out**.

drop out of college / university / a course / a race = stop before you have completely finished

- ☐ Gary went to university but **dropped out** after a year.

get out of something that you arranged to do = avoid doing it

- ☐ I promised I'd go to the wedding. I don't want to go, but I can't **get out** of it now.

leave something out = omit it, not include it

- ☐ In the sentence 'She said that she was ill', you can **leave out** the word 'that'.

cross something out = write a line through something

- ☐ Some of the names on the list had been **crossed out**.

CROSS OUT

A

out = not burning, not shining

go out

put out a fire / a cigarette / a light

turn out a light

blow out a candle

- ☐ Suddenly all the lights in the building **went out**.
- ☐ I **put** the fire **out** with a fire extinguisher.
- ☐ I **turned** the lights **out** before leaving.
- ☐ We don't need the candle. You can **blow it out**.

B

work out

work out = *do physical exercises*

- ☐ Rachel **works out** at the gym three times a week.

work out = *develop, progress*

- ☐ Good luck for the future. I hope everything **works out** well for you.
- ☐ A: Why did James leave the company?
B: Things didn't **work out**. (= things didn't work out well)

work out (for calculations):

- ☐ The total bill for three people is £97.35. That **works out** at £32.45 each.

work (something) **out** = *calculate*

- ☐ 345×76 ? I need a calculator. I can't **work it out** in my head.

work out or **figure out** = *understand, think about a problem and find an answer*

- ☐ Investigators are trying to **work out** what caused the accident. or
Investigators are trying to **figure out** what caused the accident.

C

Other verbs + **out**

carry out an order / an experiment / a survey / an investigation / a plan etc.

- ☐ Soldiers are expected to **carry out** orders.
- ☐ An investigation into the accident will be **carried out**.

find out that/what/when (etc.) ... , **find out about** ... = *get information about*

- ☐ The police never **found out** who committed the crime.
- ☐ I just **found out** that it's Helen's birthday today.
- ☐ I checked a few websites to **find out** about hotels in the town.

give/hand things **out** = *give to each person*

- ☐ At the end of the lecture, the speaker **gave out** information sheets to the audience.

point something **out** (to somebody) = *draw attention to it*

- ☐ As we drove through the city, the tour guide **pointed out** all the sights.
- ☐ I didn't realise I'd made a mistake until somebody **pointed it out to** me.

run out (of something)

- ☐ We **ran out of** petrol on the motorway. (= we used all our petrol)

sort something **out** = *find a solution to, put in order*

- ☐ There are a few problems we need to **sort out**.
- ☐ All these papers are mixed up. I'll have to **sort them out**.

turn out to be ... / **turn out** good/nice etc. / **turn out** that ...

- ☐ Nobody believed Paul at first, but he **turned out** to be right. (= it became clear in the end that he was right)
- ☐ The weather wasn't so good in the morning, but it **turned out** nice later.
- ☐ I thought they knew each other, but it **turned out** that they'd never met.

try out a machine, a system, a new idea etc. = *test it to see if it is OK*

- ☐ The company is **trying out** some new software at the moment.

A **on** and **off** for lights, machines etc.

We say:
the light **is on** / **put** the light **on** / **leave** the light **on** etc.
turn the light **on/off** or **switch** the light **on/off**

- ☐ Shall I **leave** the lights **on** or **turn** them **off**?
- ☐ 'Is the heating **on**?' 'No, I **switched** it **off**.'

also

put (music, a song) **on**, **put** the kettle **on**:

- ☐ Let's **put** some music **on**. What would you like to hear?
- ☐ We need boiling water, so I'll **put** the kettle **on**.

B **on** and **off** for events etc.

go on = *happen*

- ☐ What's all that noise? What's **going on**? (= what's happening)

call something **off** = *cancel it*

- ☐ The concert in the park had to be **called off** because of the weather.

put something **off**, **put off** doing something = *delay it*

- ☐ The election has been **put off** until January.
- ☐ We can't **put off** making a decision. We have to decide now.

C **on** and **off** for clothes etc.

put on clothes, glasses, make-up, a seat belt etc.

- ☐ My hands were cold, so I **put** my gloves **on**.

put on weight = *get heavier*

- ☐ I've **put on** two kilos in the last month.

try on clothes (to see if they fit)

- ☐ I **tried on** a jacket in the shop, but it didn't look right.

take off clothes, glasses etc.

- ☐ It was warm, so I **took off** my coat.

D **off** = away from a person or place

be off (to a place)

- ☐ Tomorrow I'm **off** to Paris. / I'm **off** on holiday.
(= I'm going to Paris / I'm going on holiday)

walk off / **run off** / **drive off** / **ride off** / **go off** (similar to **walk away** / **run away** etc.)

- ☐ Anna got on her bike and **rode off**.
- ☐ Mark left home at the age of eighteen and **went off** to Canada.

set off = *start a journey*

- ☐ We **set off** early to avoid the traffic. (= We left early)

take off = *leave the ground (for planes)*

- ☐ After a long delay, the plane finally **took off**.

see somebody **off** = *go with them to the airport/station to say goodbye*

- ☐ Helen was going away. We went to the station with her to **see her off**.

Phrasal verbs 5 **on/off** (2)**A** verb + **on** = continue doing something**go on** = *continue*

- ☐ The party **went on** until 4 o'clock in the morning.

go on / carry on doing something = *continue doing it*

- ☐ We can't **go on** spending money like this. We'll have nothing left soon.
☐ I don't want to **carry on** working here. I'm going to look for another job.

go on with / carry on with something = *continue it*

- ☐ Don't let me disturb you. Please **carry on with** what you're doing.

keep on doing (or **keep** doing) something = *do it continuously or repeatedly*

- ☐ He **keeps on** criticising me. It's not fair! (or He **keeps** criticising me.)

drive on / walk on / play on = *continue driving/walking/playing etc.*

- ☐ Shall we stop at this petrol station or shall we **drive on** to the next one?

B **get on****get on** = *progress*

- ☐ How are you **getting on** in your new job? (= How is it going?)

get on (with somebody) = *have a good relationship*

- ☐ Joanne and Karen don't **get on**. They're always arguing.
☐ Richard **gets on** well **with** his neighbours. They're all very friendly.

get on with something = *continue something you have to do, usually after an interruption*

- ☐ I must **get on with** my work. I have a lot to do.

C verb + **off****doze off / drop off / nod off** = *fall asleep*

- ☐ I **dozed off** during the lecture. It was very boring.

finish something **off** = *do the last part of it*

- ☐ A: Have you finished painting the kitchen?
 B: Nearly. I'll **finish** it **off** tomorrow.

go off = *make an alarm sound*

- ☐ Did you hear the alarm **go off**?

put somebody **off** (doing) something so that they don't want it or want to do it any more

- ☐ We wanted to go to the exhibition, but we were **put off** by the long queue.
 (= we didn't go because of the long queue)
☐ What **put** you **off** applying for the job? Was the salary too low?

rip somebody **off** / be **ripped off** = *cheat somebody / be cheated*

- ☐ Did you really pay £2,000 for that painting? I think you were **ripped off**.
 (= you paid too much)

show off = *try to impress people with your ability, your knowledge etc.*

- ☐ Look at that boy on the bike riding with no hands. He's just **showing off**.

tell somebody **off** = *speak angrily to somebody because they did something wrong*

- ☐ Clare's mother **told** her **off** for wearing dirty shoes in the house.

A Compare **up** and **down**:**put** something **up** (on a wall etc.)

- ☐ I **put** a picture **up** on the wall.

pick something **up**

- ☐ There was a letter on the floor. I **picked** it **up** and looked at it.

stand up

- ☐ Alan **stood up** and walked out.

turn something **up**

- ☐ I can't hear the TV. Can you **turn** it **up** a bit?

**take** something **down** (from a wall etc.)

- ☐ I didn't like the picture, so I **took** it **down**.

put something **down**

- ☐ I stopped writing and **put down** my pen.

sit down / bend down / lie down

- ☐ I **bent down** to tie my shoelace.

turn something **down**

- ☐ The oven is too hot. **Turn** it **down** to 150 degrees.

B **knock down, cut down** etc.**knock down** a building / **blow** something **down** / **cut** something **down** etc.

- ☐ Some old houses were **knocked down** to make way for the new shopping centre.
☐ Why did you **cut down** the tree in your garden?

be **knocked down** (by a car etc.)

- ☐ A man was **knocked down** by a car and taken to hospital.

burn down = *be destroyed by fire*

- ☐ They were able to put out the fire before the house **burnt down**.

C **down** = getting less**slow down** = *go more slowly*

- ☐ You're driving too fast. **Slow down**.

calm (somebody) **down** = *become calmer, make somebody calmer*

- ☐ **Calm down**. There's no point in getting angry.

cut down (on something) = *eat, drink or do something less often*

- ☐ I'm trying to **cut down on** coffee. I drink too much of it.

D Other verbs + **down****break down** = *stop working (for machines, cars, relationships etc.)*

- ☐ The car **broke down** and I had to phone for help.
☐ Their marriage **broke down** after only a few months.

close down / shut down = *stop doing business*

- ☐ There used to be a shop at the end of the street. It **closed down** a few years ago.

let somebody **down** = *disappoint them because you didn't do what they hoped*

- ☐ You can always rely on Paul. He'll never **let** you **down**.

turn somebody/something **down** = *refuse an application, an offer etc.*

- ☐ I applied for several jobs, but I was **turned down** for all of them.
☐ Rachel was offered the job, but she decided to **turn** it **down**.

write something **down** = *write something on paper because you may need the information later*

- ☐ I can't remember Ben's address. I **wrote** it **down**, but I can't find it.

A

go up, come up, walk up (to ...) = *approach*

- ☐ A man **came up to** me in the street and asked me for money.

catch up (with somebody), catch somebody up = *move faster than people in front of you so that you reach them*

- ☐ I'm not ready to go yet. You go on and I'll **catch up with** you / I'll **catch** you **up**.

keep up (with somebody) = *continue at the same speed or level*

- ☐ You're walking too fast. I can't **keep up (with)** you.
☐ You're doing well. **Keep it up!**

B

set up an organisation, a company, a business, a system, a website etc. = *start it*

- ☐ The government has **set up** a committee to investigate the problem.

take up a hobby, a sport, an activity etc. = *start doing it*

- ☐ Laura **took up** photography a few years ago. She takes really good pictures.

fix up a meeting etc. = *arrange it*

- ☐ We've **fixed up** a meeting for next Monday.

C

grow up = *become an adult*

- ☐ Amy was born in Hong Kong but **grew up** in Australia.

bring up a child = *raise, look after a child*

- ☐ Her parents died when she was a child and she was **brought up** by her grandparents.

D

clean up, clear up, tidy up = *make something clean, tidy etc.*

- ☐ Look at this mess! Who's going to **tidy up?** (or ... to **tidy it up**)

wash up = *wash the plates, dishes etc. after a meal*

- ☐ I hate **washing up**. (or I hate **doing the washing-up**.)

E

end up somewhere, **end up** doing something etc.

- ☐ There was a fight in the street and three men **ended up** in hospital.
 (= that's what happened to these men in the end)
☐ I couldn't find a hotel and **ended up** sleeping on a bench at the station.
 (= that's what happened to me in the end)

give up = *stop trying*, **give something up** = *stop doing it*

- ☐ Don't **give up**. Keep trying!
☐ Sue got bored with her job and decided to **give it up**. (= stop doing it)

make up something, be **made up of** something

- ☐ Children under 16 **make up** half the population of the city.
 (= half the population are children under 16)
☐ Air is **made up** mainly **of** nitrogen and oxygen. (= Air consists of ...)

take up space or time = *use space or time*

- ☐ Most of the space in the room was **taken up** by a large table.

turn up, show up = *arrive, appear*

- ☐ We arranged to meet David last night, but he didn't **turn up**.

use something up = *use all of it so that nothing is left*

- ☐ I'm going to make soup. We have a lot of vegetables and I want to **use them up**.

A

bring up a topic etc. = *introduce it in a conversation*

- ☐ I don't want to hear any more about this. Please don't **bring it up** again.

come up = *be introduced in a conversation*

- ☐ Some interesting things **came up** in our discussion yesterday.

come up with an idea, a suggestion etc. = *produce an idea*

- ☐ Sarah is very creative. She's always **coming up with** new ideas.

make something up = *invent something that is not true*

- ☐ What Kevin told you about himself wasn't true. He **made it all up**.

B

cheer up = *be happier*, **cheer somebody up** = *make somebody feel happier*

- ☐ You look so sad! **Cheer up!**
☐ Helen is depressed. What can we do to **cheer her up**?

save up for something / to do something = *save money to buy something*

- ☐ Dan is **saving up** for a trip to New Zealand.

clear up = *become bright (for weather)*

- ☐ It was raining when I got up, but it **cleared up** later.

C

blow up = *explode*, **blow something up** = *destroy it with a bomb etc.*

- ☐ The engine caught fire and **blew up**.
☐ The bridge was **blown up** during the war.

tear something up = *tear it into pieces*

- ☐ I didn't read the letter. I just **tore it up** and threw it away.

beat somebody up = *hit someone repeatedly so that they are badly hurt*

- ☐ A friend of mine was attacked and **beaten up**. He had to go to hospital.

D

break up, split up (with somebody) = *separate*

- ☐ I'm surprised to hear that Kate and Paul have **split up**. They seemed very happy together.

do up a coat, a shoelace, buttons etc. = *fasten, tie etc.*

- ☐ It's quite cold. **Do up** your coat before you go out.

do up a building, a room etc. = *repair and improve it*

- ☐ The kitchen looks great now that it has been **done up**.

look something up in a dictionary/encyclopaedia etc.

- ☐ If you don't know the meaning of a word, you can **look it up** (in a dictionary).

put up with something = *tolerate a difficult situation or person*

- ☐ We live on a busy road, so we have to **put up with** a lot of noise from the traffic.

hold up a person, a plan etc. = *delay*

- ☐ Don't wait for me. I don't want to **hold you up**.
☐ Plans to build a new factory have been **held up** because of financial problems.

mix up people/things, **get** people/things **mixed up** = *you think one is the other*

- ☐ The two brothers look very similar. People often **mix them up**.
 or ... People often **get them mixed up**.

A Compare **away** and **back**:**away** = away from home

- ☐ We're **going away** on holiday today.

away = away from a place, a person etc.

- ☐ Sarah got into her car, started the engine and **drove away**.
- ☐ I tried to take a picture of the bird, but it **flew away**.
- ☐ I dropped the ticket, and it **blew away** in the wind.
- ☐ The police searched the house and **took away** a computer.

In the same way you can say:

walk away, run away, look away etc.**back** = back home

- ☐ We'll **be back** in three weeks.

back = back to a place, a person etc.

- ☐ A: I'm going out now.
B: What time will you **be back**?
- ☐ After eating at a restaurant, we **walked back** to our hotel.
- ☐ I've still got Jane's keys. I forgot to **give** them **back** to her.
- ☐ When you've finished with that book, can you **put it back** on the shelf?

In the same way you can say:

go back, come back, get back, take something **back** etc.B Other verbs + **away****get away** = *escape, leave with difficulty*

- ☐ We tried to catch the thief, but she **got away**.

get away with something = *do something wrong without being caught*

- ☐ I parked in a no-parking zone, but I **got away with** it. I didn't have to pay a fine.

keep away (from ...) = *don't go near*

- ☐ **Keep away from** the edge of the pool. You might fall in.

give something **away** = *give it to somebody else because you don't want it any more*

- ☐ 'Did you sell your bike?' 'No, I **gave it away to a friend**.'

put something **away** = *put it in the place where it is usually kept*

- ☐ When the children finished playing with their toys, they **put them away**.

throw something **away** = *put it in the rubbish*

- ☐ I kept the letter, but I **threw away** the envelope.

C Other verbs + **back****wave back / smile back / shout back / hit** somebody **back**

- ☐ I waved to her, and she **waved back**.

call/phone/ring (somebody) **back** = *return a phone call*

- ☐ I can't talk to you now. I'll **call you back** in ten minutes.

get back to somebody = *reply to them by phone etc.*

- ☐ I sent him an email, but he never **got back to** me.

look back (on something) = *think about what happened in the past*

- ☐ My first job was in a travel agency. I didn't like it much at the time but, **looking back on** it, I learnt a lot and it was a useful experience.

pay back money, **pay** somebody **back**

- ☐ If you borrow money, you have to **pay it back**.
- ☐ Thanks for lending me the money. I'll **pay you back** next week.